2024
RSPO Principles & Criteria
for
Sustainable Cultivation of Oil Palms &
Production of Sustainable Palm Oil
and Oil Palm Products

Version 4-1

Adopted at the 21st RSPO General Assembly on 13 November 2024
(Non-final design)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

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High Value Conservation Network (HCV Network/HCVN)	VVF Ltd
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I. Introduction

1.1 Roundtable of Sustainable Palm Oil (RSPO)

The Roundtable on Sustainable Palm Oil (RSPO) was established in 2004 as a non-profit membership association (under Article 60 of the Swiss Civil Code) with the aim of convening the palm oil industry through a multi-stakeholder platform to develop and implement global standards for sustainable palm oil and oil palm products. Our objective is to promote the growth and use of certified sustainable palm oil and oil palm products through cooperation and shared responsibility within the supply chain and the wider palm oil value chain.

1.1.1 The RSPO Vision

RSPO is a global partnership to make palm oil sustainable.

We convene stakeholders across the palm oil value chain to act together as partners for progress and positive impact, facilitating global change through the production, consumption, and awareness of sustainable palm oil. To provide assurance, we set the standards of certification. To inspire change, we communicate environmental, social, and economic/commercial benefits. To make progress, we catalyse collaboration. RSPO, therefore, represents a collective ambition to ensure the palm oil value chain equitably balances the interests of our three Impact Pillars - People, Planet, Prosperity.

The RSPO Principles and Criteria (P&C) is a foundational mechanism within RSPO's wider library of standards, systems, and procedures. While the RSPO P&C is not the only mechanism RSPO has developed as a global partnership to make palm oil sustainable, it is the most critical one around which all RSPO activities are designed and structured.

1.1.2 The RSPO Theory of Change

The first RSPO Theory of Change (ToC) was published in 2017 and revised in September 2024 for relevance, in compliance with the ISEAL Impacts Code of Good Practice Version 2.0. The 2024 RSPO Principles and Criteria has been aligned with the revised RSPO ToC.

The revised ToC is presented in two visual diagrams: the full ToC and a simplified ToC (see Appendix A). The full ToC is intended for a detailed and more technical understanding of the ToC's causal pathways, while the simplified ToC is intended to show the essence of expected change for general understanding and communication.

While the scope of the ToC is broader than the RSPO P&C, the standard interacts with the ToC in fundamental ways. A clear, implementable, auditable, and relevant standard is integral to achieving the positive impacts and RSPO's vision, from RSPO's direct strategies and activities, to the outputs, expected change, and intended impacts of those strategies and activities.

Progress of the ToC will be monitored and evaluated for continuous improvement. Public reporting of the progress in expected change and intended impacts will be published in the RSPO Impact Report or Impact Update, based on the RSPO Impact Framework.

1.1.3 The RSPO Information System

RSPO has developed a unified digital certification, trade, and traceability Information System, titled prisma (referenced as 'RSPO Information System' in this document). All information concerning compliance and certification under the 2024 RSPO P&C (unless specifically mentioned as an exception) will be reported and stored in prisma, which will provide critical digital traceability pathways to deliver key publicly-available certification data to the wider RSPO palm oil value chain. The development of prisma, and the transmission of data within the system, shall respect the confidentiality and operational/business rights of RSPO members and Units of Certification.

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II. Preamble

2.1 The RSPO Principles & Criteria

The RSPO Principles and Criteria (P&C) is applicable to the sustainable cultivation of oil palms, and production of sustainable palm oil and oil palm products worldwide. The RSPO P&C outlines requirements for sustainable cultivation and production practices, supplemented with guidance, recommended practices, and advice to assist RSPO members in reaching shared sustainability objectives. Adherence to the RSPO P&C ensures that oil palms are cultivated, and palm oil/oil palm products are produced, in a way that equitably balances the interests of People, Planet and Prosperity.

Background to 2024 RSPO P&C (Version 4-0)

The first RSPO Principles and Criteria (P&C) was piloted in 2005 and released for general adoption in 2007. The standard was revised in 2013, and again in 2018. A separate RSPO Independent Smallholder (ISH) standard (RISS V1-0) was released for general adoption in 2019. To ensure downstream chain of custody of palm oil and oil palm products produced and sold as RSPO certified, the RSPO Supply Chain Certification (SCC) Standard was adopted in November 2014, and revised in February 2020.

In February 2022, RSPO began a comprehensive Standards Review and Revision process to assess relevance of the 2018 RSPO P&C (Version 3-1) and the 2019 RSPO ISH Standard (IS_V1-0), in line with the 'RSPO Standard Operating Procedure for Standard Setting and Review (2020)', and in compliance with the 'ISEAL Code of Good Practice for Setting Social and Environmental Standards Version 6.0'.

The revised standard - 2024 RSPO P&C (Version 4-0) - is the fourth version of the RSPO Principles and Criteria, adopted by RSPO members at the 21st RSPO General Assembly on 13 November 2024, to replace the previous 2018 RSPO P&C (Version 3-1) standard.

Version*	Description	Date
V1-0* (P&C 2007)	The first RSPO P&C was drafted in November 2005, with trial implementation conducted from November 2005 to November 2007. It was formally endorsed for general adoption by the RSPO Executive Board in October 2007. The 2007 RSPO P&C applied to all oil palm producers.	Oct 2007
V2-0* (P&C 2013)	The first revision of the RSPO P&C was adopted at the RSPO Extraordinary General Assembly on 25 April 2013. Additional indicators were endorsed for inclusion by the RSPO Board of Governors on 15 November 2013. The 2013 RSPO P&C applied to all oil palm producers.	15 Nov 2013
V3-0* (P&C 2018)	The second revision of the RSPO P&C was adopted at the 15th RSPO General Assembly on 15 November 2018. The 2018 RSPO P&C applies to all oil palm producers (with the exception of Independent Smallholders and Independent Palm Oil Mills).	15 Nov 2018
IS_V1-0* (ISH 2019)	The first standalone RSPO Independent Smallholder (ISH) Standard was adopted at the 16th RSPO General Assembly on 6 November 2019. The RSPO ISH Standard applies to independent smallholder groups.	16 Nov 2019
V3-1* (P&C 2018)	A procedural update of the 2018 RSPO P&C to incorporate traceability requirements for palm oil mills, in alignment with the revised 2020 RSPO Supply Chain Certification (SCC) Standard adopted on 1 February 2020.	1 Feb 2020
V4-0 (P&C 2024)	The third revision of the RSPO P&C was adopted at the 21st RSPO General Assembly on 13 November 2024. The 2024 RSPO P&C applies to all oil palm producers (with the exception of Independent Smallholders and Independent Palm Oil Mills).	13 Nov 2024

**RSPO standards without official version numbers, which have been retroactively applied for document control purposes .*

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2.1.1 Structure

The 2024 RSPO Principles and Criteria is composed of six sections, with normative and informative elements. In reference to the "ISO/IEC Directives, Part 2, Principles and Rules for the Structure and Drafting of ISO and IEC documents", the definition of normative and informative is:

- **Normative:** Describes the scope of the document or sets out mandatory provisions
- **Informative:** Information intended to assist the understanding or use of the document, or that provides contextual information about its content, background, or relationship with other documents

Section	Title	Applicability
I	**Introduction**	**Informative**
II	**Preamble**	**Normative**
III	**Change Log**	**Informative**
IV	**Principles, Criteria, and Indicators**	**Normative**
V	**Annexes**	
Annex 1	*Terms and definitions*	*Normative*
Annex 2	*Relevant International Laws and Conventions*	*Informative*
Annex 3	*Interpretation of Indicator 7.7.1 (C)*	*Normative*
Annex 4	*List of RSPO-recognised Human Rights Due Diligence methodologies for compliance to Indicator 1.3.1*	*Normative*
Annex 5	*Guidance*	*Informative*
Annex 6	*Supplementary and derivative documents of the 2024 RSPO P&C*	*Normative / Informative*
VI	**Appendices**	
Appendix A	*RSPO Theory of Change*	*Informative*
Appendix B	*List of National Interpretations of the 2018 RSPO P&C*	*Informative*

Presentation Format

The presentation of principles, criteria, and indicators in the 2024 RSPO P&C is based on the following format:

Term	Definition	Applicability
Principle	Fundamental statement about an overarching sustainability objective of the standard, encompassing criteria and indicators to achieve that objective. Aligned with Long-term Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change	Normative
Criterion/ Criteria	A component condition or outcome that has to be met to comply with the principle. Aligned to Long-term/Intermediate Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change.	Normative
Indicator	A measurable state that the Unit of Certification shall demonstrate compliance to, based on objective or subjective assessment, in order to achieve a criterion. Aligned with Intermediate Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change.	Normative
Criticality	Critical Indicators are denoted with (C) in the numbering of the indicator. Non-Critical Indicators are denoted by the absence of a (C) in the numbering of the indicator.	Normative
Procedural Note	An instance where an exceptional measure or an interim directive is required due to pending developments. A Procedural Note is used where a procedure or a supplementary/derivative document is still under development at the time of the standard's adoption or effective date, to clarify terms, conditions, and interim measures that shall be in active use until pending development has been completed and endorsed for implementation. Unless explicitly stated to be informative, a Procedural Note is normative.	Normative / Informative

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Supplementary and Derivative Documents

Implementation of the 2024 RSPO P&C shall be supported by a library of supplementary and derivative documents, which include guidance documents and/or Best Management Practices (BMPs) for specific indicators, formally-adopted procedures (e.g., the RSPO Remediation and Compensation Procedure/RaCP, the RSPO New Planting Procedure/NPP, the RSPO Prevailing Wage Calculation Procedure, the RSPO Drainability Assessment Procedure), as well as National Interpretations of the 2024 RSPO P&C.

A list of currently effective, to be developed, to be updated, and in development supplementary and derivative documents to support implementation of the 2024 RSPO P&C is available in Annex 6, and can be referenced on the RSPO website.

National Interpretations

The 2024 RSPO Principles and Criteria provides general principles, criteria, indicators, requirements, and guidance for sustainable cultivation of oil palms, and production of sustainable palm oil and oil palm products, that are applicable globally. The National Interpretation (NI) process, as specified in the "RSPO Standard Operating Procedure for Standard Setting and Review (2020)", allows the general 2024 RSPO P&C to be contextualised at a national level for specific countries.

RSPO encourages all palm oil producing countries to comply with the general 2024 RSPO P&C, but allows for members in a particular country to initiate a National Interpretation process. Until a NI has been developed for a specific country and endorsed by the RSPO Board of Governors, the applicable standard in that country is the general 2024 RSPO P&C.

RSPO respects the right of our members to initiate a National Interpretation process, and the RSPO Secretariat will provide guidance and facilitation support. A NI process may be initiated through a formal request addressed to the RSPO Secretariat (standard.development@rspo.org), and written approval from RSPO shall be required to proceed. A NI process may be initiated within 24 months of the formal adoption of the general 2024 RSPO P&C, and development of any initiated NI should be concluded no later than 36 months from the formal adoption of the general 2024 RSPO P&C 2024.

A National Interpretation shall be confined to the scope of the general 2024 RSPO P&C. Additional criteria shall not be developed. A NI may strengthen criteria, indicators, and guidance, or develop acceptable performance levels to measure indicators that are contextualised for a specific country, as long as such changes do not represent a diminution of the general 2024 RSPO P&C. New indicators and guidance may be developed, as long as such additions do not contradict or weaken any other part of the NI or the general 2024 RSPO P&C.

A list of currently effective National Interpretations of the 2018 RSPO P&C is available in Appendix B.

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2.1.2 Scope

The 2024 RSPO Principles and Criteria provides a holistic approach for the sustainable cultivation of oil palms, and production of sustainable palm oil and oil palm products, focusing on significant social, environmental, and economic/commercial aspects associated with the cultivation of oil palms, and production of palm oil and oil palm products. This is defined as:

A. The *Elaeis* genus of oil palms, including all botanical hybrids, breeds, varieties, and/or forms derived from the African oil palm (*Elaeis guineensis)* or the American oil palm (*Elaeis oleifera)* e.g., variants or forms such as *E.guineensis fo. tenera*, *Elaeis guineensis fo. dura*, *Elaeis guineensis var. Pisifera.*
B. Planting, replanting, expansion, and cultivation of oil palms (including land, activities, and workers associated with such developments and/or operations)
C. Harvesting, distribution, and sourcing of Fresh Fruit Bunches (FFB) from oil palms (including land, activities, and workers associated with such developments and/or operations)
D. Milling, production, and trade of crude palm oil (CPO) (including land, activities, and workers associated with such developments and/or operations)
E. Associated oil palm products of such operations, including palm kernels, by-products, and waste products

The 2024 RSPO P&C applies to RSPO members involved in activities covered by the above scope regardless of category or sector of RSPO membership, with the exception of Independent Palm Oil Mills (which are covered under the RSPO Supply Chain Certification Standard) and Independent Smallholder groups (which are covered under the RSPO Independent Smallholder Standard). In this document, RSPO members within scope shall be referred to as ‘oil palm growers’ or ‘growers’.

Certification under the 2024 RSPO P&C is granted to a palm oil mill(s) and associated supply base(s), collectively known as a Unit of Certification or UoC, that demonstrates compliance to the standard. The scope of a UoC’s certification shall include scheme smallholders (individuals or groups) and/or outgrowers under a formal and legal contractual FFB sourcing agreement with a Unit of Certification, which should be contextualised through a National Interpretation process.

Translation Accuracy Disclaimer

The 2024 RSPO P&C (as well as associated supplementary and derivative documents) is written in English, with translations into Bahasa Malaysia, Bahasa Indonesia, Thai, French, and Spanish. Translation accuracy of these RSPO documents in languages other than English is a priority, but is not guaranteed or implied. Any discrepancies or differences in translations is not binding nor enforceable; in such cases, the official English version of the RSPO document shall prevail.

Legal Precedence

The 2024 RSPO P&C (as well as associated supplementary and derivative documents) may include criteria, indicators, and/or requirements that overlap with prevailing national, regional, or local regulations/laws in countries where oil palm cultivation and palm oil production occurs. In cases where the 2024 RSPO P&C differs from such regulations or laws, the higher or stricter of the two shall always prevail. The National Interpretation (NI) process may adapt the general 2024 RSPO P&C to account for local context, against a reference list of applicable regulations and laws in the specific country. In the absence of an NI, the general 2024 RSPO P&C shall prevail.

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2.2 Drafting Guidelines

The 2024 RSPO P&C has been drafted based on a simplified adaptation of the 'ISO/IEC Directives, Part 2, Principles and Rules for the Structure and Drafting of ISO and IEC documents', in particular Section 7 'Verbals Forms for Expression of Provisions'. This is to ensure that the standard is written, and can be read or interpreted, in a consistent manner and style across the entire document. The following drafting rules were generally applied during the revision process for the 2024 RSPO P&C.

2.2.1 Wording and Intention

The compulsory nature of each requirement is expressed using a simplified adaptation of the ISO 'Verbals Forms for Expression of Provisions', to capture the specific intention of provisionary clauses within the standard.

Type of clauses based on intention

- **Requirement:** Indicates instructions or requirements to be followed strictly for compliance to the standard
  Example: The Unit of Certification shall develop a policy….
- **Recommendation:** Indicates a recommended option(s) deemed as suitable among several possibilities (without mentioning or excluding others) for compliance to the standard
  Example: The plan should prioritise training for smallholders relevant to the 2024 RSPO P&C…
- **Permission:** Indicates a course of action permissible within the limits of the standard
  Example: The Unit of Certification may refer to other available methodologies…
- **Possibility/Capability:** Indicates a course of action or scenarios of possibility (whether material, physical, or causal) permissible within the limits of the standard
  Example: The Unit of Certification's contractors can demonstrate evidence…
- **External constraints:** Indicates constraints or obligations beyond requirements of the standard
  Example: The Unit of Certification must take into account new relevant laws or regulations when developing…

Clause/Intention	Preferred verbal form	Alternate verbal forms
Requirement	Shall	Is required to
		Has to
	Shall not	Is not allowed to
		Do/does not
Recommendation	Should	It is recommended that
	Should not	It is not recommended that
Permission	May	Is permitted/allowed to
	May not	Is not permitted/allowed to
Possibility/Capability	Can	Is able to
	Cannot	Is not able to
External Constraints	Must	-
	Must not	-

2.2.2 Syntax

The following syntax guidelines have been applied in the drafting of criteria and indicators in the 2024 RSPO P&C, aiming to be:

- **Clear:** Plain language and common words should be used so that a criterion or an indicator is straightforward, understandable and relevant. Sentences should be as short and concise as possible.
- **Specific:** For indicators, only a single aspect should be evaluated. An indicator with more than one aspect to be evaluated should be subdivided to reflect each aspect, or expressed as separate components of a single indicator.
- **Measurable:** For indicators that are outcome-based, the indicator should specify the outcome/levels of expected performance, which should be measurable and auditable during an assessment at a reasonable cost. For

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indicators that are practice-based, the indicator should specify the minimum requirements necessary, and may also specify recommendations, permissions, and/or possibilities that advance the effectiveness or results of the practice.

- **Achievable**: A criterion or an indicator should not be drafted or defined in terms of design or descriptive characteristics. A criterion or an indicator should not reference or favour any specific or particular technology, patent, or third-party tools/items, unless there is a formal agreement with RSPO that clearly governs terms of usage.
- **Tangible:** A criterion or an indicator should be written in a clear and consistent vocabulary and style. Subjective elements should be avoided, especially the usage of phrases such as 'not limited to', 'wherever possible', 'proactive(ly), 'substantial', 'adequate(ly)', 'satisfactory(ly)'.
- **Current:** A criterion or an indicator should express requirements that should be in place and present during the time of assessment, and not at a future date.

The preferred syntax structure for principles, criteria, and indicators in the 2024 RSPO P&C shall be:

Principle	A principle in the 2024 RSPO P&C should be written in the active form.
Criteria	A criterion in the 2024 RSPO P&C should be written in the active form, using the Unit of Certification/UoC as the subject. A criterion should include a requirement clause ('shall') in the first sentence. Subsequent sentences may include alternate clause forms (e.g., 'should', may') based on intention and subject.
Indicators	**Critical Indicators - Denoted by (C)** A Critical Indicator in the 2024 RSPO P&C should be written in the active form, requiring an affirmative response. A Critical Indicator should include a Requirement clause ('shall') in the first sentence. Subsequent sentences may include alternate clause forms (e.g., 'should', 'may') based on intention and subject. A Critical Indicator shall require an affirmative response or a qualitative response.
	Non-Critical Indicators - Denoted by an absence of (C) A Non-Critical Indicator may be written in an active or passive form, requiring an affirmative response. *Example: Key management documents are made available to workers and stakeholders in a language that is understood by them* or, In an active or passive form, requiring a qualitative response. *Example: Key management documents should be understood by workers and stakeholders*

2.2.3 Lists and usage of serial commas

The purpose of a list shall be made clear by its context, with items separated into individual components and numbered. In the 2024 RSPO P&C, the preferred numbering convention within lists should be based on alphabetical bullets i.e., A), B), C), D)....

Where a list is not separated and used within paragraph text, a serial comma shall be used to avoid misinterpretation and ambiguity. A serial comma is a comma placed immediately after the penultimate (second-to-last) term in a list. An example of the usage and intention of a serial comma is:

- "marketing, storing, packing for shipment, or distribution of palm oil", where it is made clear that 'packing for shipment (of palm oil)' and 'distribution (of palm oil)' are separate activities.

This guideline has been applied to avoid potential issues of interpretation and/or ambiguity, where

- "marketing, storing, packing for shipment or distribution of palm oil" may be interpreted as
  - separate activities of 'packing for shipment (of palm oil)' and 'distribution (of palm oil)'
  - or interpreted as only the activity of 'packing for shipment or packing for distribution (of palm oil)', and excludes the activity of 'distribution (of palm oil)'.

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2.2.4 Terms and definitions

A list of key terms and definitions used in the 2024 RSPO P&C and the 2024 RSPO ISH Standard is provided in Annex 1, aligned for consistency across both standards. The first instance of a key term with a definition in each criterion and each indicator will be underlined, and linked to the relevant section of Annex 1.

Key terminology used in Criteria and Indicators

Based on the 'ISO 9000 Quality Management Systems - Fundamentals and Vocabulary', the following key terminology has been adapted and generally applied in the drafting rules of the 2024 RSPO P&C.

Primary (High-level) Mechanisms			
System	A set of interrelated or interacting elements **Management System:** A set of interrelated or interacting elements of a Unit of Certification to establish policies (with objectives), and plans to achieve those objectives		
Policy	The intention and direction of a Unit of Certification as formally expressed by its management to achieve a specific objective	**Plan/ Action Plan**	A strategy with process(es) or procedure(s) to achieve a specific objective of a Unit of Certification
Secondary (Lower-level) Mechanisms			
Process	A set of interrelated or interacting activities to deliver an intended result		
Procedure	A specified way of carrying out an activity or a process		
Activity	An action taken to enhance or improve performance		

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2.3 Compliance and Certification

Compliance to the standard is strictly required and must be demonstrated against any normative indicators, requirements, and/or other normative elements identified. Non-compliances are raised by qualified auditors from accredited Certification Bodies under the independent, third-party RSPO Assurance System, overseen by Accreditation Bodies appointed by RSPO. The governing document for compliance and certification against the 2024 RSPO P&C is the 'RSPO Certification System for P&C and ISH Standards'.

Compliance to indicators differs based on criticality. A Critical Indicator is essential to compliance, and non-conformity or lack of evidence of conformity (as assessed by a qualified auditor) is graded as a Major Non-Compliance (NC). A Non-Critical Indicator, denoted by an absence of (C), is graded as a Minor NC if non-fulfilment or a lack of evidence of conformity is assessed by a qualified auditor.

2.4 Adoption, Implementation, Review, and Revision

This section defines the schedule and timeline for the implementation and reporting of compliance to the 2024 RSPO P&C, and subsequent future reviews and/or revisions.

2.4.1 Adoption Date

The 2024 RSPO P&C was formally adopted at the 21st RSPO General Assembly on 13 November 2024.

2.4.2 Effective Date

The 2024 RSPO P&C shall become effective and binding 12 months after the adoption date i.e., 13 November 2025. Prior to this effective date, the 2018 RSPO P&C (Version 3-1) shall continue to apply for all existing or potential Units of Certification. This 12-month transition period is formally adopted to assist RSPO members in the change management activities necessary to implement the 2024 RSPO P&C.

RSPO shall support RSPO members on any initiated National Interpretations (NIs) processes within this 12-month transition period. If a NI update or development for a specific country is not completed within the 12 months, the general 2024 RSPO P&C shall apply until the NI update or development is completed and endorsed by the RSPO Board of Governors.

If a supplementary or derivative document necessary for implementation of the 2024 RSPO P&C is not able to be updated or developed within the 12 months, RSPO shall provide an indicative status or timeline for completion.

2.4.3 Interim Revision I

The 2024 RSPO P&C includes an Interim Revision I mechanism, intended to allow flexibility to urgently adapt or adjust the standard if any unintended consequences or unforeseen challenges are encountered in implementation. Within the formal 12-month transition period following adoption of the 2024 RSPO P&C, RSPO shall assess and review issues of interpretation or content of requirements reported regarding the implementation of the standard, with a transparent oversight structure.

If necessary, Interim Revision I may trigger a minor revision of the standard to ensure auditability, implementability, and clarity, supported by appropriate document/process control procedures (e.g., revising Version 4-0 to Version 4-1). Interim Revision I is in line with Clause 5.8 of the 'ISEAL Code of Good Practice for Setting Social and Environmental Standards Version 6.0' and Clause 6.12 of the 'ISEAL Code of Good Practice for Sustainability Systems Version 1.0'.

2.4.4 Interim Revision II

The 2024 RSPO P&C includes an Interim Revision II mechanism, intended to allow flexibility to urgently adapt or adjust if procedural/process issues or challenges are encountered in the implementation of the standard. Interim Revision II shall be active for the 12 months following the effective date of the 2024 RSPO P&C (i.e., 13 November 2025). During the Interim

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Revision II period, RSPO shall assess and review reported issues or challenges in the procedures/processes regarding requirements and implementation of the standard, under a transparent oversight structure.

If necessary, Interim Revision II may trigger a minor revision of the standard to ensure clarity in the auditability and implementability of the standard, supported by appropriate document/process control procedures (e.g., revising Version 4-1 to Version 4-2). Interim Revision II is in line with Clause 5.8 of the 'ISEAL Code of Good Practice for Setting Social and Environmental Standards Version 6.0' and Clause 6.12 of the 'ISEAL Code of Good Practice for Sustainability Systems Version 1.0'.

2.4.5 Formal Review of the 2024 RSPO P&C

Clause 5.8, Item 1 of the 'ISEAL Code of Good Practice for Setting Social and Environmental Standards Version 6.0' and Clause 6.14 of the 'ISEAL (combined) Code of Good Practice for Sustainability Systems Version 1.0' requires that RSPO shall:

A. Review the standard at least once every five years for continued relevance and for effectiveness in meeting its stated objectives; and
B. If necessary, revise the standard in a timely manner, in line with the relevant requirements (of the ISEAL Code)

For compliance with the ISEAL Code, a formal review of the 2024 RSPO P&C shall be conducted no later than November 2029 (five years from the date of adoption).

RSPO shall also assess the continued relevance of the 2024 RSPO P&C against evolving market and regulatory trends or risks. If necessary, an urgent formal review of the standard may be initiated before the stipulated five year timeframe elapses.

2.4.6 Revision of the 2024 RSPO P&C

If the formal review of the 2024 RSPO P&C concludes that a major revision is required for continued relevance and to ensure effectiveness, RSPO shall revise the standard in line with the other relevant requirements of the ISEAL Code.

The revision should be completed within a recommended timeframe of 12 months or less, for adoption by RSPO members at an RSPO General Assembly. This is in line with Clause 5.8, Item 1 in the 'ISEAL Code of Good Practice for Setting Social and Environmental Standards Version 6.0' and Clause 6.14 of the 'ISEAL (combined) Code of Good Practice for Sustainability Systems Version 1.0'.

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III. Change Log (2024 RSPO P&C)

The following is a summary of changes made in the current version of 2024 RSPO P&C (Version 4-1) from the base version of the 2024 RSPO P&C (Version 4-0), as adopted by the 21st RSPO General Assembly on 13 November 2024. Per Section 2.4.3 (Interim Revision I) of the Preamble, procedural updates of the 2024 RSPO P&C are primarily for clarity to support implementability and auditability. Changes are categorised as an **Addition** or an **Amendment**. Minor changes (e.g., correction of phrasings or spelling mistakes, aligning formatting or content style) are noted as **Editorial**.

Section	Change	Summary of Change	Rationale of Change
Principle 6, Criterion 6.8	Amendment	**Version 4-1:** Note in Criterion 6.8 moved to Annex 5 Guidance for Indicator 6.8.1; less strict verb form applied. *National Interpretations <u>should</u> include information or national regulations governing recruitment fees and related costs, where applicable.* ***To replace:* Version 4-0** - Note in Criterion 6.8: *National Interpretations shall include information or national regulations governing recruitment fees and related costs, where applicable.*	For clarity. To avoid situations where National Interpretations are unable to include such information. Strictest verb form 'shall' is used for mandatory requirements, while 'should' is used to recommend a suitable option without being mandatory. Tabled to RSPO Standards Standing Committee; approved by the Committee as a procedural update in June 2025.
Principle 7, Indicator 7.3.4	Amendment	**Version 4-1:** Indicator 7.3.4 amended to: *In the event there is any replanting on marginal soil(s) and/or fragile soil(s), the Unit of Certification <u>should manage the area in line</u> with the 'RSPO Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Soil'.* *Procedural Note: RSPO shall develop the RSPO Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Soil' guidance document. <u>Other soil management approaches to maintain the environmental integrity of marginal soil(s) and/or fragile soil(s) may apply.</u>* ***To replace:* Version 4-0** - Indicator 7.3.4: *In the event there is any replanting on marginal soil(s) and/or fragile soil(s), the Unit of Certification <u>shall manage the area in accordance</u> with the 'RSPO Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Soil'.* *Procedural Note: RSPO shall develop the 'RSPO Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Soil' guidance document.*	For clarity. The text in Version 4-0 contained an inherent contradiction with the indicator using the strictest verb form 'shall' in reference to a guidance document that is Informative. This could cause interpretation risk and potential compliance issues. Notes from the RSPO P&C and ISH Standard Review process confirm that the intention of the guidance document is as an Informative supplement to other soil management approaches. Tabled to RSPO Standards Standing Committee; approved by the Committee as a procedural update in June 2025.
Annex 1	Amendment	**Version 4-1:** Definition of 'Medium Grower' amended to: *Medium Growers are land owners or small businesses with more than 50 ha and up to 500 ha (accumulative), who cultivate and harvest oil palms using hired labour rather than family labour. They may have diverse sources of income including from multiple crops, may not reside near their oil palm plantings and may employ administrative staff. <u>Medium growers may or may not operate mills.</u> (National Interpretation is encouraged).*	For clarity and consistency. Definition of the term 'Medium Grower' in Version 4-0 did not reflect the updated definition endorsed by the RSPO Board of Governors in September 2021 per the recommendations of the Medium Grower Task Force. Additional text to provide further clarity: for Medium Growers with mills, certification under the P&C applies, while Medium Growers without mills can be certified as a supply base under Group Certification for FFB Production.

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		***To replace:* Version 4-0 -** Definition of 'Medium Grower': *Medium Growers are beneficial owners, land owners, or businesses with more than 50 hectares (ha) and up to 500 ha (accumulative) of cultivated and harvested oil palms.*	Tabled to RSPO Standards Standing Committee; approved by the Committee as a procedural update in June 2025.
Annex 2	Addition	**Version 4-1**: Inclusion of 'Annex 2 - Key International Laws and Conventions Applicable to the Production of Palm Oil'	Pending completion of Annex, for inclusion following adoption of Version 4-0 *Note: Annex 2 is classified as Informative*
Annex 5	Amendment	**Version 4-1:** Title of Annex 5 amended to Guidance. ***To replace:* Version 4-0** - Annex 5 titled as Compliance Requirements and Informative Guidance	For clarity. The title of Annex 5 in Version 4-0 reflects an obsolete applicability. This is potentially confusing, as Annex 5 is confirmed to be Informative. Tabled to RSPO Standards Standing Committee; approved by the Committee as a procedural update in June 2025.
Annex 5	Addition	**Version 4-1:** Inclusion of 'Annex 5 - Guidance'	Pending completion of Annex, for inclusion following adoption of Version 4-0 *Note: Annex 5 is classified as Informative*
Annex 6	Amendment	**Version 4-1**: Title of the RSPO document on 'Repayment of Recruitment Fees and Related Costs' amended to Guidance. Applicability of the document clarified to be Informative. ***To replace:* Version 4-0** - The RSPO document on 'Repayment of Recruitment Fees and Related Costs' titled as Procedure and applicability classified as Normative.	For clarity. The title of the document in Version 4-0 reflects an obsolete intention of Indicator 6.8.3. This is potentially confusing. The RSPO document on 'Repayment of Recruitment Fees and Related Costs' is confirmed to as Informative and should be titled as a Guidance. Tabled to RSPO Standards Standing Committee; approved by the Committee as a procedural update in June 2025.
Document	Editorial	**Version 4-1:** Correction of minor inaccuracies (spelling, numbering, and grammar, aligned with UK English).	
Document	Editorial	**Version 4-1:** Terms with definitions (per Annex 1) have been underlined in Criteria, Indicators and Guidance, as appropriate.	Stylistic editorial amendment to clearly and visibly identify terms used in Criteria, Indicators and Guidance that have been defined in Annex 1.

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IV. Principles, Criteria, and Indicators

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Principle 1 - RSPO Growers act transparently, ethically, and responsibly

Impact Goals

The Criteria and Indicators in Principle 1 are linked to the following Long-term Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change:



Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Criteria		Indicator	
1.1	**The Unit of Certification shall demonstrate transparency and responsible conduct with relevant stakeholders on issues related to the RSPO Principles and Criteria standard. Information provided shall be in appropriate language(s) and format(s), through a transparent process, to allow for effective participation in decision-making.**	**1.1.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall make publicly available management documents specified in the RSPO Principles and Criteria standard. This excludes confidential information.
		1.1.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that process(es)/procedure(s) for consultation and communication with relevant stakeholders are documented, implemented, and made available. Explanations of such process(es)/procedure(s) shall be done by a nominated management official(s) in an appropriate language and format.
		1.1.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall maintain a list of relevant stakeholders. Records shall be maintained of any requests for information by relevant stakeholders, including the UoC's responses to such requests.
1.2	**The Unit of Certification shall commit to ethical behaviour in all business operations, transactions, and conduct.**	**1.2.1**	The Unit of Certification shall develop a policy committing to the UoC to a code of ethical conduct in all business operations and transactions. The policy shall be communicated to all levels of the workforce and operations. The policy shall include, at a minimum: A) Respect for fair conduct of business; and B) Prohibition of all forms of corruption, bribery, and fraudulent use of funds and resources*. **National Interpretations should determine relevant national regulations related to anti-corruption.*
		1.2.2	Process(es) or procedure(s) for managing ethical misconduct shall be developed and implemented.
1.3	**The Unit of Certification shall identify, address, and monitor human rights impacts in its operations, through implementation of Human Rights Due Diligence (HRDD).**	**1.3.1**	The Unit of Certification shall identify existing and potential human rights impacts within its operations and its direct suppliers, through implementation of Human Rights Due Diligence (HRDD). Existing and potential human rights impacts identified through the HRDD shall be addressed through an action plan developed by the UoC. The action plan shall be reviewed at least once every 2 years. ***Procedural Note*** *The RSPO Human Rights Working Group (HRWG) shall develop a guidance to assist members and UoCs in their compliance to Indicator 1.3.1 regarding their respective Human Rights Due Diligence obligations.* *The RSPO Human Rights Working Group (HRWG) shall develop a list of RSPO-recognised HRDD methodologies e.g., the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, OECD (Refer to Annex 4).*

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Principle 2 - RSPO Growers operate legally and with accountability

Impact Goals

The Criteria and Indicators in Principle 2 are linked to the following Long-term Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change:



Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Criteria		Indicator	
2.1	**The Unit of Certification shall operate legally, in compliance with applicable legal requirements and ratified international laws and regulations.**	**2.1.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall comply with all applicable and relevant legal requirements*. **National Interpretations shall determine all applicable national and local laws/regulations, including any ratified international laws and regulations.*
		2.1.2	A documented system to ensure legal compliance shall be developed and implemented, with process(es) in place to track changes to any applicable and relevant laws/regulations. The system shall include evidence of legal due diligence/evaluation of legal compliance of contractors.
		2.1.3 (C)	Evidence* of the Unit of Certification's legality of land operations shall be available. Legal or authorised boundaries shall be clearly demarcated and visibly maintained, and planting is within these legal or authorised boundaries. **National Interpretations shall define the evidence required based on the country's context.*
2.2	**The Unit of Certification shall engage with contractors that are legally compliant.**	**2.2.1**	The Unit of Certification shall maintain a list of the UoC's contractors*. **Contractors involved in activities within the scope of the RSPO Principles and Criteria, including contractors providing operational services, supplying labour, or supplying FFB.*
		2.2.2	All contracts involving the Unit of Certification's contractors shall require the contractor to meet and demonstrate compliance to applicable and relevant national and local laws/regulations.
		2.2.3	All contracts involving the Unit of Certification's contractors shall disallow the use of child labour, forced/trafficked labour, and collection of recruitment fees (and related costs) from workers by the contractor.
2.3	**The Unit of Certification shall source Fresh Fruit Bunches (FFB) from legal and traceable suppliers.**	**2.3.1 (C)**	For all directly sourced FFB, the mill(s) within the Unit of Certification shall obtain documentation on the FFB origins and legality. Documentation* shall include: A) Geolocation of the FFB origin; B) Evidence of legal status of the land (including tenure and user rights) of the supply base or smallholder; and C) Where applicable, evidence of a legal business licence for the buying and selling of FFB. **National Interpretations shall determine commonly accepted local practices and customs for FFB legality that are generally accepted to be on a par with legal standing or accepted by authorities (e.g., native courts).*

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		2.3.2 (C)	For all indirectly sourced FFB, the mill(s) within the Unit of Certification shall engage with such suppliers to ensure the FFB's traceability and legality. The UoC shall provide the annual percentage of its indirectly sourced FFB volume with available documentation during audits to demonstrate progress towards traceability and legality. Documentation* shall include: A) Geolocation of the FFB origin; B) Evidence of legal status of the land (including tenure and user rights) of the supply base and/or smallholder; and C) Where applicable, evidence of a legal business licence for the buying and selling of FFB. **National Interpretations shall determine commonly accepted local practices and customs for FFB legality that are generally accepted to be on a par with legal standing or accepted by authorities (e.g., native courts).*
2.4	**The Unit of Certification shall commit to uphold human rights, and to respect rights of workers and stakeholders affected by the UoC's business operations and conduct.**	**2.4.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall develop a policy or policies to respect the human rights of workers, contractors, suppliers, affected communities, and Human Rights Defenders. The policy or policies shall prohibit negative actions against affected stakeholders including Human Rights Defenders, complainants, whistleblowers, and/or community spokespersons who lodge complaints against the UoC. The policy or policies shall be publicly available.
		2.4.2	The policy or policies shall be implemented by the Unit of Certification and its contracted security services. The policy or policies shall be socialised to affected stakeholders in a language understood by them.
2.5	**The Unit of Certification shall, in consultation with relevant stakeholders, develop and implement an accessible system to manage and resolve grievances regarding its business operations and conduct.**	**2.5.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall establish and implement an accessible and impartial grievance system. The system shall: A) Ensure confidentiality or anonymity, if requested; B) Be appropriate for potential complainants, especially workers and affected communities; C) Take into account any specific needs of women and children; D) Maintain independence and impartiality in handling grievance(s); E) Not prevent the use of other judicial or non-judicial processes independent of the UoC on the same issue by either party; and F) Provide safeguards to avoid potential reprisals or intimidation of complainant(s) as the result of lodging grievance(s).

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		2.5.2	The Unit of Certification shall ensure availability, access, and socialisation of the grievance system to relevant stakeholders, especially workers and affected communities, in appropriate language(s) and format(s). Assistance shall be provided to relevant stakeholders including illiterate stakeholders or vulnerable groups who may face challenges during socialisation or gaining access to the grievance system.
		2.5.3 (C)	The status of grievance(s) shall be recorded, maintained, and kept up-to-date. All grievance(s) raised shall be responded to, and should be resolved or be in the process of resolution. Records/documentation of grievance(s) shall include: A) Steps taken to resolve grievance(s); B) Procedures outlining the timeline in addressing the raised grievance(s); C) Outcomes of grievance resolution processes; D) Unresolved grievance(s), including status, issues affecting resolution, and steps taken by UoC for potential resolution; and E) Verification that a complainant (and their representatives, if any) are updated and informed on the progress and status of a case, in a language they understand.

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Principle 3 - RSPO Growers optimise productivity, demonstrate traceability, and create positive impacts

Impact Goals

The Criteria and Indicators in Principle 3 are linked to the following Long-term Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change:



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Criteria		Indicator	
3.1	**The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement business plans to ensure long-term viability of the UoC.**	**3.1.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement a long-term business management plan. Where applicable, the plan shall include a jointly-developed business case for scheme smallholders.
		3.1.2	An annual long-term replanting plan shall be developed, and reviewed annually.
		3.1.3	The business management plan shall be reviewed annually by the UoC's management to address risks, allow adaptive business planning, and for continuous improvements.
3.2	**The Unit of Certification shall ensure that operating procedures to optimise productivity are consistently documented, implemented, and monitored.**	**3.2.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for its production operations aimed at optimising productivity.
		3.2.2	The Unit of Certification's SOPs shall be monitored for consistent implementation. Records of monitoring, and any actions taken, shall be maintained and made available.
3.3	***The Unit of Certification shall conduct a comprehensive assessment of social and environmental impacts prior to development of any new plantings or operations, with a social and environmental management & monitoring plan developed.*** **National Interpretations should determine any country-specific legal requirements, together with any other issues not required by law but are nevertheless considered important.*	**3.3.1 (C)**	In any new plantings or operations including mills, the Unit of Certification shall conduct an independent Social and Environmental Impact Assessment (SEIA). The SEIA shall be undertaken through participatory methodology involving the affected stakeholders.
		3.3.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure SEIA(s) are available, and social and environmental management & monitoring plans have been developed with the participation of affected stakeholders.
		3.3.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification's social and environment management & monitoring plan shall be implemented, reviewed, and updated at least once every two (2) years with the participation of affected communities and relevant stakeholders.
3.4	***The Unit of Certification shall manage land responsibly and adopt Good Agriculture Practices (GAPs), towards optimising FFB yields and productivity.*** **National Interpretations shall determine national legal requirements and Good Agricultural Practices related to nutrition and nutrient management of oil*	**3.4.1**	The Unit of Certification shall conduct annual estimates of its Fresh Fruit Bunch (FFB) yield potential.
		3.4.2	Changes in soil fertility and plant nutrient levels shall be monitored, documented, and managed.
		3.4.3	Good Agriculture Practices (GAPs), as contained in the Unit of Certification's Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), shall be followed to manage soil fertility, optimise yields, and minimise environmental impacts.

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	palms.		
3.5	***Supply Chain Requirements for Mills (not applicable to <u>medium growers</u> and <u>scheme smallholders</u>)*** ***Procedural Note*** *The latest version of the RSPO Supply Chain Certification (SCC) Standard shall be referred to during the auditing of indicators in Criterion 3.5.*	**3.5.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall record and make available the actual annual production tonnage of RSPO certified crude palm oil (CPO) and palm kernel (PK) at the UoC's mill(s) for the previous year or the previous 12-month period.
		3.5.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall record and make available the estimated annual production tonnage of RSPO certified crude palm oil (CPO) and palm kernel (PK) of the UoC's mill(s), based on the documented and recorded mill-specific <u>Oil Extraction Rate</u> (<u>OER</u>) and Kernel Extraction Rate (KER).
		3.5.3 (C)	**Documented Procedures** - The Unit of Certification shall have complete and up-to-date documented procedures for the implementation of all elements of the RSPO supply chain model (<u>Mass Balance</u> or <u>Identity Preserved</u>) applicable to the UoC's mill(s).
		3.5.4 (C)	**Internal Audit -** The Unit of Certification shall have a documented procedure to conduct an annual internal audit to determine whether the UoC's mill(s) conforms to the requirements in the RSPO Supply Chain Requirements for Mills *(Criterion 3.5)* and the 'RSPO Rules on Market Communications and Claims'.
		3.5.5 (C)	**Purchasing and Goods In** - The Unit of Certification shall monitor the level of FFB sourcing at its mill(s). Monitoring for the UoC's level of FFB sourcing shall include: A) Verification and documentation of the tonnage and sources of certified and non-certified FFB received; B) Informing the UoC's Certification Body immediately in cases of projected overproduction of certified volume; and C) Process(s)/procedure(s) for the handling and/or documentation of non-conforming FFB.
		3.5.6 (C)	**Sales and Goods Out** - The Unit of Certification shall ensure that key information necessary for the UoC's RSPO certified palm oil and oil palm products is complete and available in document form.
		3.5.7 (C)	**Outsourcing Activities** - The Unit of Certification shall not outsource milling activities at its mill(s). In cases where the UoC's mill(s) outsource any activities to independent third parties (e.g., subcontractors for storage or transport), the UoC shall ensure that the independent third party complies with the relevant requirements of the RSPO Supply Chain Requirements for Mills (*Criterion 3.5*).
		3.5.8 (C)	Prior to its next audit, the Unit of Certification shall record and make available in advance to its appointed Certification Body the details of all <u>contractors</u> that physically handle the UoC's RSPO certified palm oil and oil palm products.
		3.5.9 (C)	**Record Keeping -** The Unit of Certification shall maintain accurate, complete, up-to-date, and accessible records/reports covering all relevant aspects of the RSPO Supply Chain Certification (SCC)

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			Standard requirements.
		3.5.10 (C)	**Processing** - For the Identity Preserved supply chain module, the Unit of Certification shall assure and verify through documented procedures and record keeping that RSPO certified palm oil and oil palm products is kept separated from non-certified palm oil and oil palm products at the UoC's mill(s).
		3.5.11 (C)	The Unit of Certification and its mill(s) shall comply to all registration/reporting requirements for the appropriate RSPO supply chain module (Mass Balance or Identity Preserved) through the RSPO Information System.
		3.5.12 (C)	The Unit of Certification and its mill(s) shall only make sustainability claims regarding the production of RSPO certified palm oil and oil palm products that are in compliance with the 'RSPO Rules on Market Communications & Claims'.

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Principle 4 - RSPO Growers respect community and human rights, and deliver benefits

Impact Goals

The Criteria and Indicators in Principle 4 are linked to the following Long-term Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change:



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Criteria		Indicator	
4.1	**There is a mutually agreed and documented process for dealing with conflict or dispute over land and other resources which is implemented and accepted by all affected parties.**	**4.1.1 (C)**	In the event there is a conflict or dispute over land and other resources, the Unit of Certification shall have a mutually agreed process, open to all affected parties, that resolves conflict or dispute over land and other resources in an effective, timely, and appropriate manner. The process shall ensure anonymity of complainants, HRDs, community spokespersons, and whistleblowers, where requested, without risk of reprisal or intimidation, and shall follow the latest RSPO policy on respect for Human Rights Defenders.
		4.1.2	The process includes the option of access to independent legal and technical advice, the ability for complainants to choose individuals or groups to support them and/or act as observers, as well as the option of a third-party mediator.
		4.1.3	The process is understood by the affected parties, including by illiterate parties.
		4.1.4	The Unit of Certification shall keep parties to a conflict or dispute informed of its progress, including against agreed timeframes, and the outcome is available and communicated to relevant stakeholders.
4.2	**The Unit of Certification contributes to local sustainable development as agreed through consultation with local communities.**	**4.2.1**	Contributions to community development that are based on the results of consultation with local communities shall be demonstrated.
4.3	**Use of the land for oil palm does not diminish the legal, customary, or user rights of other users without their Free, Prior and Informed Consent.**	**4.3.1 (C)**	Documents showing legal ownership or lease, or authorised use of customary land authorised by customary landowners through a Free, Prior and Informed (FPIC) process. Documents related to the history of land tenure and the actual legal or customary use of the land are available.
		4.3.2	Copies of documents evidencing agreement-making processes and negotiated agreements detailing the FPIC process are available and include: A) Evidence that a plan has been developed through consultation and discussion in good faith with all affected groups in the communities, with particular assurance that vulnerable, minorities' and gender groups are consulted, and that information has been provided to all affected groups, including information on the steps that are taken to involve them in decision making; B) Evidence that the Unit of Certification has respected communities' decisions to give or withhold their consent to the operation at the time that these decisions were taken; and C) Evidence that the legal, economic, environmental, and social implications of permitting operations on their land have been understood and accepted by affected communities, including the implications for the legal status of their land at the expiry of the Unit of Certification's title, concession, or lease on the land.

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		4.3.3 (C)	Maps of an appropriate scale showing the extent of recognised legal, customary, or user rights are developed through participatory mapping involving affected parties (including neighbouring communities where applicable, and relevant authorities).
		4.3.4	All relevant information is available in appropriate forms and languages, including assessments of impacts, proposed benefit sharing, and legal arrangements.
		4.3.5 (C)	Evidence is available to show that communities are represented through institutions or representatives of their own choosing, including by legal counsel if they so choose.
		4.3.6	There is evidence that implementation of agreements negotiated through FPIC is annually reviewed in consultation with affected parties.
4.4	**No new plantings are established on local peoples' land where it can be demonstrated that there are legal, customary, or user rights, without their FPIC. This is dealt with through a documented system that enables these and other stakeholders to express their views through their own representative institutions.**	**4.4.1 (C)**	Documents showing identification and assessment of demonstrable legal, customary, and user rights are available.
		4.4.2 (C)	FPIC is obtained for all oil palm development through a comprehensive process, including in particular, full respect for their legal and customary rights to the territories, lands, and resources via local communities' own representative institutions, with all the relevant information and documents made available, with option of resourced access to independent advice through a documented, long-term and two-way process of consultation and negotiation.
		4.4.3	Evidence is available that affected local peoples understand they have the right to say 'no' to operations planned on their lands before and during initial discussions, during the stage of information gathering and associated consultations, during negotiations, and up until an agreement with the Unit of Certification is signed and ratified by these local peoples. Negotiated agreements are non-coercive and entered into voluntarily and carried out prior to new operations.
		4.4.4	To ensure local food and water security, as part of the FPIC process, participatory SEIA, and participatory land-use planning with local peoples, the full range of food and water provisioning options are considered. There is transparency of the land allocation process.
		4.4.5	Evidence is available that the affected communities and rights holders have had the option to access information and advice that is independent of the project proponent, concerning the legal, economic, environmental, and social implications of the proposed operations on their lands.
		4.4.6	Evidence is available that the communities (or their representatives) gave consent to the initial planning phases of the operations prior to the issuance of a new concession or land title to the operator.
		4.4.7	New lands will not be acquired for plantations and mills after 15 November 2018 as a result of recent (2005 or later) expropriations in the national interest without consent (eminent domain), except in cases of smallholders benefitting from agrarian reform or anti-drug programmes.
		4.4.8 (C)	New lands are not acquired in areas inhabited by communities in

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			voluntary isolation.
4.5	**Any negotiations concerning compensation for loss of legal, customary, or user rights are dealt with through a documented system that enables indigenous peoples, local communities, and other stakeholders to express their views through their own representative institutions.**	**4.5.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall develop a mutually agreed procedure for identifying legal, customary, or user rights, and ensure that a procedure for identifying people entitled to compensation is in place.
		4.5.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall develop a mutually agreed procedure for calculating and distributing fair and gender-equal compensation (monetary or otherwise) is established and implemented, monitored, and evaluated in a participatory way, and corrective actions taken as a result of this evaluation.
		4.5.3	The Unit of Certification shall provide evidence that equal opportunities are provided to both men and women to hold land titles for small holdings.
		4.5.4	The Unit of Certification shall document the process and outcomes of any negotiated agreements, compensation, and payments, with evidence of the participation of affected parties, and made publicly available to them.
4.6	**Where it can be demonstrated that local peoples have legal, customary, or user rights, they are compensated for any agreed land acquisitions and relinquishment of rights, subject to their FPIC and negotiated agreements.**	**4.6.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that a mutually agreed procedure for identifying people entitled to compensation is in place.
		4.6.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that a mutually agreed procedure for calculating and distributing fair compensation (monetary or otherwise) is in place and documented and made available to affected parties.
		4.6.3	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that communities that have lost access and rights to land for plantation expansion are given opportunities to benefit from plantation development.
4.7	**The right to use the land is demonstrated and is not legitimately contested by local people who can demonstrate that they have legal, customary, or user rights.**	**4.7.1**	Where there are or have been disputes, the Unit of Certification shall provide proof of legal acquisition of title and evidence that mutually agreed compensation has been made to all people who held legal, customary, or user rights at the time of acquisition, and provided to parties to a dispute, and that any compensation was accepted following a documented process of FPIC.
		4.7.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that land conflict is not present in its area. Where land conflict exists, the UoC ensures that acceptable conflict resolution processes (*Refer to Criteria 4.1 and 4.5*) are implemented and accepted by the parties involved. In the case of newly acquired plantations, the UoC addresses any unresolved conflict through appropriate conflict resolution mechanisms.
		4.7.3	Where there is evidence of acquisition through dispossession or forced abandonment of customary and user rights prior to the current operations and there remain parties with demonstrable customary and land use rights, the Unit of Certification ensures that these claims are settled using the relevant requirements (*Refer to Indicators 4.3.2, 4.3.3 and 4.3.4).*
		4.7.4	For any conflict or dispute over the land, the Unit of Certification shall ensure that the extent of the disputed area is mapped out in a participatory way with involvement of affected parties (including

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			neighbouring communities, where applicable).

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Principle 5 - RSPO Growers support and provide opportunities for smallholder inclusion

Impact Goals

The Criteria and Indicators in Principle 5 are linked to the following Long-term Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change:



Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Criteria		Indicator	
5.1	**The Unit of Certification shall engage and trade with interested smallholders in a fair and transparent way. Smallholder inclusion in the UoC's RSPO certified supply chain should be strengthened.**	**5.1.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement process(es)/procedure(s) to conduct fairly and transparently with all smallholders, including interested RSPO certified independent smallholders. The process(es)/procedure(s) shall include: A) Current and historical prices paid for FFB supplied to the UoC's mill(s), publicly available or upon request; B) Transparent and clear explanation of the UoC's FFB supply pricing mechanism (if requested); C) Fair pricing, including premium FFB pricing (where applicable); D) Mutual agreement of terms, schedule of activities, budget, beneficiaries, characterisation of the producers, and timeframe of payments for FFB supplied; and E) Annual inspection and verification of the UoC's FFB weighing scale by an appropriate independent third party or a government authority.
		5.1.2 (C)	Where there is a contractual agreement(s) between the Unit of Certification and smallholder(s) for FFB supply, the UoC shall provide evidence that such contractual agreement(s) are mutually agreed through a fair and transparent process.
		5.1.3 (C)	Where there is a contractual agreement(s) between the Unit of Certification and smallholder(s) for FFB supply, evidence shall be demonstrated that smallholder(s) understand key terms of such contractual agreement(s), and received payments in accordance with terms stated within. The evidence shall specify, at a minimum: A) Date of receipt/documentation; B) Price per unit of FFB supplied and timeline for payment; C) Weight of FFB supplied; D) Deductions (if any); and E) Total price paid by the UoC for FFB supplied.
		5.1.4 (C)	To support smallholder inclusion and to strengthen downstream traceability, the Unit of Certification shall actively engage, consult, and provide opportunities for all smallholders to access the UoC's RSPO certified supply chain where feasible, including interested RSPO certified independent smallholders. Where potential smallholder partnership or collaboration opportunities is identified and is feasible, the UoC shall develop mutually agreed terms or agreement(s) that specify: **For non-RSPO certified independent smallholder groups** A) Management of the RSPO certification process; B) Roles and responsibilities of the UoC and smallholders for operating the internal control system (ICS); and C) Certificate ownership. **For RSPO certified independent smallholder groups**

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			A) Distribution, handling, and marketing of physical certified FFB, where possible.
5.2	**The Unit of Certification shall support interested smallholders within its supply base to develop, operate, and improve their livelihoods; in particular interested certified independent smallholders.**	**5.2.1**	In collaboration with interested smallholders within its supply base, the Unit of Certification shall develop, implement, and review annually a smallholder support plan to improve agricultural practices. The plan shall include, at a minimum: A) Training on sustainable agricultural practices; B) Support to enhance legality of smallholder FFB production; and C) Support to identify geolocation of FFB origins.
		5.2.2	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that interested smallholders participating in its smallholder support plan are trained and can show understanding of key sustainable agricultural practices necessary to increase FFB productivity. The development of training in the plan should prioritise training(s) relevant to RSPO, aligned with the requirements/guidance of RSPO Principles and Criteria 2024, as appropriate topics and goals for smallholders.
		5.2.3	The Unit of Certification shall identify potential opportunities and implement additional activities that contribute to livelihood improvement of smallholders within its supply base. Development and implementation of the activities shall take into consideration results of participatory consultations conducted with such smallholders.

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Principle 6 - RSPO Growers respect workers' rights and working conditions

Impact Goals

The Criteria and Indicators in Principle 6 are linked to the following Long-term Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change:



Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Criteria		Indicator	
6.1	**All forms of discrimination are prohibited against all workers.**	**6.1.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall establish and implement a non-discrimination policy which is applicable to recruitment, hiring, work scope, pay and benefits, access to training, promotion, facilities, and work equipment. This policy shall be publicly available and socialised to the workforce and contractors.
		6.1.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall provide equal opportunities to all workers.
		6.1.3	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that all workers receive remuneration for work of equal value and evaluation, which is based on both their experience and the quality of their work.
6.2	**Working conditions for all workers shall meet at least legal or industry standards**	**6.2.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall establish and implement procedure(s) for recruitment, selection, hiring, promotion, retirement, suspension, and termination. The procedure(s) shall be documented, and socialised to all workers. The document shall be made available upon request.
		6.2.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that: A) Employment contracts shall set out the terms and conditions of employment in compliance with national legal requirements or any collective bargaining agreement (if applicable). The terms and conditions shall include pay, regular working hours, deductions, overtime, sick leave, leave entitlement, maternity leave, reasons for dismissal, repatriation (if applicable), and termination notice. B) The terms and conditions of the employment contract, or collective bargaining agreement, along with applicable labour laws, shall be made available and explained to workers in a language they understand prior to signing of the contract. The UoC shall acquire acknowledgment from the workers regarding their understanding of the terms and conditions of employment. C) A copy of the employment contract shall be given to the workers. D) There shall be no contract substitution. If national regulations require more than one contract to be signed by workers, the higher standard or provisions will apply. E) Any amendments to the employment contract shall be agreed to by the worker. This does not include the terms and conditions in the collective bargaining agreement, if applicable.
		6.2.3	The Unit of Certification shall demonstrate that the international migrant workers signed the UoC's employment contract in the country where they were hired.

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		6.2.4	The Unit of Certification shall maintain a worker register for up to five years from the date of workers' resignation or termination of employment, or as determined by national regulation. Records of remediation for cases of forced labour, trafficking in persons, and repayment of recruitment fees (where applicable) shall be kept for up to five years from the date of worker's resignation or termination of employment.
		6.2.5	Permanent, full-time employment is used for all core work in the Unit of Certification. Casual and short-term workers who are rehired for more than three successive times shall be provided the opportunity to become permanent full-time workers on the fourth rehiring.
		6.2.6 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that: A) All workers are paid and provided with payslips in accordance with the terms of their employment contracts (monthly, weekly, daily, or piece rate, as relevant). B) The details on the payslips, including the calculation of wages and lawful deductions, are clearly explained to the workers in a language they understand. C) Records are maintained for each and every type of worker, detailing hours worked (both regular and overtime), the calculation of wages and lawful deductions, and the actual wages paid. D) Where several members of a family are employed by the UoC, each family member shall have separate payslips. The wages earned shall be reflected in their individual payslips.
		6.2.7 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that: A) Piece-rate wages are not less than the legal piece-rate minimum wage, or the rate specified in the Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA), as applicable. Where there is no legal minimum or CBA piece-rate wage, wages shall be calculated proportionately and not less than the legal minimum wage or the CBA wage. Work targets shall be achievable within regular working hours. B) Overtime wage rate is not less than the national legal overtime rate or the rate specified in the Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA), as applicable. Where legal and CBA rates are not available, the overtime wage rate shall not be less than one-and-one-quarter times the regular wage rate. C) Where a work day is curtailed due to workplace injuries, a full day's wage is paid to the affected worker (regardless of worker type) or as per the legal or Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA) provision. Workplace injuries refer to injuries caused by

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			work-related accidents.
		6.2.8 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall provide for workers living within the Unit of Certification housing that ensures: A) Structural safety; B) At least minimum space per worker; C) Sewage and garbage disposal; D) Supply of water, including water that is safe to drink; E) Supply of electricity; F) Sanitary, washing, and cooking facilities; and G) Appropriate protection against weather elements The UoC shall ensure workers, and their families (if applicable), have access to healthcare, education (for workers' children), and welfare amenities. The facilities and amenities provided shall comply with applicable national and/or international law requirements. In cases of acquisitions of non-certified supply base by the UoC, a plan shall be developed detailing the upgrade of infrastructure, if necessary. The plan shall be implemented within 5 years from when FFB production starts and the UoC shall review the plan annually. The plan shall meet applicable national and/or international law requirements.
		6.2.9	The Unit of Certification shall ensure workers have access to safe, sufficient, and affordable food.
6.3	**Living Wage shall be paid to all workers, progressively**	**6.3.1 (C)**	Aligned with the Revised RSPO Living Wage Strategy 2023, Living Wage shall be paid to all workers. The Unit of Certification shall calculate prevailing wages annually in accordance with 'RSPO Prevailing Wage Calculation Procedure'. ***Procedural Note*** *The Unit of Certification shall use the existing 'RSPO Guidance on Calculating Prevailing Wages' until the 'RSPO Prevailing Wage Calculation Procedure' is available. Revised RSPO Living Wage Strategy 2023 has 3 key steps:* *Step One: Calculate prevailing wage* *Step Two: Identify Living Wage gaps.* *Step Three: Verify and close Living Wage gaps.*
6.4	**The Unit of Certification shall respect the rights of all workers to form and join trade unions, associations of their choice, or worker organisations with their own representatives to bargain collectively. Where the right to**	**6.4.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall establish and implement a policy recognising freedom of association, the right to collective bargaining, and Collective Bargaining Agreements (CBA), where available. This policy shall be made publicly available.

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	freedom of association and collective bargaining is restricted under law, the employer facilitates a parallel means of independent and free association and bargaining for all workers through representatives of their choice.	**6.4.2**	The Unit of Certification shall allow nomination, formation, functioning, and administration of Workers' Organisations and registered trade unions free from interference. Workers that participate in such organisations shall be protected against discrimination, retaliation, and intimidation or harassment (including threats) such as penalties or repercussion. The UoC shall provide facilities free of charge within its premises for workers to engage with each other and their representatives.
		6.4.3	The Unit of Certification shall document the minutes of meetings between the UoC and trade unions or workers' representatives. These minutes of meetings shall be accessible upon request, and shall be explained in language(s) the workers understand. The actions agreed upon at these meetings shall be implemented and status of actions is updated.
6.5	**~~There is no use of child labour~~**	**6.5.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall establish and implement a policy for the protection of children, and the prohibition and remediation for child labour. The policy shall be made publicly available. The UoC shall socialise this policy and the negative effects of child labour to the workforce, contractors, suppliers, and any other relevant stakeholders, in a language that they understand.
		6.5.2 (C)	For non-hazardous work, the Unit of Certification is permitted to employ young workers from the age of 15, following the national minimum age or the company policy's minimum age, whichever is higher. The work shall not interfere with schooling nor be harmful to their health or development. Young workers shall be paid and provided individual payslips.
		6.5.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall document and implement an age screening verification procedure. In the event child labour is found, the UoC shall conduct remediation as guided by the latest version of the 'RSPO Guidance on Child Rights for Palm Oil Producers'.
6.6	**All forms of intimidation, harassment, abuse, or violence in the workplace are prevented, mitigated, and addressed.**	**6.6.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall establish and implement a policy for prohibiting all forms of intimidation and harassment (including threats), sexual harassment, abuse, and violence. There shall be procedures for investigation, disciplinary actions/sanctions, and remediation. The policy shall be made publicly available and socialised to workforce, suppliers, and contractors in a language that they understand.
6.7	**Rights of women workers are respected and promoted and where violations are found, women shall be provided access to remediation.**	**6.7.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall establish and implement a policy to protect the rights of women workers (e.g., reproductive rights, maternal health, women's safety). The policy shall be made publicly available and socialised to the workforce in a language that they understand.

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		6.7.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall facilitate the formation of a Women's Welfare and Empowerment Committee of women workers to discuss matters such as, but not limited to, those related to discrimination, safety, grievances, or workplace issues. The Women's Welfare and Empowerment Committee shall be permitted to decide the frequency of meetings. Meetings shall be conducted in a language that is understood or spoken by its members. The UoC shall provide a safe and secure meeting place. The Unit of Certification shall respond to any issues presented by the Women's Welfare and Empowerment Committee. Any actions taken shall be documented. Where no action is taken, the UoC shall record its reasons.
		6.7.3 (C)	No work with hazardous chemicals is undertaken by pregnant or breastfeeding women workers. The Unit of Certification shall provide safe alternative work with equivalent pay to the identified women workers. Pregnancy tests shall be provided when legally mandated and with the women workers' consent.
		6.7.4	The Unit of Certification shall assess the medical and maternity needs of expectant and new mothers in consultation with them, and actions shall be taken to address the needs that have been identified.
6.8	***Forced Labour* and *Trafficking in Persons* is prohibited. Prevention and *remediation* procedures are in place.**	**6.8.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement policies and procedures on the prevention and remediation of forced labour and trafficking in persons; reference is made to International Labour Organisation (ILO)'s Indicators of Forced Labour. The policies and procedures shall be made publicly available and socialised to the workforce, suppliers, and contractors in a language that they understand. Where migrant workers are employed, specific labour procedures shall be established and implemented. Where third party labour recruiters are used, the Unit of Certification shall conduct an evaluation of them against Indicator 6.8.1 (C).
		6.8.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that there is no debt bondage, withholding of wages, or collection of any payments directly or indirectly, including through deductions from wages and/or benefits. This includes, but is not limited to, the following: A) Wage deductions due to inability to meet unachievable work targets; B) Allowing wage arrears to accumulate due to delayed payment (beyond the payment date agreed in the employment contracts) or non-payment of wages; C) Deception in the calculation and payment of wages, including unlawful wage deductions;

			D) Requiring workers to pay deposits to the Unit of Certification; E) Wage advances and loans (and related interest rates) which exceed the limits prescribed by law; and F) Recruitment fees and related costs
		6.8.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall repay active workers (as of, and from, the adoption date of the RSPO Principles & Criteria 2024) who have paid recruitment fees or related costs.
		6.8.4 (C)	Workers' government-issued identity documents and other personal documents shall not be kept by the Unit of Certification. These documents may be handed to the UoC, or those acting on its behalf, for mandatory legal or immigration processing purposes with the consent of the workers, and shall be returned without undue delay. Secure storage for these documents shall be provided for those workers who are accommodated by the UoC and shall be freely accessible to the workers.
		6.8.5 (C)	Workers shall be able to enter or exit the Unit of Certification's work and accommodation premises in accordance with reasonable measures related to health, safety, security, and employment terms.
		6.8.6 (C)	Workers who live on-site shall have access to transport and/or means of communication (e.g., telephones, SIM cards, phone credits). Restriction of transport and/or communication shall not be used as a disciplinary measure.
		6.8.7 (C)	For overtime work, informed consent of the worker shall be obtained. The total working hours shall allow for breaks and rest periods during a working day, as determined by local and/or national laws, including at least 24 consecutive hours of rest in every 7-day period. When work is offered on rest days, informed consent of the worker must be obtained, and they may work for not more than 14 days continuously.
		6.8.8 (C)	Workers shall have the right to enter into, and terminate, their employment. Termination of contract(s) shall be in accordance with their terms of employment. Penalty for termination of employment is prohibited.
6.9	**The Unit of Certification shall implement health and safety practices to protect workers from occupational illness, disease, and injury.**	**6.9.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall establish and implement Occupational Health and Safety policies. The policies shall be made publicly available and socialised to the workforce in a language that they understand. The policies shall include provisions that will: A) Assure a safe and healthy working place; B) Prevent work-related illnesses, diseases, and injuries; C) Create a mechanism for workers to report and raise health and safety issues, including work related accidents, illnesses, diseases, injuries, and emergencies; D) Comply with applicable national laws and Collective Bargaining

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			Agreements (where applicable); E) Provide access to water that is safe to drink at workplace; and F) Establish roles and responsibilities of the Unit of Certification, Health & Safety Committees, and workers in relation to health and safety.
		6.9.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall establish Health and Safety (H&S) Committees at its mill(s) and estate(s). The H&S Committee shall include members from management, worker representatives, worker organisations, and registered trade unions (where applicable). The H&S Committee meetings shall be conducted in a language understood by all members. The UoC shall respond to any issues raised by the H&S Committee. The committee shall meet quarterly. The Unit of Certification shall be responsible for the following matters which are managed through its H&S Committee: A) Workplace health and safety issues, including regular worksite safety inspections, training, and continuous improvements; B) Review Hazard Identification, Risk Assessment and Risk Control (HIRARC), in consultation with Health and Safety (H&S) Committees; C) Identification of the necessary controls for the elimination of workplace hazards; D) Identification, safe storage, mixing, and usage of chemicals including pesticides in the workplace, and establishing a documented procedure for the safe storage, handling, mixing, use, and safe disposal of chemicals; E) Continued improvement of the management system to enhance its H&S performance; F) Concerns raised by workers about health, safety, and welfare; and G) Collaborate with the Women's Welfare and Empowerment Committee to address specific health and safety risks for women workers.
		6.9.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall conduct Hazard Identification, Risk Assessment and Risk Control (HIRARC) at its mill(s) and estate(s) respectively, to identify health and safety issues including gender-specific impacts (e.g., impact of pesticides on reproductive health, pregnant women, young workers), suitable job-specific Personal Protection Equipment (PPE), and persons with disabilities. The HIRARC shall be conducted by competent personnel* who has been trained in HIRARC assessment. The HIRARC shall be reviewed and approved by an authorised health and safety officer. **National Interpretations should identify requirements for competent personnel.*
		6.9.4 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement risk mitigation practices and corrective actions (a 'H&S Plan') in consultation with the Health and Safety (H&S) Committees for both

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			its mill(s) and estate(s), based on the UoC's HIRARC. The H&S Plan shall be monitored and reviewed annually.
		6.9.5 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall provide suitable, appropriate, and good conditioned PPE (as determined by the HIRARC assessment) to all workers, free of charge. Workers shall receive training on the importance of proper use and maintenance of essential PPE. Records of the PPE issuance shall be documented and maintained. When there is a need for replacement, it shall be provided free of charge. Sanitation facilities shall be made available for workers applying hazardous chemicals to change out of PPE, wash, and wear their personal clothing. A designated area for washing PPE shall be provided.
		6.9.6 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall provide training on updated job-specific occupational health and safety procedures to relevant workers (e.g., operational supervisors), taking into account gender-specific needs, in a form and language that they understand. The UoC shall conduct assessment of the training conducted, and records of assessment and training shall be maintained.
		6.9.7	The Unit of Certification shall assign personnel trained in first aid to all operations. Workers shall have access to first aid kits at all times.
		6.9.8	The Unit of Certification shall establish an Emergency Response Procedure (ERP) in accordance with the risk assessment conducted by the UoC. The ERP shall be made available and socialised to the workforce in a language that they understand. The ERP shall include: A) Establishment of an Emergency Response Team (ERT) trained in first aid to provide emergency response in all operations; B) Contact details of personnel responsible for emergencies; C) Contact details and address of nearest medical facilities (e.g., dispensaries, medical practitioners); and D) Safety drills (e.g., fire evacuation). The ERP shall be reviewed annually, and results of the review shall be documented.
		6.9.9 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall provide annual medical surveillance for workers handling hazardous chemicals, free of charge. Actions to treat related health conditions shall be documented.
		6.9.10	The Unit of Certification shall record occupational injuries and illnesses using Lost Time Incidents (LTI) metrics. Processes to investigate work-related incidents shall be developed and implemented. Reports of the investigation shall be documented.

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		6.9.11	The Unit of Certification shall provide all workers with medical care and be covered by accident insurance. Costs incurred from work-related incidents leading to illness, disease, or injury are covered in accordance with national law or by the UoC where national law does not offer protection.
		6.9.12 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall ensure that only trained workers handle, use, or apply chemicals in accordance with the manufacturers' or suppliers' instructions and precautions. Personnel handling, using, or applying chemicals must demonstrate up-to-date understanding and knowledge related to their assigned tasks.

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Principle 7 - RSPO Growers protect, conserve, and enhance ecosystems as responsible environmental stewards

Impact Goals

The Criteria and Indicators in Principle 7 are linked to the following Long-term Outcomes in the RSPO Theory of Change:



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Criteria		Indicator	
7.1	**The Unit of Certification shall practise Integrated Pest Management to effectively manage pests, diseases, weeds and invasive introduced species.** **National Interpretations shall determine any nationally regulated and/or industrial specific controls, measures, best practices, and thresholds. This may include:* *A) Prohibited chemical pesticides;* *B) Controlled chemical pesticides;* *C) Use of biological control agents;* *D) Prophylactic use;* *E) Aerial spraying; and* *F) Medical surveillance.*	**7.1.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement an Integrated Pest Management (IPM) plan to mitigate negative impacts of unsustainable pest management methods on the environment and human health.
		7.1.2 (C)	Restricted and hazardous pesticides that endanger the health of workers, families, communities, or the environment shall not be used, unless in exceptional circumstances as validated by a due diligence process or when authorised by government authorities for pest outbreaks. This shall include pesticides that are: A) Categorised as World Health Organization Class 1A or 1B; B) Meet the criteria for carcinogenicity Categories 1A and 1B, mutagenicity Categories 1A and 1B, or reproductive toxicity Categories 1A and 1B, according to the Globally Harmonized System on Classification and Labelling of Chemicals (GHS); C) Listed by the Stockholm or Rotterdam Conventions; D) Restricted or prohibited under national regulations; and/or E) Paraquat.
		7.1.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall record all pesticides usage. Records shall include the pesticide's trade name, active ingredient, LD50, quantity of active ingredient used, period of usage, location/area of application, and reason for usage.
		7.1.4 (C)	There shall be no prophylactic use of pesticides, unless in exceptional circumstances, as identified in national best practice guidelines.
		7.1.5 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall not launch aerial sprayings of pesticides, unless in exceptional circumstances where no other viable alternatives are available. When aerial spraying is unavoidable, prior approval from government authorities shall be obtained and detailed information of the aerial spraying shall be provided to potentially affected local communities at least 48 hours prior to application of aerial spraying. Targeted spraying with unmanned aerial vehicles (drones) is permitted.
		7.1.6 (C)	The introduction of species referenced in the Global Invasive Species Database and/or CABI Digital Library and/or national regulation shall be prohibited.
		7.1.7 (C)	Where the use of the invasive or prohibited species was already in place before November 2024, the Unit of Certification shall manage the usage of such species in line with internationally accepted scientific protocols or national regulations.
		7.1.8	The use of fire for pest or disease control shall be prohibited, unless in exceptional circumstances. Where fire must be used for control of pests and diseases, the

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			Unit of Certification shall provide evidence of prior approval from government authorities and implement a plan to prevent, mitigate, and/or repair damages to the environment.
7.2	**The Unit of Certification shall reduce, recycle, reuse, and dispose of waste/by-products in an environmentally and socially responsible manner.**	**7.2.1**	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement a waste management plan to reduce, minimise, recycle, and reuse waste produced from its operations and non-operational activities. The plan shall also include responsible disposal of waste or by-products, where applicable.
		7.2.2	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement a nutrient recycling plan. The nutrient recycling plan shall include the recycling of biomass (i.e., Empty Fruit Bunches/EFB, Palm Oil Mill Effluent/POME, palm residues) and optimal use of inorganic fertilisers.
		7.2.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall demonstrate that workers have job-specific training to implement the waste management plan.
		7.2.4	The use of fire as a measure for waste disposal shall be prohibited, unless in exceptional circumstances. Direct disposal of waste into watercourses or other ecosystems shall be prohibited.
7.3	**The Unit of Certification shall not conduct new plantings on steep terrain, marginal soil(s), and fragile soil(s). The UoC shall adopt best soil conservation practices for minimising soil erosion and soil degradation in these areas.** **National Interpretations should determine nationally regulated specific controls (best practices) and thresholds, such as slope limits, specifying soil types (marginal and/or fragile) on which planting should be avoided, or the proportion of plantation area that may be allowed. National Interpretation may include expanded definitions of 'extensive planting', 'marginal soil', 'fragile soil', and 'steep slope'.*	**7.3.1 (C)**	Areas of steep terrain, marginal soil(s), and fragile soil(s) shall be identified and mapped. Soil surveys and topographic information shall guide the planning of drainage and irrigation systems, roads, and other infrastructure of the Unit of Certification. To demonstrate the long-term suitability of land for oil palm cultivation, soil maps or soil surveys identifying marginal and fragile soils, including steep terrain, shall be taken into account in plans and operations.
		7.3.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall not conduct new plantings and extensive replanting of oil palm on steep terrain.
		7.3.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall not conduct new plantings and/or new development on marginal soil(s) and/or fragile soil(s). ***Procedural Note*** *The RSPO New Planting Procedure shall be updated to reflect this requirement.*
		7.3.4 (C)	In the event there is any replanting on marginal soil(s) and/or fragile soil(s), the Unit of Certification should manage the area in line with the 'RSPO Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Soil'. ***Procedural Note*** *RSPO shall develop the 'RSPO Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Soil' guidance document. Other soil management approaches to maintain the environmental integrity of marginal soil(s) and/or fragile soil(s) may apply.*

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7.4	**The Unit of Certification shall prohibit land clearing on peatland (regardless of depth) after the cut-off date of 15 November 2018. All plantings on peatland before the cut-off date shall be managed responsibly. All unplanted and set-aside peatlands are protected and conserved.**	**7.4.1 (C)**	There shall be no new plantings and/or development on peatlands, regardless of depth, after 15 November 2018.
		7.4.2	The Unit of Certification shall map and have inventories of all areas of peatlands (planted and unplanted) in accordance with RSPO procedures on Peat Inventory. The UoC shall make its map and other inventory information available to the RSPO Secretariat.
		7.4.3 (C)	Any activities by the Unit of Certification that may disrupt peatland ecosystem integrity or hydrology including new construction of drains, roads, dams, bunds, levees, and/or power lines on unplanted and set-aside peatlands shall be prohibited.
		7.4.4 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall protect and manage all unplanted and set-aside peatlands, guided by the latest version of 'RSPO Manual on Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Management and Rehabilitation of Peatlands' and associated audit guidance.
		7.4.5 (C)	All existing plantings on peat are managed according to the latest version of 'RSPO Manual on Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Existing Oil Palm Cultivation on Peat' and associated audit guidance.
		7.4.6 (C)	To determine the suitability of replanting on peat, the Unit of Certification shall conduct a drainability assessment for oil palm planted on peat in accordance with the latest 'RSPO Drainability Assessment Procedure'.
		7.4.7 (C)	Where a RSPO Drainability Assessment report indicates a phasing out of oil palm cultivation of at least 40 years, or two cycles (whichever is greater), before reaching the natural gravity drainability limit for peat, the Unit of Certification shall develop and implement a plan to replace with crops suitable for a higher water table (e.g., paludiculture) or to rehabilitate with natural vegetation.
7.5	**The Unit of Certification shall demonstrate efforts to maintain the quality and availability of surface and groundwater, and mitigate/remedy those that occur.**	**7.5.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement a water management plan* to promote more efficient use to maintain quality, and continued availability of surface and groundwater, in consultation with affected communities. The plan shall address the following: A) The UoC does not restrict access to clean water or contribute to pollution of water used by communities; and B) Workers shall have adequate access to clean water. **National Interpretations should further define the process and developing the water management plan, based on the national context.*

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

		7.5.2	The Unit of Certification shall record water consumption (mill water use per metric tonne of product) and water withdrawal (total water volume extracted from surface and groundwater source) at the UoC's mill(s).
		7.5.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall protect watercourses and wetlands by maintaining and restoring appropriate riparian reserves and other buffer zones, in line with the latest version of the 'RSPO Manual on Best Management Practices (BMPs) for the Management and Rehabilitation of Riparian Reserves'.
		7.5.4 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall treat and process palm oil mill effluent (POME) in compliance with applicable national regulations. Discharge quantity and quality of the palm oil mill effluent, especially Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD), shall be regularly monitored.
7.6	**The Unit of Certification shall demonstrate efforts to minimise and reduce greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, air pollution associated with its existing activities and new developments, and reduce fossil fuel consumption by optimising the use of renewable energy.**	**7.6.1 (C)**	The Unit of Certification shall identify and assess its greenhouse gas emissions (GHG) through the latest version of RSPO PalmGHG calculator to develop and implement an emissions reduction plan. The plan to reduce or minimise GHG emissions shall be implemented and monitored.
		7.6.2 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall publicly report its GHG emissions per product, as estimated through the latest version of RSPO PalmGHG calculator.
		7.6.3 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall estimate the carbon stock of the proposed development area and major potential sources of emissions that may result directly from the development since 2014. The Unit of Certification shall prepare and implement a plan to protect the carbon stock, following the 'RSPO GHG Assessment Procedure for New Development'.
		7.6.4 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement a plan to reduce or minimise significant air pollutants (apart from greenhouse gases). **National Interpretations should determine any relevant national air pollution standards or thresholds.*
		7.6.5 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall prohibit the use of fire for land preparation of new plantings, development, and/or replanting.
		7.6.6	The Unit of Certification shall develop and implement fire prevention process(es)/procedure(s) to reduce fire risk in all areas under the UoC. The process/procedure should be developed in engagement with relevant stakeholders.
		7.6.7	A plan for improving the efficiency of, or minimising, fossil fuel usage shall be developed and implemented. The plan shall consider the role and usage of renewable energy to replace or reduce fossil fuels.

Adopted 18 Nov 2024

7.7	**Land clearing does not cause deforestation or damage any area required to protect and/or enhance High Conservation Values (HCVs) and/or High Carbon Stock (HCS) forests. HCVs and HCS forests in the managed area are identified, protected, and/or enhanced.** ***Preamble*** *The RSPO will develop a procedure for development in High Forest Cover Landscapes (HFCLs) within High Forest Cover Countries (HFCCs), to enable certified development by indigenous peoples and local communities with legal or customary rights, to balance sustainable livelihoods and poverty reduction with the need to conserve, protect, and enhance ecosystems.* *This procedure will take into consideration regional and national multi-stakeholder processes and will be designed to enable communities to choose their own development path, while providing socio-economic benefits and safeguards. The procedure should aim to provide:* *A) Demonstrable benefits to the local community;* *B) Clear recognition of legal and customary lands based on participatory land use planning;* *C) Development proportional to the needs of the local community; and* *D) A balance between conservation and development. This procedure will also cover planting on previous or abandoned agricultural land/plantations in such landscapes.*	**7.7.1 (C)**	A Unit of Certification shall not damage primary forest and HCVs (from November 2005) and HCS forests (from 15 November 2018). HCVs, HCS forests, and other conservation areas are identified for protection according to the following scenarios: 1) A Unit of Certification (or parts thereof) with existing plantations and no new land clearing (after November 2018) shall provide evidence of a valid HCV assessment. 2) A Unit of Certification (or parts thereof) that followed the transitional measures in P&C 2018 (Refer to 'Interpretation of Indicator 7.12.2 and Annex 5 of RSPO P&C 2018') shall provide evidence that a valid HCV, and/or standalone HCSA assessment, and/or Integrated HCV-HCS assessment (as applicable) was conducted before any new land clearing. 3) A Unit of Certification (or parts thereof) not covered by Scenario 2 with any new land clearing after 15 November 2018 shall provide evidence that: a) Land clearing is preceded by an Assessor Licensing Scheme (ALS) integrated HCV-HCS assessment, using the Integrated HCV-HCSA Assessment Manual valid at the time of the assessment (either the November 2017 or June 2023 version of the Manual). b) Compliance with the requirements of the New Planting Procedure (NPP) 2015, and subsequent revisions of the NPP. ***Procedural Note*** *For details of the scenarios, refer to Annex 3 (to be developed and approved by the RSPO Standards Standing Committee). Annex 3 will be based on the 'Interpretation of Indicator 7.12.2 and Annex 5 of RSPO P&C 2018', to be updated for validity.*
		7.7.2 (C)	For all land clearing since November 2005, the Unit of Certification shall provide evidence of a historic Land Use Change Analysis (LUCA). Where there has been land clearing without prior HCV assessment since November 2005, or without a prior Integrated HCV-HCSA Assessment since 15 November 2018, the 'RSPO Remediation and Compensation Procedure (RaCP)' applies.

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

		7.7.3 (C)	Where HCVs and/or HCS forests have been identified, the Unit of Certification shall develop and implement a management & monitoring plan to protect and/or enhance HCVs and/or HCS forests. This plan shall make clear the roles of affected communities in implementation; shall be developed in consultation with relevant stakeholders; and shall include the directly managed area and any relevant wider landscape level considerations (where these are identified). This management & monitoring plan shall include, but is not limited to the following (if applicable): A) All RTE species (HCV-1); B) Management of human-wildlife conflict (threats to HCVs); C) Other conservation areas; and D) A programme to socialise the status of RTE species to the workforce.
		7.7.4 (C)	The Unit of Certification shall adapt, where necessary, the management & monitoring plan to protect and/or enhance HCVs and/or HCS forests (Refer to Indicator 7.7.3). The plan shall be reviewed at least once every five years. Outcomes of the monitoring activities shall be used to update the management & monitoring plan. ***Procedural Note*** *RSPO shall develop a guidance on changes in HCV conditions and status to support implementation of the management & monitoring plan.*
		7.7.5	Where rights of local communities have been identified in HCV areas, HCS forest after 15 November 2018, and other conservation areas, there is no diminishment of these rights without evidence of a negotiated agreement, obtained through FPIC.

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

V. Annexes

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Annex 1 - Terms and definitions

Term	Definition	Source
Active ingredients	Chemical substances that provide the pesticidal actions.	Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides (FAO & WHO, 2016)
Adapt	To modify or adjust the previously developed management & monitoring plan in response to changing conditions, outcomes, or new information, ensuring the continuous protection and enhancement of key elements (such as HCVs and HCS forests). This process includes streamlining documentation and findings from other processes, such as accident logs and grievance mechanisms.	RSPO P&C 2024
Aerial spraying	Application of pesticides from an aircraft (plane or helicopter).	Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides (FAO & WHO, 2016)
Abuse of vulnerability	Taking advantage of any worker of their vulnerabilities for the purposes of exploitation or gain. Abuse of a position of vulnerability refers to any situation in which the worker involved believes he or she has no real and acceptable alternative except to submit to the abuse.	RSPO P&C 2024
Affected Communities	All communities that are likely to be affected directly and significantly by the proposed development, i.e., those with land holdings and usage rights within the affected area who must be included in the assessment and FPIC process. Other communities that are likely to be affected only indirectly, e.g., by possible longer-term changes to the ecosystem services provisions due to the water usage of the operation, also need to be taken into account.	RSPO Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) Guide (2022)
Agreement	An arrangement or decision by two or more parties to do or not to do something. This can be formal or informal, and depending on the common intention of the parties may be enforceable by law.	RSPO P&C 2024
Alternate Land Development Strategies	Allocation of smallholder plot(s) as conservation or restoration areas with the main objective to improve and maintain peatland ecosystem integrity.	RSPO ISH standard 2024
Annual Surveillance Audit	Annual systematic repetition of conformity assessment activities as a basis for maintaining the validity of RSPO certification.	RSPO Certification Systems for Principles & Criteria and Independent Smallholder Standards (2024)
Associated Development	Developments including establishing mills, kernel crushers, nurseries, housing/camps and offices, roads/tracks, drainage, effluent treatment plants, fruit collection centres, terracing, earthworks, scheme smallholdings/outgrower plots, and any other development relevant to the operations of a new oil palm development.	RSPO New Planting Procedure (2015)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD)	Biochemical Oxygen Demand is the amount of dissolved oxygen (DO) needed (i.e., demanded) by aerobic biological organisms to break down organic material present in a given water sample at a certain temperature over a specific time period.	RSPO P&C 2024
Biological control agent	Refers to the use of natural or modified organisms, genes, or gene products to reduce the effects of undesirable organisms and to favour desirable organisms such as crops, beneficial insects, and microorganisms.	Biological Control Agents: Diversity, Ecological Significances, and Biotechnological Applications' (Singh et al., 2020)
Bribery	The offering, promising, giving, accepting, or soliciting of an advantage as an inducement for an action which is illegal, unethical, or a breach of trust. Inducements can take the form of money, gifts, loans, fees, rewards, or other advantages (taxes, services, donations, favours etc.).	Global Anti Bribery Guidance (Transparency International, 2017)
Child/Children	The term child or children applies to all persons under the age of 18.	ILO Minimum Age Convention, 1973 (No. 138) ILO Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No. 182)
Child labour	Child labour is work that deprives children of their childhood, their potential, and their dignity, and that is harmful to physical and mental development. The term applies to: - All children under 18 involved in the “worst forms of child labour”, per the ILO Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No. 182); - All children aged under 12 taking part in economic activity; and - All 12 to 14-year-olds engaged in more than light work. The ILO defines 'light work' as work that is not likely to be harmful to children’s health or development and not likely to be detrimental to their attendance at school or vocational training. Those under 18 years old should not engage in hazardous work that might jeopardise their physical, mental, or moral well-being, either because of its nature or the conditions under which it is carried out. For young workers above the legal minimum age but below 18, there should be restrictions on hours of work and overtime; working at dangerous heights; with dangerous machinery, equipment and tools; transport of heavy loads; exposure to hazardous substances or processes; and difficult conditions such as night work at night.	ILO Minimum Age Convention, 1973 (No. 138) ILO Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No. 182) International Programme on the Elimination of Child Labour (IPEC), ILO (1992)

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

Child labour remediation	Child labour remediation refers to the process of removing a child from a child labour situation to ensure safe and adequate alternatives for them, such as reintegrating them into the education system or, if they are above the minimum age for work, creating an opportunity for them to work in a non-hazardous job.	RSPO Guidance on Child Rights for Palm Oil Producers (2020)
Communities	Communities refer to indigenous peoples, tribal peoples, local communities (including women, children, and people with disabilities), displaced persons, migrants, and other land users.	RSPO P&C 2018
Confidential information/ Confidentiality	Examples of commercially confidential information include financial data such as costs and income, and details relating to customers and/or suppliers. Data that affects personal privacy should also be confidential. Ongoing disputes (within or outside of a legal mechanism) can be considered as confidential information where disclosure could result in potential negative outcomes for all parties involved. However, affected stakeholders and those seeking resolution to conflict should have access to relevant information. Examples of information where disclosure could result in potential negative environmental or social outcomes include information on sites of rare species where disclosure could increase the risk of hunting or capture for trade, or sacred sites which a community wishes to maintain as private.	RSPO P&C 2024
Conflict resolution process	A conflict resolution process is any process that can either prevent, diffuse, or address conflict effectively, whether such conflict occurs between the Unit of Certification and communities, or between affected communities themselves.	Adapted from Designing Conflict Resolution Systems (Mediators Beyond Borders, online; accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://mediatorsbeyondborders.org/what-we-do/conflict-literacy-framework/cr-systems-design)
Contract	An agreement between two or more parties that, by its terms, is legally binding and enforceable in a court of law.	RSPO P&C 2024
Contract substitution	The practice of substituting or changing the terms of employment to which the worker originally agreed, either in writing or verbally, which results in worse conditions or less benefits. Changes to the employment agreement or contract are prohibited unless these changes are made to meet local law and provide equal or better terms.	ILO Report of the Committee examining alleged non-observance by Qatar of the Forced Labour Convention, 1930 (No. 29), (ILO, 2014)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Contributing family members	Family or smallholder household members who do not receive a wage/salary or profit in return for the work performed on the smallholder plot. They may benefit in-kind or receive irregular payments in cash as a result of the outputs of their work. Please refer to other related definitions: 'smallholder household' and 'family members'.	Adapted from the International Classification of Status in Employment (ICSE-18) Manual 2023; and the ILO Private Employment Agencies Convention, 1997 (No. 181)
Contractor	A person, firm, organisation, or company that undertakes a contract with the Unit of Certification to provide materials or services (including labour).	RSPO P&C 2024
Core work	The primary area or activity that a company was founded to do or focuses on in its business operations. Core work pertains to work that is essential and desirable to the growth of the company. All agricultural and milling activities are considered core work, i.e. planting, harvesting, fertilising, maintenance, FFB sorting and grading, machine-technical maintenance; and machine operation.	RSPO P&C 2018
Debt bondage	Debt bondage is work exchanged for a debt. It is also known as bonded labour or debt slavery, which occurs when individuals are compelled to work in exchange for repayment of a debt. Workers are often coerced into labour under the pretext of settling their own debts or those of family members.	ILO Helpdesk: Business and Forced Labour (online; accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://www.ilo.org/resource/other/ilo-helpdesk-business-and-forced-labour)
Deception	Deception pertains to the act of providing false representations and failing to fulfil promises made to workers, whether communicated verbally or in writing. Deceptive recruitment practices can include false promises regarding working conditions and wages, but also regarding the type of work, housing and living conditions, acquisition of regular migration status, job location, or the identity of the employer.	Adapted from the ILO '11 Indicators on Forced Labour' (International Labour Organization, 2012)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Deforestation	The conversion of forests - including primary, regenerated (second-growth), and managed natural forests, as well as areas identified through High Conservation Value (HCV) and High Carbon Stock (HCS) assessments required by the RSPO - into non-forest land use. This process involves the removal of trees and the alteration of ecosystems, resulting in the loss of species composition, ecological structure, and function. Forests at risk of deforestation include: - Primary forests, which have developed naturally without significant human intervention. - Regenerated forests, which have recovered from past impacts but now function similarly to natural ecosystems. - Managed natural forests, where human activities like timber harvesting or low-intensity agriculture occur without severely impacting the forest's ecological integrity. - Partially degraded forests, where degradation has not resulted in a complete transformation of land use or a sustained reduction in ecological function. HCV and HCS assessments help identify these forests as critical for biodiversity, ecosystem services, and carbon storage. Deforestation of such areas compromises both environmental sustainability and efforts to combat climate change, emphasising the need for strong safeguards and responsible land management practices.	RSPO P&C 2024
Development	Development refers to alteration of landscape in any number of ways: from natural or semi-natural state of the land, to land for the purposes of palm oil production. This includes the carrying out of building (construction, installation or expansion of a building or other structures), engineering, creation of impervious surfaces or other operations in, on, over. or under land; or making of any material change in the use of any building or other land.	RSPO P&C 2024
Discrimination	Any distinction, exclusion, or preference made on the basis of race, colour, sex, religion, political opinion, national extraction, or social origin, which has the effect of nullifying or impairing equality of opportunity or treatment in employment or occupation; Such other distinction, exclusion, or preference which has the effect of nullifying or impairing equality of opportunity or treatment in employment or occupation as may be determined after consultation with representative employers' and workers' organisations, where such exist, and with other appropriate bodies.	United Nations Human Rights Office of the High Commissioner, Discrimination (Employment and Occupation) Convention, 1958 (No. 111)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Drainability Assessment Procedure (DAP)	A methodology for determining how the projected future subsidence would affect the relative level of the fields and the respective drainage outlet from the plantation and the ability of water to drain by gravity in the future. In implementing the DAP, the Unit of Certification shall: - Describe the characteristics of the plantation and the proposed replanting area; - Determine drainage zone(s) and identify the final water outlets; - Determine the average ground elevation and calculate elevation of peatland replanting area; - Determine the annual water level at the final water outlets; - Measure the peat thickness and calculate average peat thickness of peatland replanting area; - Calculate average Natural Drainage Limit (NDL) of each peatland replanting area; - Calculate the depth to NDL of each peatland replanting area; - Use the default subsidence rate or calculate the average subsidence rate of each peatland replanting area; and - Project the future drainability of peatland replanting area.	RSPO Drainability Assessment Procedure 2021
Due diligence	A risk management process implemented by a company to identify, prevent, mitigate, and account for how it addresses environmental and social risks and impacts in its operations, supply chains, and investments.	Adapted from the Accountability Framework Initiative (2020)
Engage	The act of participating, becoming involved, entering into, or maintaining an agreement or contract.	RSPO P&C 2024
Expropriation	The act by authorities (governments and/or any other institution exercising governmental functions) to acquire private property or divesting interest in land without obtaining agreement and consent, and which may or may not be with the payment of compensation.	RSPO P&C 2024
Ethical recruitment	Hiring workers lawfully and in a fair and transparent manner that respects and protects their rights	IRIS Standards: Ethical Recruitment, (International Organization for Migration, 2020)
Existing Plantations	Land planted with oil palm and associated development owned and/or directly managed by an RSPO member prior to and during its RSPO membership. This includes newly acquired oil palm plantations by an RSPO member.	RSPO P&C 2024
Extensive replanting on steep terrain	Any individual, contiguous replanted area on steep terrain (>25 degrees) greater than 25 hectares within the replanting area.	RSPO P&C 2024

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Family farm	A farm operated and mostly owned by a family, for the growing of oil palm, sometimes along with subsistence production of other crops, and where the family provides the majority of the labour used. Such farms provide the principal source of income, and the planted area of oil palm is below 50 hectares in size.	Adapted from Free, Prior and Informed Consent Guide for RSPO Members (2015)
Family members	Family members refer specifically to individuals within the nuclear family structure. This includes parents, siblings, and children who are directly related by blood, marriage, or adopted. Excluded from this definition are extended family members such as aunts, uncles, grandparents, and cousins. The focus is on the immediate family unit, emphasising the core relationships that typically reside within the same household. Please refer to other related definitions: 'smallholder household' and 'contributing family members'.	RSPO ISH standard 2024
Forced labour	All work or service which is exacted from any person under the menace of any penalty, and for which said person has not offered him or herself voluntarily.	ILO Forced Labour Convention, 1930 (No. 29)
Forest	Natural ecosystem characterised by a significant tree cover, with species composition, structure, and ecological functions that support biodiversity, carbon storage, and other ecosystem services as identified through High Conservation Value (HCV) and High Carbon Stock (HCS) assessments required by the RSPO. This includes: - Primary forests, untouched by significant human activities and developed through natural processes. - Regenerated forests, which have recovered after past disturbances and now resemble natural ecosystems in terms of structure and function. - Managed natural forests, where human activities like timber extraction or small-scale agriculture occur, but the forest retains its overall ecological integrity. - Partially degraded forests, which have been impacted by natural or anthropogenic factors but still maintain enough tree cover and ecological functions to be classified as forests.	RSPO P&C 2024
Fragile soil	A soil that is susceptible to degradation (i.e., reduction in fertility) when disturbed. A soil is particularly fragile if the degradation rapidly leads to an unacceptably low level of fertility or if it is irreversible using economically feasible management inputs. Please also refer to other related definitions: 'marginal soil'.	RSPO P&C 2018

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Gender Sensitive	To understand and give consideration to socio-cultural norms and discriminations in order to acknowledge the different rights, roles, and responsibilities of women, and men, in the community and the relationships between them. Policies and programmes that take into account the particularities pertaining to the lives of both women and men, while aiming to eliminate inequalities or imbalance between women and men, and promote gender equality, including an equal distribution of resources.	Adapted from Women Empowerment Development Organisation (WEDO), 2013 (online)
Geolocation	Geographical location of a plot of land described by means of latitude and longitude coordinates corresponding to at least one latitude and one longitude point, and using at least six decimal digits.	Article 2 (28), Regulation (EU) 2023/1115 of the European Parliament and of the Council (2023)
Good faith	The principle of good faith implies that the parties make every effort to reach an agreement, conduct genuine and constructive negotiations, avoid unjustified delays in negotiations, respect agreements concluded, and give sufficient time to discuss and settle collective disputes. In the case of multinational enterprises, such companies should not threaten to transfer the whole or part of an operating unit from the country concerned in order to unfairly influence negotiations.	Adapted from ILO Q&As on business and collective bargaining (online; accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://www.ilo.org/resource/qas-business-and-collective-bargaining-0)
Greenhouse gas (GHG)	Gaseous constituents of the atmosphere, both natural and anthropogenic, that absorb and emit radiation at specific wavelengths within the spectrum of infrared radiation emitted by the Earth's surface, the atmosphere, and clouds.	Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (2021)
Group manager	A person, a group of people, or an organisation responsible for running the internal control system and managing an independent smallholder group. This can be a mill, an organisation, or an individual.	RSPO ISH standard 2019
Growers	Growers are beneficial owners, land owners, or businesses with more than 500 hectares (accumulative) of cultivated and harvested oil palms. Please also refer to other related definitions: 'medium grower', 'smallholder'.	RSPO P&C 2024
Health and Safety (H&S) Committee	A Health and Safety Committee is a representative group composed of both management and worker representatives, tasked with the development of safety and health rules, and safe systems of work. It is responsible for identifying hazards, assessing risks, developing and implementing measures to prevent accidents and injuries, and ensuring compliance with relevant health and safety regulations and standards. It reviews the effectiveness of safety and health programmes, conducts investigations on trends of accidents that occur at the place of work, reviews the health and safety policies, and makes recommendations.	RSPO P&C 2024

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

Hazardous waste	Hazardous waste is a waste with properties that make it dangerous or capable of having a harmful effect on human health or the environment.	United States Environment Protection Agency (EPA), Learn the Basic of Hazardous Waste (online; accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://www.epa.gov/hw/learn-basics-hazardous-waste)
Hazardous work for children	Hazardous work for children is defined as “any work which is likely to jeopardise children’s physical, mental or moral health, safety or morals” and which “should not be done by anyone under the age of 18”. This includes: A) Work which exposes children to physical, psychological, or sexual abuse; B) Work underground, under water, at dangerous heights, or in confined spaces; C) Work with dangerous machinery, equipment, and tools, or which involves the manual handling or transport of heavy loads; D) Work in an unhealthy environment which may, for example, expose children to hazardous substances, agents, or processes, or to temperatures, noise levels, or vibrations damaging to their health; and E) Work under particularly difficult conditions such as work for long hours or during the night or work where the child is unreasonably confined to the premises of the employer.	Adapted from Article 3 (d) of the ILO Convention concerning the Prohibition and Immediate Action for the Elimination of the Worst Forms of Child Labour, 1999 (No. 182) and from Article (II) - Hazardous Work, of the ILO Worst Forms of Child Labour Recommendation, 1999 (No. 190)

Adopted 13 Nov 2025

High Conservation Value (HCV) areas	The areas necessary to maintain or enhance one or more High Conservation Values (HCVs): HCV 1 – Species diversity. Concentrations of biological diversity including endemic species, and rare, threatened or endangered (RTE) species, that are significant at global, regional, or national levels. HCV 2 – Landscape-level ecosystems, ecosystem mosaics, and Intact Forest Landscapes (IFL). Large landscape-level ecosystems, ecosystem mosaics, and IFL that are significant at global, regional, or national levels, and that contain viable populations of the great majority of the naturally occurring species in natural patterns of distribution and abundance. HCV 3 – Ecosystems and habitats. RTE ecosystems, habitats, or refugia. HCV 4 – Ecosystem services. Basic ecosystem services in critical situations, including protection of water catchments and control of erosion of vulnerable soils and slopes. HCV 5 – Community needs. Sites and resources fundamental for satisfying the basic necessities of local communities or indigenous peoples (for livelihoods, health, nutrition, water, etc.), identified through engagement with these communities or indigenous peoples. HCV 6 – Cultural values. Sites, resources, habitats, and landscapes of global or national cultural, archaeological, or historical significance, and/or of critical cultural, ecological, economic, or religious/sacred importance for the traditional cultures of local communities or indigenous peoples, identified through engagement with these local communities or indigenous peoples.	High Conservation Value Resource Network (HCVRN) Common Guidance for Identification of HCVs (2017)
High Carbon Stock	High Carbon Stock forests are defined as forests with above and below ground carbon stores, where the sequestered carbon losses as a result of land use change are greater than the potential gains in carbon stock within the new development area (including set aside and non-planted areas) over the period of one planting cycle.	RSPO P&C 2024, adapted from RSPO P&C 2013
High Forest Cover Country (HFCC)	Countries assessed as having >60% forest cover (based on recent, trusted REDD+ and/or national data); <1% oil palm cover; a deforestation trajectory that is historically low but is increasing or constant; and a known frontier area for oil palm or where major areas have been allocated for development.	RSPO No Deforestation consultancy: HFCC (Proforest, 2018)

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

High Forest Cover Landscape (HFCL)	Landscapes having >80% forest cover. Landscape defined as "the size of a landscape may be determined by A) Identifying the watershed or the geographical land unit containing a cluster of interacting ecosystems; B) Selecting a unit size that encompasses the plantation concession and a buffer of the surrounding area (e.g. 50,000 ha or 100,000 ha); or C) Using a radius of 5 km from the area of interest (for instance, the planned concession)".	Adapted from Module 5 of the HCSA Toolkit Version 2.0 (High Carbon Stock Approach, May 2017)
Highly Hazardous Pesticide	Pesticides that are acknowledged to present particularly high levels of acute or chronic hazards to health or the environment according to internationally accepted classification systems such as the World Health Organization (WHO), or the Globally Harmonized System of Classification and Labelling of Chemicals (GHS), or their listing in relevant binding international agreements or conventions. In addition, pesticides that appear to cause severe or irreversible harm to health or the environment under conditions of use in a country may be considered to be, and treated as, highly hazardous.	Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides (FAO & WHO, 2016)
Human Rights Defenders (HRD)	People who, individually or with others, act to promote and protect human rights in a peaceful way.	Declaration on the Right and Responsibility of Individuals, Groups and Organs of Society to Promote and Protect Universally Recognised Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms (United Nations General Assembly, 1998)
Human Rights Due Diligence (HRDD)	Human rights due diligence is a way for businesses to proactively manage potential and actual adverse human rights impacts with which they are involved. It involves requiring businesses to identify, prevent, mitigate, and account for how they address actual and potential impacts on human rights.	United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights (Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights, 2011)
Identity Preserved	A mill is deemed to be Identity Preserved (IP) if the FFB processed by the mill is only sourced from plantations/estates that are certified against the RSPO Principles and Criteria, or against the RSPO Group Certification scheme. Certification for mills is necessary to verify the volumes and sources of certified FFB entering the mill, the implementation of any processing controls (e.g., if physical separation is used), and volume sales of RSPO certified palm oil and oil palm products. If a mill processes certified and uncertified FFB without physically separating them, then only the Mass Balance supply chain module is applicable.	RSPO Supply Chain Certification standard (2020)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Independent Smallholder	An oil palm grower who has the following characteristics: - Enforceable decision-making power on the operation of the land and production practices; - Ability and freedom to choose how the land and type of planted crops is organised, managed, and financed; - Meet any further criteria or definition relative to the applicability of the RSPO P&C and ISH standards, provided in the relevant National Interpretation for a specific country; - The total size of their oil palm production area is smaller than or equal to 50 hectares (ha) if no threshold is defined in a National Interpretation; OR smaller than or equal to the maximum size defined in a National Interpretation (e.g., for Indonesia this implies the threshold size is 20 ha or below; for Ecuador 75 ha or below); and - Not a scheme smallholder Please refer to other related definitions: 'smallholder' and 'scheme smallholder'.	Adapted from RSPO P&C 2018 and ISH 2019 standards
Indigenous peoples	Indigenous peoples refer to those who: - Self-identify as indigenous peoples at the individual level and accepted by the community as their member - Have historical continuity with pre-colonial and/or pre-settler societies that developed on their territories - Strong link to territories and surrounding natural resources - Consider themselves as having distinct social, economic or political systems from other sector of the societies in the area where they live - Distinct language, culture, and beliefs - Form non-dominant groups of society - Resolve to maintain, develop, and reproduce their ancestral environments and systems to future generations as distinctive peoples and communities. When considering the factors above, no single one shall be determinative. Indigenous peoples are defined as such regardless of the local, national, and regional terms that may be applied to them, such as ‘tribal people,’ ‘first peoples,’ ‘secluded tribes,’ ‘hill people,’ or others.	Adapted from the United Nations Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues Factsheet (online, accessed on 11 September 2024 at https://www.un.org/esa/socdev/unpfii/documents/5session_factsheet1.pdf)
Initial Certification	The beginning stage of the certification cycle where the decision of certification and issuance of certificate is done.	RSPO Certification Systems for Principles & Criteria and RSPO Independent Smallholder Standard (2020)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Integrated Pest Management (IPM)	A careful consideration of all available plant protection methods and subsequent integration of appropriate measures that discourage the development of populations of harmful organisms and keep the use of plant protection products and other forms of intervention to levels that are economically and ecologically justified, and reduce or minimise risks to human health and the environment. 'Integrated pest management' emphasises the growth of a healthy crop with the least possible disruption to agro-ecosystems and encourages natural pest control mechanisms.	Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides (FAO & WHO, 2016)
Internal Control System (ICS)	A set of rules, policies, and procedures which an organisation implements to provide direction, increase efficiency, and strengthen adherence to policies to manage a group.	RSPO ISH standard 2019
International accepted scientific protocol	A predefined science-based procedure which is either published by an international scientific network or union, or referenced frequently in the international scientific literature.	FSC Principles and Criteria for Forest Stewardship FSC-STD-01-001 (V5-2, 2018)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Intimidation and harassment (including threats)	Refers to a range of unacceptable behaviour that results in physical, psychological, sexual, or economic harm. Examples include: <u>Communities</u> A) Any threats of dispossession of land, forced removal, or relocation; B) Any threat to deny access to resources on land e.g. water, agriculture, sacred grounds, etc.; C) Any threats against community members during receipt of grievances; D) Any threats and abuse of power by military, paramilitaries, or security personnel (contracted by the Unit of Certification) against community members (includes sexual favours); E) Any threats and coercion against community members in signing agreements related to relinquishing of land rights or resources; F) Persistent verbal abuse. <u>Workers</u> A) Loss of income and/or restricted access to the workplace, housing, and/or land; B) Threats of dismissal from employment or against workers who wish to resign; C) Threats against workers during receipt of grievances regarding working and living conditions via internal (labour dispute mechanisms) and/or external (e.g. embassy, NGO, etc.) grievance channels; D) Threats to terminate employment of family members; E) Withdrawal of rights such as the rights to leave the workplace; F) Verbal abuse. It may also include undermining of workers, i.e., psychological coercion, designed to increase the sense of vulnerability. <u>Human Rights Defenders</u> A) Loss of income due to/resulting in organisational restrictions; B) Any threats of dismissal from employment, restrictions on travel, and restrictions to the environment in which the HRDs operate; C) Any deliberate obstruction to holding of meetings between HRDs; D) Any hostility within the community the HRDs lives as claims may be seen to jeopardise the community's honour and culture (this may especially be the case with women HRDs); E) Any character assassination of HRDs in the form of discrediting or defamation campaigns; F) Any arbitrary use of security forces surveillance; G) Any SLAPP suits (Strategic Lawsuits against Public Participation) due to his or her work and/or in the course of his/her activities; H) Any threats of physical violence and death threats. Special attention is needed to avoid gender-specific violence such as rape or threats of sexual violence used to silence women.	RSPO P&C 2024
Labour recruiters	Includes all labour recruiters (both public and private employment services/agencies) and all other intermediaries or sub-agents that offer labour recruitment and placement services. This includes labour recruiters in countries of origin that assist, or are sub-contracted to, the labour recruiter that is directly engaged by the Unit of Certification, and any recruiters engaged by the sub-contractor.	RSPO P&C 2024

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Land clearing/land clearance	Conversion of land from one land use to another. Clearing of actively managed certified oil palm plantations to replant oil palm is not considered land clearing. Within existing Units of Certification, clearing of less than 10 ha meeting all the requirements below is not considered land clearing: A) 10 ha threshold is the maximum limit (cumulative) within a specified Unit of Certification over the lifetime of the plantation; B) Must not be contiguous to HCV and potential HCS forests; and C) Must not be HCV and potential HCS forests.	RSPO P&C 2018
Legal due diligence	The term 'legal due diligence' is commonly defined as an investigation, review performed, and/or research conducted on a company or business asset or a business, to confirm the facts of a matter under consideration before entering into an agreement with the another party. Once the facts are collected and analysed, an informed decision can be made.	RSPO P&C 2024
Legal registration	Official license and/or permission from the relevant government authorities for an entity to operate as an enterprise, with rights to buy and sell products and/or services commercially. The licence or permissions can apply to an individual, a privately-owned enterprise, or a publicly-owned corporate entity.	RSPO P&C 2024
Livelihood	A person's or a group's way of making a living, from their environment or in the economy, including how they provision their basic needs, and assure themselves and following generations secure access to food, clean water, health, education, housing, and the materials needed for their life and comfort either through their own direct use of natural resources or through exchange, barter, trade, or engagement in the market. A livelihood includes not just access to resources but the knowledge and institutions that make this possible such as time for community participation and integration, personal, local or traditional ecological knowledge, skills, endowments and practices, the assets that are intrinsic to that way of making a living (e.g. farms, fields, pastures, crops, stock, natural resources, tools, machinery, and intangible cultural properties), and their position in the legal, political, and social fabric of society. The risk of livelihood failure determines the level of vulnerability of a person or a group to income, food, health, and nutritional insecurity. Therefore, livelihoods are secure when they have secure ownership of, or access to, resources and income earning activities, including reserves and assets, to offset risks, ease shocks, and meet contingencies.	Compiled and adapted from various definitions of livelihoods from the Department for International Development (DfID), the Institute of Development Studies (IDS), the FAO, and academic texts in 'The Household Livelihood Security Concept' (Frankenberger & McCaston, 1998; online, accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://www.fao.org/4/x0051t/x0051t05.htm)

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

Living Wage	The remuneration received for a standard workweek by a worker in a particular place sufficient to afford a decent standard of living for the worker and her or his family. Elements of a decent standard of living include food, water, housing, education, health care, transportation, clothing, and other essential needs including provision for unexpected events.	What is a Living Wage? (Global Living Wage Coalition; online, accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://www.globallivingwage.org/about/what-is-a-living-wage/)
Local Community/Local Peoples	Refer to a community in a particular place where local people share common concern around local facilities, services and environment, and which may at times depart from traditional or state definitions. Generally, local communities attach particular meaning to land and natural resources as sources of culture, customs, history, and identity, and depend on them to sustain their livelihoods, social organisation, culture and traditions, beliefs, environment, and ecology.	RSPO Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) Guide (2022)
Managed area	The land containing oil palm and associated land uses such as infrastructure (e.g., roads, buildings), riparian zones, and set-aside conservation areas.	RSPO P&C 2018
Management documents	Management documents are documented information and evidence to interact with the RSPO P&C standard. It shall be in the form of manual, working procedures, reports, and records that subject to be audited and reviewed periodically.	RSPO P&C 2018
Management Review/ Reviewed annually by management	Management reviews are an opportunity to evaluate the systems and controls that are in place, to review feedback, make improvements and track corrective action, to assure that changes are monitored, reported and evaluated, and to determine the overall effectiveness of the quality programme (QMS).	ISO 9001: 2015 - Quality Management Systems
Marginal soil	A soil that is unlikely to produce acceptable economic returns for the proposed crop at reasonable projections of crop value and costs of amelioration. Degraded soils are not marginal soils if their amelioration, and resulting productivity, is cost effective. Please also refer to other related definitions: 'fragile soil'.	RSPO P&C 2018
Mass Balance	A mill is deemed to be Mass Balance (MB) if the mill processes FFB from both RSPO certified and uncertified plantations/estates. A mill may take delivery of FFB from uncertified growers, in addition to those from its own and 3rd party certified supply base(s). In that scenario, the mill can only claim the volume of palm oil and oil palm products produced from processing of the certified FFB as Mass Balance.	RSPO Supply Chain Certification standard (2020)
Maternal Health	Maternal health refers to the health of women during pregnancy, childbirth, and the post-natal period.	Maternal Health (World Health Organisation; online, accessed January 2023 at https://www.who.int/health-topics/maternal-health)

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

Medium Grower	Medium Growers are land owners or small businesses with more than 50 ha and up to 500 ha (accumulative), who cultivate and harvest oil palms using hired labour rather than family labour. They may have diverse sources of income including from multiple crops, may not reside near their oil palm plantings and may employ administrative staff. Medium growers may or may not operate mills. (National Interpretation is encouraged). Please also refer to other related definitions: 'grower', 'smallholder'.	RSPO P&C 2024
Migrant Worker	A person who migrates or who has migrated whether within a country (internal migrant) or from one country to another (international migrant) to work.	RSPO P&C 2024
Migrant Worker Status	Workers who have registered to be regularised under national labour recalibration/regularisation programs.	RSPO P&C 2024
National law	A binding rule or body of rules prescribed by the government of a sovereign state that holds force throughout the regions and territories within the government's dominion. In the context of international law, a State party to an international treaty must ensure that its own domestic law and practice are consistent with what is required by the treaty. National laws includes subsidiary legislations, regulations, by-laws, rules, and orders issued by the government.	National Law (UN Environment Programme; online, accessed January 2023 at https://leap.unep.org/en/knowledge/glossary/national-law)
Negative action	Negative action against affected stakeholders is any act of retaliation; intimidation, harassment and threats; violence (physical, sexual and gender-based) and torture; instigating violence or use of any form of harassment, including the use of mercenaries and paramilitaries in their operations; exploitation; discrimination; and detention, disappearance or killing.	RSPO P&C 2024
New planting	The planned or proposed establishment of oil palm plantations and associated developments on lands not previously cultivated with oil palm, owned and/or directly managed by an RSPO member.	RSPO P&C 2024
Non-judicial process	Non-judicial process refers to mechanisms that do not involve formal national court proceedings or the direct involvement of the judiciary. These processes are often carried out by administrative or executive bodies such as mediations or arbitrations. This may also include dialogue-based or other culturally appropriate compatible processes. It can be used by individuals, workers, communities, and/or civil society organisations e.g., labour tribunals, national human rights institutions, ombudsperson offices, community tribunals, etc.	RSPO P&C 2024
Oil Extraction Rate (OER)	Proportion of crude palm oil extracted from Fresh Fruit Bunches, using either the dry or wet extraction method.	RSPO P&C 2024
Operations	All activities planned and/or undertaken by the Unit of Certification, which includes its contractors, within the boundaries of its palm oil mill and its estates/plantations.	RSPO P&C 2024

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Other conservation areas	Areas (in addition to HCVs, HCS forests, and peatland conservation areas) that are required to be conserved by the RSPO P&C standard e.g., riparian areas, steep slopes, other areas allocated by the Unit of Certification.	RSPO P&C 2018
Outgrower	Farmer(s) or grower(s), where the sale of their FFB is exclusively contracted to the Unit of Certification. Outgrowers may be smallholders.	RSPO P&C 2013
Paludiculture	Productive land use on rewetted peatland with crops that are adapted to the high water levels in peatlands. Paludiculture is classified as a peatland rehabilitation strategy. Plant species can be cultivated as part of the paludiculture are swam jelutong (*dyera polyphylla*), alternative pulp species, tengkawang (*shorea spp.*), sago (*metroxylon spp.*), rattan, and medicinal plants.	RSPO Manual on BMPs for Management and Rehabilitation of Peatlands (2019)
Participatory Mapping/Methodology	Participatory mapping, also known as 'community mapping', is based on the premise that communities have knowledge of their customary tenure and surrounding environments, which can be expressed in simple maps. It allows communities to bring their local knowledge and perspectives to the attention of authorities and the UoC. This is done jointly by the Unit of Certification and the communities.	Adapted from RSPO Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) Guide (2022)
Peat	A soil with cumulative organic layer(s) comprising more than half of the upper 80 cm or 100 cm of the soil surface, containing 35% or more of organic matter (35% or more Loss on Ignition) or 18% or more organic carbon. Note for management of existing plantations in Malaysia and Indonesia, a narrower definition has been used, based on national regulations, namely: soil with an organic layer of more than 50% in the top 100 cm, containing more than 65% organic matter.	RSPO Peatland Working Group 2 (PLWG2), July 2018. Derived from FAO and USDA definition for histosols (organic soils) (FAO 1998, 2006/7; USDA 2014)
Pesticide	Substances or a mixture of substances intended for preventing, destroying, repelling, or mitigating any pest, or regulating plant growth. Pesticides are categorised into four main substituent chemicals: herbicides; fungicides; insecticides; and bactericides.	RSPO P&C 2013
Plan	A time-bound and detailed scheme, programme, or method for achieving objective(s) and desired outcome(s). Plans shall have clear targets with timelines for delivery, actions to be taken, and a process for monitoring progress to adapt plans to changing circumstances and reporting. Plans shall also include the identification of named individuals or positions responsible for the delivery of the plan. There shall be evidence that sufficient resources are available to carry out the plan and the plan is implemented in full.	RSPO P&C 2013
Plantation	The land on which oil palm is grown. Can be known as 'estate', 'concession' or 'supply base' depending on context such as ownership, land title(s), or commercial arrangements.	RSPO P&C 2018

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Precautionary Approach	An approach requiring that when the available information indicates that management activities pose a threat of severe or irreversible damage to the environment or a threat to human welfare, The organisation will take explicit and effective measures to prevent the damage and avoid the risks to welfare, even when the scientific information is incomplete or inconclusive, and when the vulnerability and sensitivity of environmental values are uncertain A precautionary approach applies explicit and effective measures when there is a threat of severe or irreversible damage to the environment or a threat to human welfare, to prevent the damage and reduce the risks. These measures are applied even when the scientific information is incomplete or inconclusive, and when the vulnerability and sensitivity of values are uncertain.	Rio Declaration on Environment and Development A/CONF.151/26 (Vol. I) (United Nations General Assembly, 1992)
Prevailing wage	The remuneration earned by a worker during normal working hours. It includes basic wage (cash), certain types of in-kind benefits, allowances, and bonuses.	RSPO Guidance on Calculating Prevailing Wages (2019)
Primary forest	Forest that has never been logged and has developed following natural disturbances and under natural processes, regardless of its age. Also included as primary are forests that are used inconsequentially by indigenous and local communities living traditional lifestyles relevant for the conservation and sustainable use of biological diversity. The present cover is normally relatively close to the natural composition and has arisen (predominantly) through natural regeneration. Applicability: *The RSPO standards have evolved in addressing deforestation, shifting from terms like "primary forest" in earlier iterations to more recent concepts such as "High Conservation Values (HCVs)" and "High Carbon Stock Forests (HCS)" in 2018. These updated terms are used within the RSPO system to ensure compliance with the standards relevant at the time of deforestation risk assessment, conducted during membership application. For new members (since November 2005) and existing members planning new planting (since January 2010), the definition of "primary forest" is applied to determine if deforestation occurred within a specified time frame.*	RSPO P&C 2024

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Private Employment Agency	Any natural or legal person, independent of the public authorities, which provides one or more of the following labour market services: A) Services for matching offers of and applications for employment, without the private employment agency becoming a party to the employment relationships which may arise therefrom B) Services consisting of employing workers with a view to making them available to a third party, who may be a natural or legal person (referred to below as a "user enterprise") which assigns their tasks and supervises the execution of these tasks C) Other services relating to jobseeking, determined by the competent authority after consulting the most representative employers and workers organizations, such as the provision of information, that do not set out to match specific offers of and applications for employment.	RSPO P&C 2024
Prophylactic	A treatment or course of action applied as a preventive measure.	RSPO P&C 2013
Publicly available	Refers to information or documents are accessible free of charge to anyone in the general public, without the need for special qualifications, permissions, or privileges.	RSPO P&C 2024
Rare, threatened or endangered (RTE) species	**Rare species:** Species that are uncommon or scarce, but not classified as threatened. These species are located in geographically restricted areas or specific habitats, or are scantily scattered on a large scale. They are approximately equivalent to the IUCN (2001) category of Near Threatened (NT), including species that are close to qualifying for, or are likely to qualify for, a threatened category in the near future. They are also approximately equivalent to imperilled species. **Threatened species:** Species that meet the IUCN (2001) criteria for Vulnerable (VU), Endangered (EN) or Critically Endangered (CR), and are facing a high, very high, or extremely high risk of extinction in the wild. These categories may be reinterpreted according to official national classifications (which have legal significance) and to local conditions and population densities (which should affect decisions about appropriate conservation measures). **Endangered species:** A taxon is Endangered when the best available evidence indicates that it meets any of the criteria A to E for Endangered (see Section V), and it is therefore considered to be facing a very high risk of extinction in the wild.	IUCN Red List Categories and Criteria Version 3.1 (International Union for Conservation of Nature, 2001)
Recruitment fees and related costs	The terms ‘recruitment fees’ or ‘related costs’ refer to any fees or costs incurred in the recruitment process in order for workers to secure employment or placement, regardless of the manner, timing, or location of their imposition or collection.	ILO General principles and operational guidelines for fair recruitment and definition of recruitment fees and related costs (International Labour Organization, 2019)

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Remediation	Remediation refers to both the process and the outcome of addressing adverse human rights impacts. Remedies available should be adequate and appropriate, proportional to the gravity of the violation, and adapted to the circumstances of the case. Assistance provided to each aggrieved party will depend on the individual needs of the aggrieved party. Below are some examples of remediation that may be considered by the Unit of Certification: A) Shelter and accommodation B) Medical and health-care services and counselling, including mental health and psychosocial support C) Compensation/repayment D) Financial assistance E) Legal assistance F) Return assistance G) Reintegration assistance H) Satisfaction (acknowledgement fault/apology) I) Restitution (restoration of situation) J) Guarantee of non-repetition	Adapted from the Corporate Responsibility to Respect Human Rights: An Interpretive Guide (United Nations Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights, 2012)
Replanting	Replanting oil palm with a subsequent oil palm crop.	RSPO New Planting Procedure (NPP) 2021
Restoration	The process of assisting the recovery of an ecosystem, and its associated conservation values, that has been degraded, damaged, or destroyed.	Adapted from the Accountability Framework Initiative (2020)

Adopted 13 Nov 2023

Rights	Rights are legal, social or ethical principles of freedom or entitlement, in accordance with the International Bill of Rights and other relevant international human rights instruments, including the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples, UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, and the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration. - Customary rights: Patterns of long-standing community land and resource usage in accordance with indigenous peoples' customary laws, values, customs, and traditions, including seasonal or cyclical use rather than formal legal title to land and resources issued by the State. - Legal rights: Rights given to individual(s), entities, and others through applicable local, national, or ratified international laws and regulations. - User rights: Rights for the use of land and resources that can be defined by local custom, mutual agreements, or prescribed by other entities holding access rights. - Demonstrable rights: Indigenous peoples, local communities, and users may have informal or customary rights in land that are not registered or recognised by the government or national laws. Demonstrable rights are distinguished from spurious claims by direct engagement with local communities, so they have adequate opportunities to justify their claims, and are best ascertained through participatory mapping with the involvement of neighbouring communities.	RSPO Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) Guide (2022)
Riparian	Riparian is used to refer to land located next to natural lakes, as well as streams and rivers, although the latter are more commonly found within oil palm concessions.	RSPO Manual for the Management and Rehabilitation of Riparian Reserves (2018)
Risk assessment	A systematic process of identifying and evaluating the potential risks that may be involved in a projected activity or undertaking. It enables a weighing up of whether enough precautions are in place or whether more should be done to prevent harm to those at risk, including workers and members of the public.	Adapted from ILO 'A 5 step guide for employers, workers and their representatives on conducting workplace risk assessments' (International Labour Organization, 2014)
Safe drinking water	Safe drinking water, also known as 'potable water' or 'improved drinking water' or 'water that is safe to drink', is water that is of sufficient quality to be used for drinking (as well as for cooking and personal/domestic hygiene) without causing risk to health.	Adapted from Module 1: Water in 'WASH@Work: a self-training handbook' (International Labour Office, 2016)
Scheme Smallholder	All smallholder farmers who are not independent smallholders, under a formal and legal contractual FFB sourcing agreement with a Unit of Certification. Please also refer to other related definitions: 'smallholder' and 'independent smallholder'.	RSPO P&C 2024

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Segregated	The Segregated (SG) supply chain model assures that RSPO certified palm oil and oil palm products delivered to the end user is only from RSPO certified sources (a mixture of Identity Preserved/IP products). Please also refer to other related definitions: 'Identity Preserved'	RSPO Supply Chain Certification standard (2020)
Sexual Harassment	Sexual harassment is any unwelcome sexual advance, request for sexual favour, verbal or physical conduct or gesture of a sexual nature, or any other behaviour of a sexual nature that might reasonably be expected or be perceived to cause offence or humiliation to another, when such conduct interferes with work, is made a condition of employment, or creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment. While typically involving a pattern of behaviour, it can take the form of a single incident. Sexual harassment may occur between persons of the opposite or same sex. Both males and females can be either the victims or the offenders.	Adapted from the ILO Briefing note 'Sexual harassment in the world of work' (International Labour Organization; online, accessed on 8 April 2024 at https://www.ilo.org/sites/default/files/wcmsp5/groups/public/@dgreports/@gender/documents/briefingnote/wcms_738115.pdf) and UN Women 'Harassment Policy including sexual harassment' (United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women; online, accessed on 8 April 2024 at https://www.un.org/womenwatch/osagi new/fpsexualharassment.htm)
Sexual violence	Includes rape, threats of sexual violence, and/or abuse. Sexual violence also includes forcing (directly or indirectly) workers/community members to engage in sexual activities.	Adapted from the ILO '11 Indicators on Forced Labour' (International Labour Organization, 2012)
Significant air pollutant	Significant air pollutants are chemical or biological substances that substantially degrade air quality. These may include pollutants from sources such as palm oil mill effluent (POME), sewage, wastewater, sediment, fertilisers, pesticides, fuels, and other palm oil operations, which exceeds the threshold in accordance with national regulations and international standards.	RSPO P&C 2024

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Smallholder	An oil palm grower with a total accumulative planted area of oil palm that is smaller than or equal to 50 hectares (ha). The definition of a smallholder farmer and threshold of planted area of oil palm may vary by country, to be determined by the relevant National Interpretation of the RSPO P&C and ISH standards. In the absence of an NI developed for a specific country that has been formally endorsed by the RSPO Board of Governors, the definition of a smallholder farmer in the generic RSPO P&C shall prevail. Please refer to other related definitions: 'independent smallholder' and 'scheme smallholder'.	Adapted from RSPO P&C 2018 and ISH 2019 standards
Smallholder plot	Land where smallholders have rights, and is planted with oil palm or allocated for new planting with oil palm or replanting.	RSPO ISH standard 2024
Smallholder household	A smallholder household refers to persons or groups that may be related or unrelated that live together and make common provision for food and other essentials for living. Please refer to other related definitions: 'family members' and 'contributing family members'.	RSPO ISH standard 2024
Social and Environmental Impact Assessment (SEIA)	An analysis and planning process to be carried out prior to new plantings or operations. This process incorporates relevant environmental and social data, as well as stakeholder consultations, in order to identify the baseline condition and potential impacts (both direct and indirect) to the site; and to determine whether these impacts can be satisfactorily addressed, in which case the proponent also defines specific actions to minimise and mitigate potential negative impacts in a resulting social and environmental management & monitoring plan.	RSPO P&C 2024
Socialise	A process of sharing knowledge and/or skills through providing information to, and interacting with, stakeholders.	RSPO P&C 2024
Stakeholder(s)	An individual or group with a legitimate and/or demonstrable interest in, or who may or may not be directly affected by, the activities of an organisation and the consequences of those activities. Stakeholders include suppliers, internal staff members, workers, family members living on-site, communities, smallholders, customers, regulators, purchasers, clients, owners, trade unions, and non-governmental organisations (NGOs).	RSPO P&C 2018
Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)	An SOP is a set of step-by-step instructions compiled by an organisation to help workers carry out routine operations. SOPs aim to achieve efficiency, quality output, and uniformity of performance, while reducing miscommunication and failure to comply.	RSPO P&C 2024
Steep terrain	Areas with a slope greater than 25 degrees, or otherwise defined through a National Interpretation (NI) process.	RSPO P&C 2013
Supplier(s)	Person(s) or organisation(s) that supply Fresh Fruit Bunches to the Unit of Certification.	RSPO P&C 2024

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

Supply chain	The series of processes/steps through which agricultural raw materials pass from the primary producer through to the end-product manufacturer (i.e. oil palm cultivation, harvesting, milling, storage, transport, refining, distribution, processing, manufacturing, retailing, etc.)	RSPO Supply Chain Certification standard 2020
Trader(s)	Person(s), business(es), or organisation(s) that buy and sell Fresh Fruit Bunches	RSPO P&C 2024
Trafficking in Persons	The recruitment, transportation, transfer, harbouring or receipt of persons, by means of the threat or use of force or other forms of coercion, of abduction, of fraud, of deception, of the abuse of power or of a position of vulnerability or of the giving or receiving of payments or benefits to achieve the consent of a person having control over another person, for the purpose of exploitation. Exploitation shall include, at a minimum, the exploitation of the prostitution of others or other forms of sexual exploitation, forced labour or services, slavery or practices similar to slavery, servitude or the removal of organs.	United Nations 'Protocols to Prevent, Suppress and Punish Trafficking in Persons, especially Women and Children....' (United Nations General Assembly, 2000)
Tribal peoples	Persons, or groups of persons, that can be identified or characterised as follows: - People who self-identify as tribal people and are accepted as such by their community - Social, cultural, and economic conditions distinguish them from other sections of the national community - Status is regulated wholly or partially by their own customs or traditions, or by special laws or regulations	RSPO P&C 2024
Unit of Certification	The Unit of Certification is the collective area proposed for certification under the RSPO P&C standard, including: A) The mill(s) and its supply base(s), which shall include both directly managed land (and estates) and scheme smallholders, where estates have been legally established with proportions of lands allocated to each; B) Oil palm production areas managed by growers, medium growers, and/or smallholders; and C) Set-aside conservation areas within the concession area under the management control of the UoC.	RSPO P&C 2024
Unlawful wage deductions	Unlawful wage deductions refer to wage deductions that are not stipulated in the national laws or collective bargaining agreement. In circumstances where the national law or collective bargaining agreement is silent on deductions, the Unit of Certification shall obtain approval from the relevant authorities for the said deductions.	RSPO P&C 2024

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Violence	Violence may take many forms. It consists of acts that results in, or is likely to result in, physical, sexual, or psychological harm or suffering. This includes threats of such acts, coercion, or withdrawal of rights, occurring within the Unit of Certification, as well as the use of violence as a disciplinary measure and/or as a result of gender-based discrimination. Violence humiliates, degrades or damages a person's well-being, value, or dignity. Violence can be perpetrated either directly or indirectly. It includes: A) Physical violence B) Sexual violence C) Psychological violence **Physical Violence** The use of physical force against another person or group that results in physical, sexual, or psychological harm. **Sexual Violence** Any form or attempt of non-consensual sexual activity or coercion perpetrated against an individual. This includes rape, forced or coerced penetration of the vulva, anus, or any other body orifice with a penis, body part, or object. Sexual violence extends beyond physical acts to include psychological coercion, verbal harassment, and any behaviour aimed at exploiting or violating an individual's sexual autonomy and dignity. **Psychological Violence** Any intentional conduct that seriously impairs another person's psychological integrity through coercion or threats. Psychological violence can take the form of coercion, defamation, verbal abuse, threats, or harassment. It may also include threat of physical force, against another person or group that result in harm to mental, spiritual, moral, or social development, as well as bullying/mobbing. **<u>Additional notes and information</u>** **Gender-based violence** Gender-based violence is violence directed against a person because of that person's gender or violence that affects persons of a particular gender disproportionately. It is rooted in gender inequality, the abuse of power and harmful norms. The term is primarily used to underscore the fact that structural, gender-based power differentials place women and girls at risk of multiple forms of violence. The United Nations Declaration on the Elimination of Violence Against Women defines violence against women as "any act of gender-based violence that results in, or is likely to result in, physical, sexual or psychological harm or suffering to women, including threats of such acts, coercion or arbitrary deprivation of liberty, whether occurring in public or in private life." While women and girls suffer disproportionately from GBV, men and boys can also be targeted. **<u>Violence against Communities</u>** - Use of physical violence against community members in signing agreements related to relinquishing of land rights or resources - Forced dispossession of land, removal, or relocation through the use of violence	Adapted from the ILO Department of Statistics 'Work-related violence and its integration into existing surveys' paper from the 19th International Conference of Labour Statisticians in Geneva (International Labour Organization, October 2013; online, accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://www.ilo.org/sites/default/files/wcmsp5/groups/public/@dgreports/@stat/documents/meetingdocument/wcms_222231.pdf) and UN Women 'Frequently asked questions: Types of violence against women and girls' (United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women; online, accessed on 8 April 2024 at https://africa.unwomen.org/en/what-we-do/ending-violence-against-women/faqs/types-of-violence-1) and (for communities) Adapted from United Nations Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues Mandated Areas - Human Rights (United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs; online, accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://social.desa.un.org/issues/indigenous-peoples/unpfii-mandated-areas-human-rights)

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	- Excessive use of force by military or security personnel (contracted by the Unit of Certification) against community members.	
Voluntary isolation	Indigenous peoples in voluntary isolation are indigenous peoples or segments of indigenous peoples who do not maintain sustained contacts with the majority non-indigenous population, and who generally reject any type of contact with persons not part of their own people. They may also be peoples or segments of peoples previously contacted and who, after intermittent contact with the non-indigenous societies, have returned to a situation of isolation and broke the relations of contact that they may have had with those societies. In line with the principles of Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC), RSPO prohibits oil palm expansion in these peoples' territories.	IAHCR 'Indigenous Peoples in Voluntary Isolation and Initial Contact in the Americas' (Inter-American Commission on Human Rights & Organization of American States, 2013)
Vulnerable groups	Any group or sector of society that is at higher risk or being subjected to social exclusion, discriminatory practices, violence, natural or environmental disaster, or economic hardship than other groups, such as indigenous peoples, ethnic minorities, migrants, disabled people, the homeless, isolated elderly people, women, and children.	RSPO P&C 2018
Waste	Any substance or object which the holder discards or intends or is required to discard.	Article 3 (1), Directive 2008/98/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council (19 November 2008)
Waste management	The collection, transport, recovery, and disposal of waste, including the supervision of such operations and the after-care of disposal sites, and including actions taken as a dealer or broker.	Article 3 (9), Directive 2008/98/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council (19 November 2008)
Watercourse	A watercourse is a natural or artificial channel through which water flows and/or a stream of water (such as a river, a brook, or an underground stream).	RSPO P&C 2024
Water security	The capacity of a population to safeguard sustainable access to adequate quantities of acceptable quality water for sustaining livelihoods, human well-being, and socio-economic development, for ensuring protection against water-borne pollution and water-related disasters, and for preserving ecosystems in a climate of peace and political stability.	UN-Water Analytical Brief 'Water Security and the Global Water Agenda' (United Nations Water, 2013; online, accessed on 3 April 2024 at https://www.unwater.org/publications/water-security-and-global-water-agenda)
Whistleblower	Individuals who are employees or former employees who report on illegal, irregular, dangerous, or unethical practices or actions by employers which contravene the RSPO Code of Conduct and related RSPO key documents, and who may potentially be at risk of reprisal. This includes individuals who are outside the traditional employee-employer relationship, such as contract workers, temporary workers, consultants, contractors, trainees/interns, volunteers, student workers, and former employees.	RSPO Policy on the Protection of Human Rights Defenders, Whistleblowers, Complainants and Community Spokespersons (2018)

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Worker(s)	Individual(s) that perform work for pay. This includes: **- Permanent workers:** Workers with an ongoing employment relationship with the Unit of Certification and do not have a predetermined end date for their employment. **- Fixed-term workers:** Workers with an ongoing employment relationship with the Unit of Certification and who have an agreed minimum number of hours of work for a period of 3 months or more. **- Short-term workers:** Workers with an ongoing employment relationship with the Unit of Certification and who have an agreed minimum number of hours of work for a period of less than 3 months. (Seasonal workers with guaranteed work or number of working hours for a period of less than 3 months can be considered a short-term worker.) **- Casual workers:** Workers with an ongoing employment relationship with the Unit of Certification and who have no guarantee of employment for a certain number of hours during a specified period but may have arrangements of an ongoing or recurring nature. (Day workers can be considered as a casual worker if they have no guarantee of work or a minimum number of hours during a specified period.) - **Third-party contracted workers**: Workers employed by private employment agencies and deployed to a Unit of Certification which assigns and supervises the execution of their tasks. Seasonal, contract, day, and temporary workers would fall into one of the above categories depending on the terms of the employment contract (permanency/duration, minimum number of working hours, pay structure, etc.). In the context of smallholders, family members who receive a wage/salary in return for the work performed may fall under one of the above categories of workers depending on the employment permanency/duration, nature of work, and minimum number of working hours.	RSPO P&C 2024
Workforce	The total number of workers employed by the Unit of Certification either directly or indirectly. This includes contract workers and consultants.	RSPO P&C 2013
Worker Organisation	Any organisation or group formed by workers to advocate their rights and interests in the workplace. These organisations may include trade unions, labour unions, workers' associations, or similar entities dedicated to promoting workers' rights, improving working conditions, and fostering engagement between the Unit of Certification and workers.	RSPO P&C 2024
Work Target	An achievable output of work to be delivered by a worker within standard working hours in order to receive a full daily/monthly wage. It can also be referred to as ‘quota’.	Adapted from 'Guideline for Indonesian Palm Oil Companies: Fair Target-Setting and Wage Policies in Oil Palm Plantations' (Earthworm Foundation, 2020)

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Worst forms of child labour	The worst forms of child labour comprises: A) All forms of slavery, or practices similar to slavery, such as the sale and trafficking of children, debt bondage and serfdom, and forced or compulsory labour (including forced or compulsory recruitment of children for use in armed conflict); B) The use, procuring, or offering of a child for prostitution, for the production of pornography, or for pornographic performances; C) The use, procuring, or offering of a child for illicit activities, in particular for the production and trafficking of drugs as defined in the relevant international treaties; and D) Work which, by its nature or the circumstances in which it is carried out, is likely to harm the health, safety, or morals of children.	ILO Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No.182)
Yield	Fresh Fruit Bunch (FFB) production in metric tonnes (MT) per hectare of production area.	RSPO P&C 2024
Young workers	Young workers are those who are from the age of 15 (or above the national minimum age, if higher) but under the age of 18.	RSPO P&C 2024

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Annex 2 - Relevant International Laws and Conventions

RSPO Pillar	Covenants, conventions, and protocols	Declarations and guidelines
Prosperity	United Nations Convention against Corruption, 2000	
	ILO Convention Private Employment Agencies, 1997 (No 181)	Private Employment Agencies Recommendation, 1997 (No. 188)
		United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, 2011
People	International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR), 1966	
	International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (ICESCR), 1966	
	International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination (ICERD), 1965	
	Convention against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment (CAT), 1984	
	Convention for the Protection of All Persons from Enforced Disappearance (CPED), 2006	
	Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC), 1989	
	Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW), 1979	
	Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (CRPD), 2006	
	Declaration on Human Rights Defenders, 1998	
	International Convention on the Protection of the Rights of All Migrant Workers and Members of Their Families (ICMRW), 1990	
	ILO Convention on Migration for Employment, 1949 (No. 97)	
	ILO Convention on Migrant Workers (Supplementary Provisions), 1975 (No. 143)	Migrant Workers Recommendation, 1975 (No. 151)
	ILO Convention on Indigenous and Tribal Peoples, 1989 (No. 169)	Indigenous and Tribal Populations Recommendation, 1957 (No. 104)
		UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples, 2007
	ILO Convention on Freedom of Association and Protection of the Right to Organise, 1948 (No. 87)	

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	ILO Convention on the Right to Organise and Collective Bargaining, 1949 (No. 98)	
	ILO Convention on Rural Workers' Organisations, 1975 (No. 141)	
	ILO Convention on Workers' Representatives, 1971 (No. 135)	
	ILO Convention on Collective Bargaining, 1981 (No. 154)	
	ILO Convention on Discrimination (Employment and Occupation), 1958 (No. 111)	
	ILO Convention on Social Policy (Basic Aims and Standards), 1962 (No. 117)	Tenants and Sharecroppers Recommendation, 1968 (No. 132)
	ILO Convention on Workers with Family Responsibilities, 1981 (No. 156)	
	ILO Convention on Vocational Rehabilitation and Employment (Disabled Persons), 1983 (No. 159)	
	ILO Convention on Maternity Protection, 2000 (No. 183)	
	ILO Convention on Minimum Age, 1973 (No. 138)	Minimum Age Recommendation, 1973 (No. 146)
	ILO Convention on the Worst Forms of Child Labour, 1999 (No. 182)	Worst Forms of Child Labour Recommendation, 1999 (No. 190)
	ILO Convention on Forced Labour, 1930 (No. 29)	Forced Labour (Supplementary Measures) Recommendation, 2014 (No. 203)
	ILO Protocol of 2014 to the Forced Labour Convention, 1930 (No. 29)	
	ILO Convention on Plantations, 1958 (No. 110)	
	ILO Convention on Holidays with Pay (Revised), 1970 (No. 132)	
	ILO Convention on Hours of Work (Industry), 1919 (No. 1)	
	ILO Convention on Hours of Work (Commerce and Offices), 1930 (No. 30)	
	ILO Convention on Safety and Health in Agriculture, 2001 (No. 184)	Safety and Health in Agriculture Recommendation, 2001 (No. 192)
	ILO Convention on Occupational Cancer, 1974 (No. 139)	Occupational Cancer Recommendation, 1974 (No. 147)
	ILO Convention on Employment Injury Benefits, 1964 (No. 121)	Employment Injury Benefits Recommendation, 1964 (No. 121)
	ILO Convention on Workmen's Compensation (Agriculture), 1921 (No. 12)	

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	ILO Convention on Occupational Safety and Health, 1981 (No. 155)	ILO Occupational Safety and Health Recommendation, 1981 (No. 164)
	ILO Convention on Workers' Housing, 1961 (No. 106)	ILO Workers' Housing Recommendation, 1961 (No. 115)
	ILO Convention on Safety in the Use of Chemicals at Work, 1990 (No. 170)	Chemicals Recommendation, 1990 (No. 177)
	ILO Convention on Working Environment (Air Pollution, Noise and Vibration), 1977 (No. 148)	Working Environment (Air Pollution, Noise and Vibration) Recommendation, 1977 (No. 156)
		ILO Declaration of Philadelphia of 1944
Planet	Rio Declaration on Environment and Development (1992) and Agenda 21	
	UN Convention on Biological Diversity, 1992	
	UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), 1992	
	Rotterdam Convention on the Prior Informed Consent Procedure for Certain Hazardous Chemicals and Pesticides in International Trade, 1998	
	Stockholm Convention on Persistent Organic Pollutants (POPs), 2001	

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Annex 3 - Interpretation of Indicator 7.7.1 (C)

In reference to the Procedural Note in Indicator 7.7.1 (C), Annex 3 provides a more detailed description of the conservation requirements and transition mechanisms that apply to UoCs based on the chronological applicability of land assessments required by the RSPO P&C since November 2005. There are three broad scenarios which apply, which can be broken down into five permutations (detailed in the table below).

A separate document for 'Interpretation of Indicator 7.7.1 (C)' is being developed, based on the existing 'Interpretation of Indicator 7.12.2 and Annex 5 of RSPO P&C 2018' document and updated for validity. Until the 'Interpretation of Indicator 7.7.1 (C)' document has been developed and endorsed, the existing 'Interpretation of Indicator 7.12.2 and Annex 5 of RSPO P&C 2018' document remains valid and should be referenced for Indicator 7.7.1 (C) of the 2024 RSPO P&C.

Chronological Applicability of Land Assessments Required in the RSPO P&C	
The Unit of Certification shall conserve HCVs, HCS forests, and other conservation areas based on the following assessments and cut-off dates:	
A	HCV Assessment, non-ALS (Assessor Licensing Scheme) - November 2005 to November 2014 + LURI (Land Use Risk Identification) low risk - 'no further actions required'
B	HCV Assessment, ALS (Assessor Licensing Scheme) - November 2014 to November 2018 + LURI (Land Use Risk Identification) low risk
C	Standalone HCS + HCV Assessment, non-ALS (Assessor Licensing Scheme) + LURI (Land Use Risk Identification) high risk *Refer to Annex 5 in 2018 RSPO P&C 'Interpretation of Indicator 7.12.2 and Annex 5 of RSPO P&C 2018'*
D	Standalone HCS + HCV Assessment, ALS (Assessor Licensing Scheme) + LURI (Land Use Risk Identification) high risk *Refer to Annex 5 in 2018 RSPO P&C 'Interpretation of Indicator 7.12.2 and Annex 5 of RSPO P&C 2018'*
E	Integrated HCV-HCS Assessment with ALS (Assessor Licensing Scheme) *Refer to Indicator 7.7.1 (C)*

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Annex 4 - List of RSPO-recognised Human Rights Due Diligence methodologies for compliance to Indicator 1.3.1

This section of the document shall be completed once the list of RSPO-recognised Human Rights Due Diligence (HRDD) methodologies has been developed by the HRDD sub-group of the RSPO Human Rights Working Group (HRWG) and endorsed by the RSPO Standards Standing Committee (SSC). Due: August 2025.

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Annex 5 - Guidance

Principle	Criterion	Indicator	Guidance
1	1.1	1.1.1 (C)	Applicable management documents to be made publicly available are, at a minimum: A) Public summary of certification assessment report; B) Land titles/user rights (Reference: Criterion 2.3); C) Occupational health and safety plans (Reference Criterion 6.9); D) Action Plans and Social & Environmental Impact Assessments (SEIAs), including results of FPIC processes (Reference: Criterion 3.3, 4.3); E) HCV, HCS, and/or HCV-HCS documentation (Reference: Criterion 7.7); F) Pollution prevention and reduction plans (Reference: Criterion 7.2, 7.5, 7,6); G) Details of complaints and grievances (Reference: Criterion 2.5); H) Negotiation procedures (Criterion 4.5); I) Continuous improvement plans, including social programmes to mitigate negative impact or advance livelihoods (Criterion 3.3); and J) Human Rights Policy, including procedures for protecting Human Rights Defenders/whistleblowers (Criterion 2.4). Confidential information refers to management documents where public availability or distribution is prevented by legal requirements or confidentiality agreements/concerns. This includes: A) Commercial/financial data (e.g., costs, income, details related to customers); B) Data affecting personal privacy; C) Information where disclosure can result in potential negative environmental/social outcomes, such as sites of RTE species that can increase the risk of hunting or poaching; D) Information regarding sacred sites which a community wishes to maintain as private; and E) Ongoing disputes (within or outside of a legal mechanism) if disclosure can affect potential outcomes for all parties involved. This excludes access of affected stakeholders and those seeking resolution to conflict to relevant information. Management documents should be made available in language(s) comprehended by relevant stakeholders.
		1.1.2 (C)	The process(es)/procedure(s) can be incorporated into the UoC's broader policies, processes or procedures or documented separately.
		1.1.3 (C)	The list of relevant stakeholders include contact details and their nominated representatives (if any). Applicable national and local data privacy laws apply to the gathering, storage, usage, distribution, and publication of an identified relevant stakeholder's personal information.

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

	1.2	**1.2.1**	The policy is set within the framework of the UN Convention Against Corruption (in particular, Article 12 Private Sector). Important elements to be covered in the policy include: bribery; facilitation payments; guidance and procedure for gifts and hospitality; disclosure of political contributions; guidelines for charitable donations and sponsorships; respect for fair conduct of business; proper disclosure of information in accordance with applicable regulations and accepted industry practices; and compliance with existing anti-corruption legislation. Applies to contractors (Reference: Criterion 2.2); commitment to the policy incorporated into contracts.
		1.2.2	Ethical misconduct include any violation of the UoC's ethical conduct policy, such as: A) Charging fees to workers; B) Recovering cost of recruitment/transportation against workers' wages; and C) Receiving gifts/commissions from labour intermediaries or suppliers. Can be documented separately, or incorporated into the UoC's broader processes or procedures e.g. the UoC's grievance system (Reference: Criterion 2.5).
	1.3	**1.3.1**	The UoC engages with relevant stakeholders in the development, implementation, and review of any action plans to address identified human rights impacts. The HRDD tool employed aligns with the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights framework on HRDD or the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises on Responsible Business Conduct. Key steps for any HRDD cover the following steps, at a minimum: 1. Assessing actual and potential human rights impacts 2. Integrating and acting upon the findings 3. Tracking responses 4. Communicating how impacts are addressed. The UoC is encouraged to build capacity of its personnel to be able to conduct HRDD assessments instead of relying on third party providers. For those who may wish to avail itself of third party support, they may do so. It is not mandatory for UoCs to engage with third party providers. Relevant personnel involved in the HRDD assessments, action plan development and implementation should received HRDD capacity building and training.

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2	**2.1**	**2.1.1 (C)**	Implementing all legal requirements is an essential baseline requirement for all growers whatever their location or size. Relevant legal requirements include those governing, but not limited to: A) Land tenure and land use rights; B) Labour practices and policies; C) Agricultural development and operations; D) Environmental management; E) Pollution and pollutants; F) Transportation and processing practices; G) Laws made pursuant to a country's obligations under international laws or conventions; and H) Customary law(s) in countries with provisions to respect such law(s). Annex 2 provides a non-exhaustive list of key international laws and conventions applicable to the production of palm oil.
		2.1.2	The documented system can take the form of physical or virtual filing cabinet of applicable laws, regulations and rules, with elements of how they are interpreted and followed in the running of the UoC's operations. If contradictions and inconsistencies in the system are identified, with solutions suggested to improve the system.
		2.1.3 (C)	Depending on the legal context of a country, with or without National Interpretation, evidence of the legal status of the land includes: A) Land title(s)*; B) Evidence of land use rights; C) Evidence of land tenure; D) Land boundary maps; and E) Business/operating licence(s). *Including legal registration(s) or written authorisation(s) issued from government authority(ies).
	2.2	**2.2.1**	Due diligence process(es) or procedure(s) are in place for selecting and engaging contractors, particularly for private employment/recruitment agencies and labour intermediaries/providers. The list can include relevant information of the contractor, including contact information and scope of work.

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		2.2.2	Reference: Indicator 2.1.1 and its guidance for 'applicable and relevant national and local laws/regulations'. Specific focus should be on 'contractors' for FFB supply (suppliers). Ensuring that all contracts involving the UoC's contractors meets all requirements can be done by first ensuring compliance at a pre-contract phase, and then ensuring that the contract itself is compliant: **Pre-Contract** - Identify and determine specific legal, regulatory, and/or certification requirements applicable to the contractor's industry (Reference: Indicator 2.1.1). - Obtain necessary documentation(s) such as business licence(s), tax compliance certificate(s), and industry-specific certification(s). - Conduct due diligence, background checks, and verify authenticity of relevant documentation(s). **Contracts** - Incorporate and ensure specific clauses requiring contractors to maintain legal compliance throughout the contract duration are included. - Clearly state and specify requirement(s) for any ongoing or updated provision of legal compliance evidence or documentation.
		2.2.3	Specific clauses in the contract as aligned with the UoC's relevant policies or procedures, specifically: A) Child labour policy (Criterion 6.5); B) Forced/trafficked labour policy (Criterion 6.8); and C) Recruitment fees (and related costs) (Criterion 6.8). Young workers can only be contracted for employment if the contractual agreement contains clauses for their protection, including type of work, hours worked, and continued access to education (Reference: Criterion 6.5).
	2.3	**2.3.1 (C)**	Directly sourced FFB' refers to FFB obtained from the UoC's own managed supply bases or bought directly from scheme smallholders, independent smallholders, or outgrowers. The 'legal business licence' can include a valid planting, operating, or trading licence(s) of suppliers of directly sourced FFB, or proof that the supplier is part of a cooperative which allows the direct buying and selling of FFB. Depending on the country, the national or sub-national equivalent of a 'legal business licence' can be used as evidence.

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		2.3.2 (C)	Indirectly sourced FFB' refers to FFB that is not bought directly from suppliers, but bought through intermediates such as collection centres and FFB distribution agents/traders. The 'legal business licence' can include a valid planting, operating, or trading licence(s) of suppliers of indirectly sourced FFB, or proof that the supplier is part of a cooperative which allows the direct/indirect buying and selling of FFB. Depending on the country, the national or sub-national equivalent of a 'legal business licence' can be used as evidence. Progress towards full traceability and legality can be evidenced by maintaining a annual list of FFB indirect suppliers engaged, including any changes from the previous period. Progress towards full traceability and legality of indirectly sourced FFB through engagement is expected over the UoC's certification cycle; in situations where progress is not shown or has stalled, justification must be provided.
	2.4	**2.4.1 (C)**	The UoC may develop the respect for human rights policy(ies) as standalone (termed or named as appropriate), or incorporated into the UoC's broader policies. The policy should include the prohibition of the following negative actions against affected stakeholders (including Human Rights Defenders, complainants, whistleblowers, and/or community spokespersons who lodge complaints against the UoC): A) Retaliation; B) Intimidation, harassment, and threats; C) Violence (physical, sexual, or gender-based) and torture; D) Exploitation; E) Discrimination (access to employment, education and training); and F) Detention, disappearance, and killing. The policy applies to the UoC's business operations and conduct, including contractors (particularly contractors providing security services to the UoC, such as private military and private security companies).
		2.4.2	The policy applies to the UoC's contractors, but in particular to contractors that provided security services to the UoC, such as private military and private security companies. Mechanism(s) are in place to report alleged violations of the policy to the UoC's grievance system and remediation procedures (Reference: Criterion 2.5).
	2.5	**2.5.1 (C)**	The grievance system (or other name as deemed appropriate) is developed taking into consideration feedback and consultation from relevant stakeholders, especially workers and affected communities. Fair and transparent mechanisms to address complaints and grievances are in place, such as Joint Consultative Committees (JCC) with gender representation and migrant worker representation (where relevant).

Adopted v2024

			Further reference: Article 31 of the 2001 UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights: Implementing the UN 'Protect, Respect and Remedy' Framework.
		2.5.2	Specific process(es) or procedure(s) to handle cases of sexual harassment or involving children are in place. Where possible, nominated personnel in the UoC responsible for receiving, responding, addressing, and resolving such grievance case(s) are trained to handle allegations of such sensitive nature. Complainants are not prevented from seeking independent legal technical advice and external sources of information.
		2.5.3 (C)	The following information* is reported to RSPO via the RSPO Information System as part of the UoC's audit reports (previously incorporated into the Metrics Template; Reference: Indicator 3.2.2 in P&C 2018): A) Number of new grievance(s) raised; B) Number of grievance(s) resolved /closed; and C) Number of unresolved/active grievance(s). **Reported in an identical 12-month period for A, B, and C* If a resolution cannot be mutually agreed within the UoC's grievance system, such grievances can be brought to the attention of the RSPO through the RSPO's Complaints System.
3	**3.1**	**3.1.1 (C)**	The recommended duration of the business management plan is 3 years. Content of the plan may vary for growers, medium growers and scheme smallholders. The plan focuses on factors* within direct control of the UoC, such as: A) Quality of available planting materials; B) Replanting programme cycles in the UoC, historical and planned (Reference: Indicator 3.1.2); C) FFB crop yield trends, historical and projected; D) Oil Extraction Rate (OER) trends at the UoC's mill(s), historical and projected; E) Cost of production, historical and projected (e.g. cost per MT of crude palm oil produced); F) Crude palm oil prices, historical and projected (based on relevant global or local benchmarks); and/or G) Relevant financial indicators of the UoC. *Suggested reference for historical trends is a calculated 3-year running average (mean) over the previous 10 years. For FFB crop yield, trends will require adjustment for any lower crop yields during major replanting programmes. Where applicable, consideration for smallholders inclusion should be inherent in the UoC's business management planning (Reference: Principle 5). For smallholder schemes, the scheme management is expected to provide their members with information on significant improvements.

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		3.1.2	The plan projects replanting for at least five (5) years, and adjusted annually based on actual replanting activities. For existing plantations on peat, a longer projection time frame is required due to additional requirements for assessment (Reference: Criterion 7.4).
		3.1.3	Aspects assessed during annual review of the plan include: A) Results and insights of internal audits, including any opportunities for improvement; B) Status of implemented preventive and corrective actions; C) Process performance and product conformity; D) Customer feedback; E) Follow-up actions from prior management reviews; F) Changes that could affect the UoC's management system; and G) Recommendations for improvement.
	3.2	**3.2.1 (C)**	The SOPs, or equivalent documented procedures, also cover relevant RSPO Supply Chain Requirements for Mills (Reference: Criteria 3.5) and account for scheme smallholders (where applicable). When engaging with third party suppliers of FFB on traceability and legality (Reference: Criteria 2.3), the UoC supplements engagement by distributing relevant information on Good Agricultural Practices (GAP) or Best Management Practices (BMPs)
		3.2.2	For continuous improvement in production operations, action plan(s) are incorporated in the SOPs to: A) Optimise yield supply base(s); B) Reduce pesticide usage (Reference: Criteria 7.1); C) Mitigate environmental impacts (Reference: Principle 7); D) Reduce waste (Reference: Criteria 7.2); E) Reduce pollution and greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions (Reference: Criteria 7.6); F) Mitigate negative impacts on communities, workers and smallholders (Reference: Principle 4, 5, 6); and G) Integrated management of HCVs and HCS forests, peatlands and other conservation areas (Reference: Criteria 7.4, 7.7).

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

	3.3	**3.3.1 (C)**	An SEIA involves assessment of all major planned oil palm development activities (e.g., land clearing, planting, replanting, milling, transportation, operations, and other infrastructure activities) for potential negative impacts on: A) High Conservation Values (HCVs), High Carbon Stock (HCS) forests, biodiversity, and RTE species (within and beyond the UoC's concession boundaries; B) Adjacent or nearby natural ecosystems, including potential increased environmental pressure; C) Watercourses, wetlands, and hydrology/land subsidence (including quantity, quality, and access to water security/land resources); D) Soil health and integrity, in particular erosion, degradation, subsidence, and/or flooding based on baseline soil surveys and topographic information; E) Land profile (e.g. forest, degraded forest, cleared land); F) Land ownership, user rights, and current land use patterns by communities or on social amenities; G) Employment or employment opportunities (including changing employment terms); H) Social aspects (based on cost-benefit analysis); I) Impact on affected communities, particularly on livelihood, differential gender effects, ethnic groups, and migrants; J) Increased risk of human rights violations; K) Food security, including rights to adequate food for affected communities; and L) GHG emission and air quality.
		3.3.2 (C)	Management & monitoring plans are intended to address potential negative impacts of development, with mechanisms developed for mitigation such as: A) Social programmes avoiding or mitigating adverse social impact including human rights; B) Social programmes advancing community livelihoods and gender equality; C) Partnership programmes for independent smallholders (Criterion 5.2); D) Education and health programmes in the communities; and E) Management plans addressing specific environmental aspects e.g., water (Criterion 7.5), soil integrity/erosion risk (Criterion 7.3) During development of the plans, affected stakeholders are able to freely express their views (individually, through their own representative institutions, or through freely-chosen spokespersons) during the identification of potential negative impacts, review of assessment findings, development of plans for mitigation, and monitoring progress/efficacy of implementation.
		3.3.3 (C)	For scheme smallholders directly managed by the Unit of Certification, the UoC undertakes an impact assessment which can be incorporated into its management & monitoring plans or as a standalone plan that will be implemented with the scheme smallholders in accordance with the results of the assessment.

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	3.4	**3.4.1**	Current and potential FFB yield and productivity can be estimated and projected based on historical trends in: A) FFB crop yield; and B) Oil Extraction Rate (OER) at the UoC's mill(s); in order to calculate C) Productivity (crude palm oil production in MT per hectare of production area. Analysis of historical trends is intended to identify areas of improvement and/or gaps that hinder reaching the expected potential yield and productivity, for incorporation into the business management plan (Reference: Criteria 3.1)
		3.4.2	Plant nutrient level' refers to the comparison of the nutrients absorbed to the nutrient requirement to support plant growth and production. 'Soil fertility' refers to the availability of macro-nutrients and trace elements in the soil for supporting plant growth and production. Long-term fertility depends on maintaining the structure, organic matter content, nutrient status and microbiological health of the soil. Nutrient efficiency should take account of the age of plantations and soil conditions. The UoC's nutrient recycling plan (Reference: Indicator 7.2.2) is encouraged to consider any use of biomass for by-products or energy production to promote circularity while also minimising use of inorganic fertiliser.
		3.4.3	National standards or nationally/internationally recommended best practices serve as guidelines for the development of GAPs, as appropriate to the UoC's operations, scale and geography. RSPO has developed a library of Best Management Practices (BMPs) for specific topics that serve as a reference for the UoC in developing its GAPs.
	3.5	**3.5.1 (C)**	RSPO certified crude palm oil and palm kernel is known as Certified Sustainable Palm Oil (CSPO) and Certified Sustainable Palm Kernel (CSPK). Indicator 3.5.1 does not apply to Initial Certification audits. Indicator 3.6.1 is partially applicable to Annual Surveillance Audit 1 (ASA 1), due to an incomplete 12-month period. For all audits after ASA 1, Indicator 3.6.1 applies in full. For UoC's with integrated RSPO certified palm kernel crusher plants, actual annual production of Certified Sustainable Palm Kernel Oil (CSPKO) and Certified Sustainable Palm Kernel Expeller (CSPKE) processed from CSPK produced by the UoC's mills does not apply to Indicator 3.6.1. Certification of palm kernel crusher plants falls under the scope of the RSPO Supply Chain Certification (SCC) standard.
		3.5.2 (C)	Kernel Extraction Rate (KER) is the palm kernel equivalent of OER. Indicator 3.5.2 applies to all audits, from Initial Certification, Annual Surveillance Audit 1, and beyond.

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		3.5.3 (C)	The documented procedures includes: A) Complete and up-to-date records and reports that demonstrate compliance with the supply chain model requirements (including training records); B) Identification of the role of the person(s) having overall responsibility for and authority over the implementation of and compliance with the supply chain model requirements. The person(s) shall be able to demonstrate awareness the UoC's procedures to implement the requirements; and C) Operations for handling, receiving, and processing RSPO certified and non-certified FFB, particularly procedures to ensure no contamination of non-certified FFB in IP mills. Special attention is required for UoC's that are dual-certified as IP/MB, with documented procedures for separate IP and MB production lines.
		3.5.4 (C)	Any non-conformities identified and raised by the internal audit require corrective action(s). Outcomes of the internal audits and all corrective actions taken to address non-conformities is subject to management review (Reference Criteria 3.1). Internal audit records and reports of the UoC's mill(s) are to be maintained and made available at the point of RSPO audits.
		3.5.5 (C)	
		3.5.6 (C)	The information on Sales and Good Out includes, at a minimum: A) Name and address of the buyer; B) Name and address of the seller; C) Loading or shipment/delivery date; D) Date of document issuance; E) RSPO certificate number; F) Description of the certified oil palm product, including the applicable supply chain model (Identity Preserved or Mass Balance, or the appropriate approved abbreviations); G) Quantity of the products delivered; H) Available related transport documentation; and I) A unique identification number. The required information can be presented either on a single document or across a range of documents issued for RSPO certified oil palm products (e.g., delivery notes, shipping documents, or specification documentation.

Adopted Nov 2024

		3.5.7 (C)	For any outsourcing activities by independent third parties, the Unit of Certification is responsible to ensure that: A) The UoC's mill(s) has legal ownership of all input material to be included in outsourced processes; B) The UoC's mill(s) has an agreement or contract covering the outsourced process with each independent third party contractor through a signed and enforceable agreement The UoC's mill(s) is responsible for ensuring that the Certification Body (CB) has access to the contractor or operation if an audit is deemed necessary; C) The UoC's mill(s) has a documented control system with explicit procedures for the outsourced process that is communicated to the relevant contractor; and D) When announced in advance, the UoC's mill(s) ensure (e.g. through contractual arrangements) that independent third parties engaged are able to provide relevant access for duly accredited CB to their respective operations, systems, and all relevant information necessary for demonstrating compliance.
		3.5.8 (C)	Details of contractors include, at a minimum: A) Name(s); and B) Contact details.
		3.5.9 (C)	The recommended retention time for all records and reports is a minimum of two (2) years. Records/reports comply with relevant legal and regulatory requirements, and is able to confirm the certified status of raw materials or products held in stock. For the Identity Preserved supply chain module, the mill records and balance all receipts of certified FFB with deliveries of RSPO CSPO/CSPK on a real-time basis. For Mass Balance Module, the mill: A) Records and balances all receipts of certified FFB and deliveries of CSPO/CSPK on a real-time basis or a quarterly basis; B) Ensures that all volumes of CSPO and CSPK delivered are deducted from the material accounting system in the RSPO Information System according to conversion ratios stated by RSPO; and C) Only delivers Mass Balance volumes from a 'positive stock' position. 'Positive stock' positions can include MB CSPO/CSPK ordered for delivery within three (3) months. The UoC's mill(s) is also allowed to practice short-shelling (i.e., CSPO/CSPK sold before it is in stock).
		3.5.10 (C)	The Identity Preserved supply chain module covers both IP-certified and the IP line of dual IP/MB-certified UoCs. Separation of certified and non-certified oil palm products is expected to be achieved across all related processes and operations, including during transport and storage.

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		3.5.11 (C)	The registration/reporting requirements for mills are: A) Shipping Announcement(s), that are carried out by the UoC's mill(s) when RSPO certified oil palm products are sold as RSPO certified to refineries, kernel crushers, and/or traders not more than three months after dispatch*'; and B) RSPO certified oil palm product volumes sold under other certification scheme(s) or as conventional, are removed in the RSPO Information System. This also applies in the case of underproduction at the UoC's mill(s). *'After dispatch' is defined as the date of the Bill of Landing or the dispatch documentation date.
		3.5.12 (C)	
4	**4.1**	**4.1.1 (C)**	The UoC must develop a conflict/dispute resolution process to address and resolve issues. The process is established through open and consensual agreements with relevant affected parties. Gender representation is considered to ensure women's perspectives and rights are considered during the resolution process. The conflict/dispute resolution process can be developed and implemented as a separate system, or incorporated into the UoC's internal grievance system (Reference: Criterion 2.5). The process must be accessible by the communities (and their representatives, if any) themselves, or may initiated by the UoC in cases where communities do not wish to lodge grievances themselves. Those who have been dispossessed or forced to abandon their customary lands or other user rights, as well as nomadic communities, also have the right to access to the UoC's conflict/dispute resolution process. The process can be considered as both a relationship-building and risk-management tool, intended to diffuse, resolve, and remediate any disagreements, confrontations, and tensions between the UoC and indigenous peoples, affected communities, and/or other users (individuals/groups) in a practical and constructive manner. In the event, no resolution can be achieved and parties have exhausted all means available at the UoC, conflicts or disputes can be brought to the attention of the RSPO's Complaints System.
		4.1.2	The UoC can facilitate provision of access to independent legal and non-legal support and expertise for communities, if requested. However, this should be mindful of perceptions of conflict of interest, hence being able to link communities to independent sources of advisory, such as NGOs or the RSPO is important.
		4.1.3	There are several ways to show evidence of compliance to this indicator, in the form of physical, documents, oral, and/or analysis. Documents can include includes photos and/or video recordings. Auditors may use any of these ways to verify that the indicator has been met.
		4.1.4	Records of lodged conflict(s) are logged, documented and kept up-to-date. Information in the records include the status, resolution, and outcome of the conflict resolution. Parties to the conflict are informed of the progress of the lodged conflict or dispute as part of the process, including representatives of affected communities (if any). This includes any steps or actions taken by the UoC. For unresolved conflicts,

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			the UoC may include information on reasons hindering potential resolution of the conflict and steps to be taken towards conclusion.
	4.2	**4.2.1**	Consultations conducted with local affected communities are intended to focus on the identification of the community's needs, and the alignment of such needs to the UoC's proposed contributions. The UoC's contributions are based on the results of such consultations, with consideration for the different needs of men, women, and minority/vulnerable groups, and should have economic, social, and/or environmental benefits. Some examples of contributions to local sustainable development: poverty reduction; access to health and wellbeing; access to quality education; access to clean water and sanitation; conservation or restoration of natural resources; gender equality programmes and support, or enhanced food and water security for the communities. The UoC, as an oil palm company, will necessarily have limitations regarding the projects requested. Thus, parties to the discussion are encouraged to try their best to reach a realistic and amicable decision on the UoC's contributions. The UoC may also seek partnerships with non-governmental organisations (NGOs) and civil society organisations (CSOs) to identify key environmental and/or social issues prevalent in the community to develop and implement solutions to address them.
	4.3	**4.3.1 (C)**	The indicators under Criteria 4.3 apply to current operations of the UoC, but there are exceptions for long-established plantations which may not have records dating back to the time of the decision making, in particular for compliance with Indicators 4.3.2 and 4.3.3. In these cases, other types of evidence may be considered as sufficient. The absence of conflict may support the presumption that consent was obtained prior to operations. The FPIC process aims to ensure that consent has been obtained from legal, customary land owners and user rights. It should not be used as a tool to reopen old negotiated agreements between the UoC and customary/user rights owners unless there is demonstrable evidence of abuse of process. Where there are legal or customary rights over land, the Unit of Certification should demonstrate that these rights are understood and are not being threatened or reduced. This Criterion should be considered in conjunction with Criterion 4.4, 4.5 and 4.6. Where customary rights areas are unclear, the UoC should conduct a participatory mapping exercise together with affected parties including neighbouring communities and local authorities.
		4.3.2	Documentation of discussions and consultations are recorded, including copies of documents evidencing agreement-making processes and negotiated agreements detailing the FPIC process. Criterion 4.3 allows negotiated agreements to compensate affected communities and other users for lost benefits and/ or relinquished rights. Negotiated agreements should be non-coercive and entered into voluntarily, carried out prior to new

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			investments or operations, and based on an open sharing of all relevant information. The representation of communities should be transparent and in open communication with other community members.
		4.3.3 (C)	Participatory mapping also known as 'community mapping', is based on the premise that communities have knowledge of their customary tenure and surrounding environments, which can be expressed in simple maps. It allows communities to bring their local knowledge and perspectives to the attention of authorities and the UoC. Once the UoC has identified all the relevant stakeholders (indigenous peoples, local communities, and other users) involved, they should collaborate in the mapping process to identify features communities perceive as important such as customary land boundaries, how they use the forest, sacred areas, and so on. This is to ensure that future negotiations are based on a clear understanding of the various rights involved. The UoC should ensure that the community includes their elders who know the local history and culture. Both men and women should also be included since they use the land differently. It is important to include all communities if the land in question is used by several communities. This will help avoid conflicts where neighbours might dispute boundaries. The participatory mapping includes neighbouring communities, where applicable. Mapping of disputed area(s) shall be conducted with engagement, consultation, and participation of affected communities. Technology such as the Global Positioning System (GPS) and Geographic Information System Software (GIS) have made these processes easier and feasible.
		4.3.4	
		4.3.5 (C)	Affected communities are informed at the beginning that they may choose to represent themselves or through expert and third parties during the negotiations with the UoC on land use. Examples of experts include individuals/organisations that well versed in social, cultural, economic, political, historical, land tenure and livelihoods aspects of communities and are equipped with a wide range of skills (for instance, a land expert, a social anthropologist, an economist, or a local person who speaks the local language). The primary role of experts would be to provide indigenous peoples, local communities, and other users with relevant information so that they will be able to make an independent and informed decision on matters related to their land rights. Examples of third parties include lawyers, NGOs and religious bodies, to help with assessments, contracts and technical parts of the negotiation process. The community may choose to invite them to assist in their decision-making process. The primary role of third parties would be to assist indigenous peoples, local communities, and other users on representation, to allow for a more informed and independent voice, during communication with the UoC, and to ensure that negotiations are carried out fairly. The roles of third parties may differ, depending on the nature and function of the third party, and the purpose of the communication or negotiation.

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			Anyone who offers advice or helps the local community in the decision-making process must be independent of the UoC involved to eliminate any bias and avoid a conflict of interest.
		4.3.6	The FPIC process does not end with the signing of a negotiated agreement between the UoC and the affected communities. Once the agreement has been signed by all relevant parties, it must be monitored annually to ensure effective FPIC implementation. A participatory monitoring procedure that involves representatives from both the UoC and the community ensures validation of results against commitments and allows for adjustments as development activities progress. More reliable monitoring results can be found through community monitoring (including community-selected indicators) because of indigenous peoples' knowledge and use of the land, water and natural resources. Where negotiated agreement(s) contain terms requiring non-compensation related remediation, the UoC shall demonstrate evidence that affected communities are consulted annually through the implementation review. Monitoring and follow-up process(es) should be in place, consulted, reviewed, and agreed with the identified communities. Results of any consultation(s) with affected communities on implementation of negotiated agreement(s) shall be documented. In cases where the UoC does not take into account results of such consultations in implementation, the UoC is expected to document and justify its reasons for rejecting the input.
	4.4	**4.4.1 (C)**	It is important to note that documents of land ownership for indigenous peoples are not always on paper, and customary or user rights often times are not recorded in documents. The RSPO recognises rights of indigenous peoples and tribal peoples over their lands. It is encouraged that other forms of ownership are given due recognition. Emphasis on evidence of land title as the only proof of rights over land should be avoided. Taking into account the disadvantages faced by indigenous peoples in proving their land-holding, the following considerations apply: A) Legal registration of land may not be the only available evidence of rights. There may be official documentary evidence, but these may relate to legal or tribunal action, or registration of births, death, and marriage. Evidence could also be in the form of recognition by the town head or village head. B) There should always be verification with communities on whether they have been adequately consulted and given their consent; and C) Indigenous rights to land may not look similar to what land-holding looks like in the conventional system, owing to the specific traits of some indigenous communities. In confirming the land rights of indigenous communities, evidence may be available from elders or from the land itself. For example, the community may have ancestral burial plots or made changes to the land to cater to their daily lives, such as traditional canals and drainages for agriculture or clusters of crops, or sites to traditionally process foods or for animal slaughter. A site visit as facilitated by the indigenous peoples themselves may be important to understand this.

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		4.4.2 (C)	The FPIC process(es)/procedure(s) should be integrated with the UoC's Social and Environmental Impact Assessment (SEIA) (Reference: Criterion 3.3). Where new plantings are considered to be acceptable after an FPIC process resulting in a negotiated agreement, the UoC's management & monitoring plan and its implementation (Criterion 3.3) incorporates the deliverables of the negotiated agreements, including maintenance of sacred sites (if any). The FPIC process should fully respect the legal and customary rights of local communities to their territories, lands, and resources. FPIC is obtained through local communities' own representative institutions, such as community leaders, traditional authorities, or elected representatives. The community representatives are recognised and accepted by the communities involved. Any agreements between the UoC and indigenous peoples, local communities, and/or other stakeholders should be made without coercion or other undue influence. Relevant stakeholders include those affected by, or concerned, with the new plantings. Customary and user rights are demonstrated through participatory mapping as part of FPIC. The UoC should not restrict access to markets for local communities through its operations.
		4.4.3	Neither party is obliged to agree to anything they do not want to. Communities have the right to say "no" to the proposed development at any time. This also means that the UoC is not compelled to meet community demands.
		4.4.4	Within the FPIC process(es)/procedure(s), mechanisms to balance potential negative impacts on food and water security for local communities should be discussed and agreed between the UoC and the local communities. In cases where the availability, access, quality, and stability of food and water mechanisms are negatively affected by the planned operations, mitigation and relief measures should be agreed. The UoC should also assess water catchments in order to identify key water risks or shared challenges. Where applicable, for communities resettled in accordance with FPIC, the UoC should monitor food and water security through continuous dialogue with the affected communities. Local peoples' knowledge of food and water systems is integrated into the SEIA through participatory mapping and land-use planning processes. Local food production practices, water management strategies, and community needs are considered when developing plans for land allocation and use.
		4.4.5	Sufficient time and planning is required and should be put in place for any FPIC process. This is to ensure that complete information is being shared with communities to inform their decision making, reasonable time is provided to digest this information and also to consult internally as a community in order to arrive at a collective decision through their own decision-making mechanisms. The UoC can facilitate provision of access to independent legal and non-legal support and expertise for communities, if requested. This should be mindful of perceptions of conflict of interest, hence being able to link communities to independent sources of advisory, such as NGOs or the RSPO is important.

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			The UoC should work closely with bodies and organisations to help ensure that communities are independently informed of their rights and entitlements and have access to legal counsel and technical advice.
		4.4.6	Consent has been obtained, without any coercion, intimidation or manipulation. Communities are free to raise any negative or positive issues relating to the development. At each stage in the process, the UoC must consider whether anything is happening that may undermine communities' collective, self-determined and autonomous control and decision-making. It may be necessary to conduct due diligence to ensure that the UoC is not unfairly benefiting from an unequal bargaining position, and what can be done to prevent this. Throughout the FPIC process, the use of manipulation, coercion or intimidation is avoided. Examples include: A) Manipulation: offers of bribes, gifts, inducements, incentives, or other unregulated or questionable patronage to community leaders or individuals to relinquish land without the wider communities' knowledge or agreement. B) Coercion: use of government or private security forces to pressure communities into relinquishing their lands. C) Intimidation: in some situations, communities may feel intimidated by the very presence of government agencies in meetings. Prior consent means undertaking the consultation process sufficiently in advance of the proposed project to allow the community to reach a decision in a timely manner using their customary decision-making process.
		4.4.7	
		4.4.8 (C)	Voluntary isolation refers to 'peoples, or parts of them, who significantly limit their relationships with people foreign to their collectivities.' Source: Beatriz Huertas Castillo, Respect for the Self-Determination and Protection of Indigenous Peoples in Isolation, 2020, published by the IWGIA.
	4.5	**4.5.1 (C)**	Where there is a conflict on the condition of land use as per land title, the Unit of Certification should show evidence that necessary action has been taken to resolve the conflict with relevant parties.
		4.5.2 (C)	
		4.5.3	Men and women are able to hold land titles.
		4.5.4	Documented systems for compensation within the negotiated agreement should include process(es)/procedure(s) for: A) Identification of: - Legal, customary or user rights; and - People entitled to compensation of rights ; B) Calculation and distribution of fair and gender-equal compensation (monetary or otherwise), including corrective action as a result of the evaluation; and C) Provision of equal opportunities to both men and women to hold land titles for small holdings

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	4.6	**4.6.1 (C)**	Compensation refers to appropriate and proportional award and/or payment (monetary or non-monetary) in recognition of loss and assessable damages. Examples (non-exhaustive) include: A) Monetary – payment for use of lands and/or losses of livelihood and/or income to the individuals entitled (e.g. the collective community rather than specific individuals for a collective grievance) B) Non-monetary - options such as land excision, land swaps, assistance with land titling, changed terms of land rental or lease, allocation of smallholdings, co-management, community shareholdings, community development, and compensation through the provision of services, infrastructures or other assistance.
		4.6.2 (C)	There should not be gender preference in the distribution of any compensation, unless subject to customary laws and/or traditions. In the absence of any customary laws and/or traditions on the entitlement of different genders to compensation or land-holdings, there should not be no discrimination or gender exclusion.
		4.6.3	Relevant non-monetary compensation or opportunities may include negotiated benefit-sharing agreements, joint venture agreements, legal representation on management boards, restrictions on prior land use, co-management arrangements, smallholder contracts, rental and leasehold arrangements, royalty payments, and the implications of land acquisition and permits for community land tenure, use and access rights.
	4.7	**4.7.1**	Where there is a conflict on the condition of land use as per land title, the Unit of Certification is expected to evidence that necessary action has been taken to resolve the conflict with relevant parties.
		4.7.2 (C)	Conflicts can lead to displacement of communities, labour shortage, problems in accessing credit and land, and casualties. Smallholders exposed to conflicts are also at risk and are sometimes forced to change land use patterns and crop portfolios, reallocate their labour structure, or destroy their physical assets to protect productivity. Conflicts not only impact the UoC and the surrounding communities, but also the entire supply chain.
		4.7.3	
		4.7.4	
5	**5.1**	**5.1.1 (C)**	Process(es)/procedure(s) for fair and transparent conduct with all smallholders can be developed as part of a smallholder inclusion/support policy, or incorporated into a broader overall smallholder policy (named as appropriate). Coverage includes both scheme and independent smallholders, or other forms of oil palm smallholdings depending on the national context. Fair Pricing - In countries or regions where FFB prices are regulated by governments, authorities, or equivalent endorsed initiatives, fair pricing is expected to be equal to or above established prices. In countries or regions where FFB prices are unregulated, establishing fair pricing includes consideration of: A) Level of costs incurred by the smallholders (e.g., fertiliser, seeds, pesticides, transportation/fuel, labour, land preparation/use permits/ownership fees); and B) Situations of unexpected/unpredictable operational, environmental, or climate-related risks (e.g., extreme weather, climate change effects, human/agricultural disease or pest outbreaks and epidemics).

Adopted 19 Nov 2024

			Fair pricing also applies in situations where the UoC functions as the group manager for scheme or independent smallholder groups certified under P&C group certification or separately under the ISH Standard.
		5.1.2 (C)	The contractual agreement(s) and subsequent transactions with smallholders under the agreement takes into account known issues or complexities, such as the role of intermediates, transport and storage of FFB, as well as quality and grading of FFB. Where possible, engagement by the UoC with intermediates, especially third-party collection centres and FFB distribution agents/traders, can improve and ensure fair and transparent conduct across its supply base(s) and network of smallholders.
		5.1.3 (C)	Smallholders have the right and be provided with the means to access to the UoC's Grievance System on issues regarding a contractual agreement (particularly fair pricing for FFB), whether or not middlemen are involved (Reference: Criterion 2.5).
		5.1.4 (C)	While both scheme and independent smallholders are included in the scope of Indicator 5.1.4, preference should be prioritise on sourcing physical certified FFB from RSPO certified independent smallholders, where possible.
	5.2	**5.2.1**	The smallholder support plan can be developed as part of a smallholder support/inclusion policy or incorporated into a broader overall smallholder policy (named as appropriate). Trainings should emphasise Good Agricultural Practices (GAP) obliged by: A) National regulations; B) Industrial GAP for oil palm cultivation; and/or C) Relevant sustainable agricultural practices mandated by RSPO standards or recommended by RSPO Best Management Practices (BMPs). Specific trainings crucial to support RSPO certification include topics such as health and safety, Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC), and conservation/management of High Conservation Values.
		5.2.2	The smallholder support plan beyond interested smallholders to include other intermediates associated with the UoC's supply base, such as third-party collection centres, FFB distribution agents/traders, FFB cooperatives, or representative organisations. Additional support for interested smallholders can include collaboratively identifying areas where sustainable agricultural practices have a high potential to increase smallholder FFB productivity, in balance with environmental and social impacts.

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		5.2.3	Potential opportunities/initiatives for smallholder livelihood improvement include: A) Quality and process controls; B) Access to high-yielding oil palm seeds and/or seedlings; C) Organisational, managerial, and/or financial competency; D) Support for RSPO standards and procedures, including certification under RSPO ISH Standard; and E) Support for other RSPO smallholder initiatives, such as the RSPO Smallholder Training Academy. Publicly available annual progress reports of the UoC's smallholder inclusion/support policy and plans, and other smallholder initiatives by the UoC, is encouraged. In such reports, a specific focus is on inclusion and support mechanisms provided to interested smallholders within the UoC's supply base, particularly if the additional opportunities and initiatives exceed the requirements of Criterion 5.1. Positive impacts are emphasised, challenges are highlighted, and solutions publicised for the benefit of other RSPO UoCs with smallholders in their supply bases.
6	**6.1**	**6.1.1 (C)**	Non-discriminatory practices are applied to all workers, regardless of contractual status. During the recruitment process, due consideration should be given to the need of medical examinations and their relevance to the workers in relation to the job for which they are considered. Medical examinations should serve prevention and protection purposes which include the protection and promotion of workers' health, protection of access to work, entitlement to compensation, health insurance benefits, and social protection. Medical examinations should not be used in a discriminatory way. Any distinction, exclusions, or preference in respect to a particular job based on the inherent requirements thereof should not be deemed to be discrimination.

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

		6.1.2 (C)	Equal opportunities principle apply to recruitment, hiring, work scope, pay and benefits facilities, work equipment, opportunities, and resources to improve themselves through training and capacity development programmes. Examples include: **Recruitment and Hiring Practices:** A) Job opportunity/vacancy advertisements without any discriminatory language/remarks. B) Fair and unbiased selection criteria during the hiring process such as explicit criteria for evaluating candidates, such as education, relevant experience, skills, and abilities. These criteria should be directly related to the requirements of the job and applied consistently to all applicants. **Promotion and Advancement:** A) Documented promotion decisions based on merit and performance evaluations. B) Career advancement opportunities available to all workers. **Training and Development:** A) Demonstrable equal access to training programs for all workers. B) Documented participation in training and development initiatives across to all workers. **Pay and Benefits:** A) Demonstrable equal pay for equivalent work roles (Reference: Indicator 6.1.3). B) Benefits provided equally to all workers regardless of background or characteristics. **Job Evaluation Process:** A) Documented formal job evaluation process to assess the requirements of each position within the organisation. B) Documented job descriptions outlining the responsibilities, qualifications, and skills required for each role.
		6.1.3	
	6.2	**6.2.1 (C)**	Steps to be followed for each process in the procedure clearly outlined. Through practice or evaluations, any contradictions and inconsistencies should be addressed. Socialisation involves actively engaging workers in understanding the procedures, their importance, and their implications. This can be achieved through orientation programs, training sessions, workshops, or other interactive methods. Any changes to the employment procedures should be updated to the workers.
		6.2.2 (C)	Changes to the employment agreement or contract can made to meet local laws or regulations and provide equal or better terms. Any amendments made to the employment contract should have the explicit consent of the workers, except for terms and conditions outlined in a Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA), where applicable.

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

			Periodic reviews conducted can ensure ongoing compliance with terms and conditions outlined in employment contracts, CBAs, and relevant labour laws, with any identified discrepancies addressed promptly.
		6.2.3	Documented evidence indicating the location where the contract was signed should be maintained. including pre-departure and post-orientation documents and acknowledgments from workers. Copies of the signed employment contracts shall be given to the workers at the country where they were hired for their reference.
		6.2.4	The worker register should include the following information for all workers: A) Types of employment (e.g., permanent, temporary, casual/ day, and piece-rated workers); B) Job scope; C) Gender; D) Length of service; E) Country of origin; F) Worker contact information; and G) Next-of-kin contact information. The worker register should be updated regularly (e.g., when there is a resignation, termination, or change of employment), ensuring accuracy and completeness of information for each worker. Subject to national and local laws/regulations/policies (Reference: Indicator 2.1.1), workers that are in the process of regularisation should be included in the worker register. This includes migrant workers and their migrant worker status. They should have access to the rights and facilities as other workers until or unless their application for regularisation have been rejected by the authorities. Records of remediation of cases of forced labour, trafficking in persons may include but are not limited to: A) Shelter and accommodation; B) Medical and health-care services and counselling, including mental health and psychosocial support; C) Compensation/repayment; D) Financial assistance; E) Legal assistance; F) Return assistance; or Gi) Reintegration Assistance.

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		6.2.5	To ensure that permanent, full-time employed workers are used for all core work in the UoC, workforce planning (the number of permanent workers and casual/short-term workers needed by work type throughout the year) can be conducted, following these key steps: A) Identify all types of tasks (e.g. harvesting, fertilizer application, pesticide spraying, pruning, etc.) B) For each type of task, identify whether the work is required year-long or if it is occasional/seasonal. For work that is required continuously all year long, use permanent, full-time workers. C) For work that is required occasionally and not always available throughout the year, identify the total volume of work and the workforce needed. If 2 or more types of work can be performed by the same worker at different times of the year, the workforce needs for these types of work can be aggregated. The aggregated workforce needs can be rounded down to determine the permanent workers required, with the decimal can be used to determine the casual and short-term workers required. *(Adapted from Earthworm Guideline on Fair Employment of Casual workers https://www.earthworm.org/uploads/files/Guideline-Fair-Employment-of-Casual-workers.pdf)* Regular reviews of a workforce plan would be necessary. If the existing number of permanent workers is below what is actually needed, a plan should be developed to identify which casual and short-term workers are eligible for a permanent, full-time contract; how many workers in total need to be promoted; and over what length of time this will be done. A plan should be time-bound and adjusted according to the (forecasted) financial situation for management buy-in and budget approval.
		6.2.6 (C)	Payslips should contain the following information: A) Date of payment; B) Pay period; C) Wage rates (basic wages, cost-of-living allowances and other guaranteed and regularly paid allowances, each listed separately); D) Overtime payments, bonuses and gratuities, family allowances, and other social security payments; E) Gross and net amounts of the payment; and F) Purpose of each amount deducted from the gross amount of the payment, or the name and number of the fund or account into which the amount of the deduction was paid.

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		6.2.7 (C)	Achievable work targets' refer to achievable output of work within standard working hours. For instance, this can be defined in terms of area or volume such as hectares of land to be harvested or sprayed with pesticide. In countries where there is no legal piece-rate work, the wage can be calculated based on the legal minimum wage following these steps: A) Work out how many 'pieces' have been completed in a normal working hour; B) Divide this by the number of workers to work out the average rate; C) Divide this number by 1.2 so that new workers are disadvantaged if they are not as fast or skilled as the others yet; and D) Divide the hourly minimum wage rate by that number to work out the rate for each piece of work completed. *(Reference: https://www.ilo.org/resource/17-piece-rate-pay)* The ILO Hours of Work (Industry) Convention, 1919 (No. 1) and Hours of Work (Commerce and Offices) Convention, 1930 (No. 30) can serve as references for overtime rate where no national legal rate or at the rate under the CBA is available.
		6.2.8 (C)	If no applicable laws are available, the ILO Workers' Housing Recommendation, 1961 (No. 115) should be a reference. Examples of welfare amenities include, but are not limited to: A) Rest and recreation facilities (football field, badminton court, basketball court etc, excluding holiday facilities); B) Food facilities (canteens); and C) Transport facilities (suitable parking or storage facilities where necessary and practicable). *(Adapted from ILO R102 - Welfare Facilities Recommendation, 1956 (No. 102))*
		6.2.9	To ensure access to safe, sufficient, and affordable food, the Unit of Certification can undertake several measures, including: A) Establish on-site dining facilities or facilitating access to nearby food establishments or convenience stores that offer meals or produce at reasonable prices in comparison to those off-site; B) Ensure that workers have means to access food if it's not available on-site, for instance, by arranging transportation to nearby stores; or C) Ensure that workers living on-site have appropriate food storage and preparation appliances (e.g. refrigerator, cooking appliances) to prepare, maintain freshness and safety of food. In essence, securing access to safe, sufficient, and affordable food necessitates addressing various factors that impact workers' capacity to procure and consume food essential for their health and well-being.

Adopted 13 Nov 2024

	6.3	**6.3.1 (C)**	Prevailing wage is the sum of base wage, cash allowances, bonuses, fringe benefits, and in-kind benefits. Not all allowances, bonuses, and benefits qualify to be added as prevailing wage (e.g., legally mandated benefits and wages earned during overtime cannot be included). The RSPO Prevailing Wages Calculation Procedure is the reference to determine which allowances, bonuses, fringe benefits, and in-kind benefits to be included as part of prevailing wage calculations. Until the Procedure has been developed and endorsed for implementation, the reference is the RSPO Guidance on Calculating Prevailing Wages 2019. The Unit of Certification should have a written policy committing to the implementation of living wage.
	6.4	**6.4.1 (C)**	The right of staff and workers, including migrant. transmigrant workers and contract workers, to form associations and worker representative committees to bargain collectively with the Unit of Certification, is respected and in accordance with Conventions 87 and 98 of the ILO. Collective bargaining is encouraged to encompass terms and conditions pertinent to workers' rights, their working and living conditions including the well-being of workers and their families (e.g., access to healthcare, education, food, safety gear, and utilities and addressing grievances and seeking remedies). Foreign and migrant workers should be made aware and updated of their entitlement to join unions or worker organisations. In cases where legal restrictions hinder the exercise of freedom of association and collective bargaining, the Unit of Certification should publish a statement fostering alternative avenues for independent and unrestricted association and negotiation among all personnel concerned.
		6.4.2	Protection against discrimination of workers participating in Worker Organisation can be demonstrated through establishing confidential reporting channels, conducting regular training, and promptly investigating and addressing any reported incidents of intimidation, harassment, or retaliation.
		6.4.3	
	6.5	**6.5.1 (C)**	Work by children on scheme smallholder family farms, where the farm is contracted to another entity, is prohibited. Work by children on family farms is acceptable under adult supervision where children are part of the family and the work does not interfere with their education and they are not exposed to hazardous working conditions. A formal employment relationship is not required for child labour to be present.

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		6.5.2 (C)	The minimum working age, together with working hours, should be clearly defined. Any hazardous work should not be done by those under 18 years old, as per ILO Convention 138 on the minimum age and No. 182 on the worst forms of child labour. Hazardous work for children is work that is likely to harm the health, safety or morals of children. Certain types of work carry particular risks, but any form of work done by a child may contain hazards that can harm them. Children may be directly exposed to obvious work hazards such as sharp tools or poisonous chemicals. Other hazards for children may be less apparent, such as the risk of abuse or problems resulting from excessive hours of work.
		6.5.3 (C)	Age verification documents include a government recognised photographic identification document, where available. For further guidance, refer to the RSPO Guidance on Child Rights. Examples of child labour remediation include informing the child's parents, taking child out of the work site, and conducting medical testing to assess physical and mental health. Personnel involved in recruitment, hiring, and monitoring of workers are trained on the age screening verification procedure and child labour remediation. Procedures should be accessible to relevant personnel, and regularly reviewed and updated to reflect changes in regulations or best practices.
	6.6	**6.6.1 (C)**	The policy should include clear guidelines and procedures for investigation, disciplinary actions/sanctions, and remediation of incidents in the workplace. Abuse is defined as the 'physical, sexual, emotional, economic, or psychological actions or threats of actions that influence another person. This includes any behaviours that frighten, intimidate, terrorise, manipulate, hurt, humiliate, blame, injure, or wound someone.'
	6.7	**6.7.1 (C)**	The policy should also address equal opportunities (Reference: Indicator 6.1.2). Development of the policy should include consultation with female staff and workers, and other relevant stakeholders. Progress in implementing the policy should be regularly monitored, and the results recorded.

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		6.7.2 (C)	Programmes particular issues faced by women in the UoC should be provided, especially for awareness on violence and sexual harassment in the workplace. This Committee should include representatives from all areas of work, and its duties include: A) Addressing issues of concern as well as opportunities for improvements for women workers; B) Training and capacity development for career advancement for women; C) Identifying risks and raising awareness among workers on womens' safety and health (e.g., access to healthcare during pregnancy, delivery, and postpartum); D) Organising annual training on women's rights; E) Discussing continual improvements that may be made by the UoC on women's issues or women's concerns (e.g., child care facilities, women allowed to breastfeed up to nine months before resuming chemical spraying tasks, break times for breastfeeding); or F) Providing counselling for women affected by violence and/or sexual harassment. A 'safe and secure meeting place' is one that prioritises the physical and emotional wellbeing of the participants, with characteristics of: A) Privacy; B) Comfort (e.g. lighting, ventilation, sanitation facilities); C) Risk free (e.g. free from potential risk/hazards); D) Secure; and E) Culturally sensitivity (e.g. meetings should not be conducted in religious places as to respect workers from different religious background).
		6.7.3 (C)	Pregnancy test can be required in certain circumstances especially where its legally mandated. Pregnancy tests should be relevant to the job requirement. Tests should be conducted to assess a worker's ability to perform a task associated with the job without posing a risk to their health or safety. If a woman is found to be pregnant during a pregnancy test, the Unit of Certification should handle the situation with sensitivity and respect for the individual privacy, and in compliance with applicable law and regulations. Adequate space and paid breaks should be provided to enable mothers with infants 24 months or younger to breastfeed or express and store breast milk with privacy.
		6.7.4	

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	6.8	**6.8.1 (C)**	National Interpretations should include information on national regulations governing recruitment fees and related costs, where applicable. The ILO Indicators of Forced Labour' and the 'Hard to See, Harder to Count' ILO guidelines represent the most common signs or "clues" that point to the possible existence of a forced labour case and can be taken into account by the Unit of Certification when formulating the policies. The 11 International Labour Organisation's Indicators of Forced Labour consists of: A) Abuse of vulnerability; B) Deception; C) Restriction of movement; D) Isolation; E) Physical and sexual violence; F) Intimidation and threats; G) Retention of identity documents; H) Withholding of wages; I) Debt bondage; J) Abusive working and living conditions; and K) Excessive overtime. The presence of one of the above indicators may not immediately imply the existence of forced labour. The surrounding circumstances must be examined holistically to lead to a finding that forced labour exists.
		6.8.2 (C)	Any statutory deductions or authorised deductions can be determined by applicable laws and regulations. Some authorised deductions may include the following: A) Mandatory payments to income tax authorities or social security institutions; B) Payment of contributions to voluntary provident or pension funds and other similar schemes; C) Trade union fees under arrangements made between a worker organisation of which the worker is a member; D) "Solidarity fee" from the wages of non-unionised workers who have benefited from a collective agreement concluded by a trade union; or E) Payment of contributions to cooperative associations and workers' mutual funds etc. Deliberate retention of wages is recognised as a form of coercion (as the worker has to stay because outstanding wages will be lost if he or she leaves, hence there is a penalty for leaving). Deposits or run-away fee is the withholding of cash or other assets belonging to the worker as a means of controlling the worker and preventing them from leaving.

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		6.8.3 (C)	Remediation of cases of forced labour and trafficking in persons may include providing: A) Shelter and accommodation; B) Medical and health-care services and counselling, including mental health and psychosocial support; C) Compensation/repayment; D) Financial assistance; E) Legal assistance; F) Return assistance; or G) Reintegration assistance.
		6.8.4 (C)	Without undue delay' generally means no more than seven (7) working days upon the receipt of the documents by the Unit of Certification following completion of mandatory legal or immigration processing purposes. If documents such as passport are required to be renewed, the UoC should provide workers with a certified copy of the document during the renewal period. Examples of for secure storage facilities include: A) Lockable storage; or B) Personal locker, cupboard with lock and key. Workers are responsible to pay for replacing stolen, lost, or damaged government-issued identity papers and passports due to negligence when under their care; and to immediately inform the UoC upon such loss or damage.
		6.8.5 (C)	Reasonable measures necessary for workers' health, safety, and security that may restrict their freedom to enter and exit their accommodation and the workplace are permissible, include: A) Health - mandatory quarantine periods in accordance with national regulations or the need to request prior permission of the supervisor to attend a medical appointment (not applicable for medical emergency); B) Safety and Security - The UoC may keep an exit and entry records, restriction to access hazardous work sites for the protection of the safety and security of workers. Reasonable security measures may be adopted to ensure the safety and privacy of workers and property; or C) Employment terms specifying working hours. When workers leave the premises of Unit of Certification outside working hours, the Unit of Certificate shall not use surveillance to restrict the movement of these workers. Surveillance is the continuous observation and monitoring for the purpose of restricting freedom of movement, including the use of surveillance cameras or security personnel/agents accompanying workers when they leave the site. Keeping exit and entry record is not considered as surveillance.
		6.8.6 (C)	When workers' accommodation is located in a remote or secluded location, it is important to provide workers with means to communicate with the outside world at affordable/public prices (that is, not inflated). Especially for workers who live on site without their family or are migrants. It is a good practice to provide workers with free transportation to and from surrounding communities to access leisure facilities, banking, or shopping, particularly if the housing is remotely located and where ordinary public transport is inadequate or impracticable.

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		6.8.7 (C)	Workers are able to withdraw their consent for overtime work without repercussions.
		6.8.8 (C)	
	6.9	**6.9.1 (C)**	The policy or policies should reference national law or regulation, or at a minimum reference the following: - ILO Occupational Safety and Health Convention, 1981 (No. 155) - ILO Occupational Safety and Health Recommendation, 1981 (No. 164) - ILO Safety and Health in Agriculture Convention, 2001 (No. 184)
		6.9.2 (C)	The H&S Committee can serve as a platform for workers to raise health and safety concerns. An issue raised and its action plan should be recorded and reviewed in the next H&S meeting. The following activities of the Committee should be documented with records kept: A) Minutes or records of the Committee's meetings - including details of discussions, decisions, and actions taken on workplace health and safety issues; B) Regular worksite safety inspections conducted by the Committee - including inspection reports, findings, and corrective actions implemented; C) Training sessions conducted for employees on health and safety topics, including attendance records and training materials; D) Reviews of the Hazard Identification, Risk Assessment, and Risk Control (HIRARC) - including assessment reports, action plans, and follow-up actions; E) Process(es) for safe storage, handling, mixing, use, and disposal of chemicals in the workplace established by the Committee; F) Continuous improvement initiatives to enhance health and safety performance - such as improvement plans, performance indicators, and monitoring records; and G) Any collaboration between the Committee and the Women's Welfare and Empowerment Committee (Reference: Indicator 6.7.2) to address specific health and safety risks for women workers, including meeting minutes or joint initiatives.
		6.9.3 (C)	For countries without a National Interpretation, a 'competent personnel' refers to a person possessing adequate qualifications (such as suitable training, sufficient knowledge, experience, and skills) to conduct the HIRARC assessment. A certified health and safety officer may define appropriate criteria for the designation of such a person(s) and may determine the duties to be assigned to them. (Reference: The ILO Safety and Health in Construction Recommendation, 1988 (No. 175), item 2(g))
		6.9.4 (C)	Annual reviews of the H&S plan should address, at a minimum: A) Newly identified and existing health and safety risks; B) Resulting effect of A) on accident rates; and C) Work time losses.

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		6.9.5 (C)	The PPE provided should be: A) Suitable for the task being performed; B) Appropriate to the worker (e.g. height, size etc); C) In good condition and not exposing to hazards; and D) Effective for workers to carry out their task safely. The designated area for washing PPE should have be supplied with clean water and equipped with appropriate cleaning agents. PPE used for operations involving chemicals only be washed and kept in this designated area; it should not be kept in a worker's living quarters. Records denoting the type of PPE provided, date of issuance, and the identity of the worker receiving the equipment is considered best practice. It is recommended that such records also include the details/reasons of PPE replacement (whether damaged or worn-out, past the date of replacement, recommendations for improvement, or any other feedback/concern from the worker regarding the condition and effectiveness of provided PPE).
		6.9.6 (C)	Relevant workers may refer, but not limited to, workers handling pesticides/chemicals, existing workers with new or expanded job scopes, workers operating heavy machinery. or identified pregnant woman/women who have given birth within the last six months.
		6.9.7	Where there is a national law or regulation mandating the ratio between the trained first aid kit personnel and the numbers of workers, this applies to the UoC (Reference: Indicator 2.1.1). The personnel should be trained and (ideally) certified in first aid procedures.
		6.9.8	An ERP outlines protocols and actions to be taken in the event of emergencies, including medical emergencies, accidents, or natural disasters.
		6.9.9 (C)	Recording the worker's health condition, treatment provided, and (any) follow-up actions taken at the time of and after the annual medical surveillance is considered best practice.
		6.9.10	Lost Time Incidents (LTI) metrics typically measure incidents that result in lost workdays or time away from work due to illnesses, diseases or injuries sustained on the job. Details of the occupational injuries and/or illnesses contributing to LTI are important to record to support investigation and further action. The processes for investigating LTIs should detail the steps involved for the UoC to conduct such investigations such as incident reporting, evidence collection, root cause analysis, and corrective action identification. Recommendations resulting from such investigations should be reviewed for potential incorporation into the UoC"s health and safety practices in order to continuously improve its protection measures and to prevent recurrence of incidents.
		6.9.11	

Adopted 15 Nov 2024

		6.9.12 (C)	The Safety Data Sheet of the product serves as a reference for conducting training to workers on the precautions and safe handling of the chemical. Practical demonstrations, assessments, or evaluations can demonstrate that workers have up-to-date understanding and knowledge in order to competently and capably handle chemicals. Restricted and hazardous pesticides, especially Highly Hazardous Pesticides, are not used unless absolutely necessary (Reference: Indicator 7.1.2)
6	**7.1**	**7.1.1 (C)**	A Unit of Certification should apply recognised IPM techniques that incorporate cultural, biological, mechanical, and physical methods to minimise the use of chemicals. Native species should be used in biological control where possible. In general, an IPM plan consists of the follow steps: A) Identification of pest(s) and available control measures; B) Implementation of the plan with clear objectives to reduce negative impacts; C) Management and monitoring, including update/review process; and D) Focus on invasive introduced species (if any)*. *Invasive introduced species are such species that exist in the Unit of Certification's operational activities (Reference: Indicator 7.1.6).
		7.1.2 (C)	Restricted and hazardous pesticides, especially Highly Hazardous Pesticides, are to be avoided for usage unless absolutely necessary with documented evidence of validation or authorisation that was no other alternative available. Availability of a chemical register or pesticide inventory - including records of pesticide usage and restricted/hazardous pesticide usage with relevant justification (if any) - may or may not be sufficient to show avoidance of use; in some cases, additional verification may be required through, or to follow up on, interviews with workers and stakeholders. Measures to avoid the development of chemical resistance (such as pesticide rotations) should be applied.
		7.1.3 (C)	LD50 refers to the amount of a particular chemical that is lethal to one-half (50%) of the experimental subjects exposed to it.
		7.1.4 (C)	Exceptional circumstances refer to situations where prophylactic use of pesticides - i.e., pre-emptive usage to eradicate pests or diseases - is the only available option to control the situation or outbreak. Such prophylactic use should be supported by documented evidence of agronomist advice, with validation or authorisation, denoting that was no other alternative available.
		7.1.5 (C)	Targeted spraying in aerial pesticide application refers to a precise method of applying pesticide only to the specific area(s) infested by the pest, disease, and/or weeds. Care should be taken in any aerial spraying using drones to minimise exposure to non-target areas, organisms, and the health of workers in the vicinity and the drone operator(s).

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		7.1.6 (C)	Invasive species', also known as 'alien invasive species', are species whose introduction, establishment, and spread into new areas threaten ecosystems, habitats or other species and cause social, economic or environmental harm, or harm to human health. (Reference: FAO, 2007:82) UoCs should periodically check for any updates to the Global Invasive Species Database (https://www.iucngisd.org/gisd/) and the CABI Digital Library (https://www.cabidigitallibrary.org/) for species considered as invasive. The most current version of the GISD and CABI serves as a reference for this indicator.
		7.1.7 (C)	For this indicator, managing the use of invasive or prohibited species previously introduced refers to continuous identification, assessment, and monitoring to minimise any associated risk(s).
		7.1.8	Exceptional circumstances refer to conditions or considerations in which fire - specifically for the control of pest and/or disease outbreaks - is the only available option to control the situation or eliminate the outbreak from further spread. Such use of fire for controlled burning should be limited and controlled, and supported by documented evidence of government approval or authorisation, referencing existing guidelines such as the 'Guidelines for the Implementation of the ASEAN Policy on Zero Burning' 2003 or equivalent comparable guidelines/regulations in other regions. Land affected by such use of fire should be restored, or left to rehabilitate back, to its previous land use function.
	7.2	**7.2.1**	The waste management plan should include measures for: A) Improving the efficiency of resource utilisation and recycling potential waste as nutrients (Reference: Indicator 7.2.2) or conversion into value-added products (e.g. through animal feeding programmes); B) Appropriate management and disposal of hazardous chemicals (and their containers). Surplus chemical containers should be reused, recycled or disposed of in an environmentally and socially responsible way using recommended best practices (e.g. returned to the vendor or cleaned using a triple rinse method), in such a way that there is no risk of contamination. Disposal instructions on the manufacturers' labels should be adhered to. Waste generated from a UoC's operations include waste produced from cultivation of oil palms and production of palm oil at the mill(s), including associated processes such as transport and plantation/estate management. Waste generated from a UoC's non-operational activities can include waste from a UoC's administrative offices, worker housing, or infrastructure facilities. Non-recyclable or re-usable waste or by-products should be responsibly disposed, in particular hazardous or harmful materials such as used chemicals, batteries, and effluent that require controlled handling or process treatment to a level where it no longer poses a risk to the environment or human health. National laws and regulations serve as the reference for responsible disposal.
		7.2.2	Optimal use of inorganic fertilisers refers to the right type of in organic fertiliser applied using the right dosage, at the right time, and in the right location. Soil and leaf nutrient analysis can be used to determine this.

		7.2.3 (C)	Health and safety aspects of waste management are taken into account (Reference: Criterion 6.9).
		7.2.4	Unprocessed waste must be properly treated in such a way that there is no longer any material risk to the environment or human health when discharged, based on national laws and regulations (where applicable) or reference international regulations/guidelines.
	7.3	**7.3.1 (C)**	Maps should follow common cartographic standards and match the area disclosed to RSPO in the UoC's most recent Land Use Change Analysis (LUCA) map submitted. Areas located within the plantation's perimeter considered unsuitable for long-term oil palm cultivation should be delineated in plans and included for conservation or rehabilitation, as appropriate. Soil surveys or soil suitability maps should be appropriate to the scale of operation and include information on soil type(s), topography, hydrology, rooting depth, moisture availability, stoniness, and fertility. Such surveys can be done independently or as part of an SEIA (Reference: Criterion 3.3). Particular care should be taken in the case of scheme smallholders, where the UoC should assist in the soil suitability assessment of their scheme smallholders' land.
		7.3.2 (C)	
		7.3.3 (C)	Peat can be considered a fragile soil. Where peat soils are identified and mapped within a UoC's perimeter, the indicators of Criterion 7.4 should be referenced for indicators within Criterion 7.3. Maps produced for Indicator 7.3.1 can be standalone or can integrated the RSPO Peat Inventory procedures (Reference: Indicator 7.4.2).
		7.3.4 (C)	Soil types requiring specific appropriate practices should be identified for planning. Techniques and practices to minimise soil erosion should be adopted (where appropriate), such as ground cover management, biomass recycling, terracing, natural regeneration over replanting, appropriate use of heavy machinery, terracing on slopes, responsible road construction, rapid establishment of cover, or protection of riverbanks.
	7.4	**7.4.1 (C)**	
		7.4.2	Areas of peat (planted and unplanted) inventoried in accordance with the RSPO procedures on Peat Inventory is submitted to the RSPO Secretariat for reference and monitoring, using the RSPO Peat Inventory template (including other required materials i.e., the UoC's peat map). 'Make.... available' in the context of this indicator refers to the official acceptance by the RSPO Secretariat of the UoC's map, as submitted.
		7.4.3 (C)	Construction activities or infrastructure development mandated or authorised by the national or sub-national government of a country within a UoC's perimeters are excluded from the scope of this indicator. In such cases, the UoC is expected to provide justification for the exclusion.
		7.4.4 (C)	

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		7.4.5 (C)	For existing plantings on peat, the water table should be maintained at an average of 50cm (within a range of 40cm and 60cm) below ground surface as measured with groundwater piezometer readings, or an average of 60cm (within a range of 50cm and 70cm) below ground surface as measured in water collection drains; through a network of appropriate water control structures (e.g. weirs, sandbags, etc.) in fields; and/or watergates at the discharge points of main drains. If the national laws or regulations of a country require a different minimum water table level for peat soils, the stricter of the two applies. Monitoring of subsidence should be undertaken in all drained peat areas in the plantation including areas adjacent to the plantation where water tables may be impacted by associated drainage. The following aspects should be documented and considered for long-term planning: A) Peat subsidence level; B) Efficacy of water level management; and C) Efficacy of ground cover management.
		7.4.6 (C)	Where applicable to its operations, a UoC must conduct a RSPO Drainability Assessment Procedure at least five years before any replanting activity. Replanting is dependent on the approval of the Drainability Assessment Procedure report. These requirements should be taken into account as the UoC develops its long-term replanting plan (Reference: Indicator 3.1.2).
		7.4.7 (C)	
	7.5	**7.5.1 (C)**	The water management plan includes measures to: A) Maintain natural hydrological patterns and stream flows; B) Consideration of relevant stakeholders, their water use, and water resource availability; C) Ensure the efficiency of use and renewability of water sources; D) Ensure that the use and management of water by the UoC does not result in adverse impacts on other users within the catchment area, including local communities and customary water users; E) Aim to ensure that local communities, workers and their families have access to adequate, clean water for drinking, cooking, bathing, and cleaning purposes; and F) Avoid contamination of surface and ground water through runoff of soil, nutrients or chemicals, or as a result of inadequate disposal of waste including Palm Oil Mill Effluent (POME).
		7.5.2	Water consumption is the total amount of water in megalitres (mL) used by the UoC's mill(s) in the production of a metric tonne of crude palm oil (CPO) or palm kernel (PK). Water used for production that has been treated and released back as safe surface water or groundwater (water discharge) can be excluded. Water withdrawal is the total amount of water withdrawn in megalitres (mL) for use by the UoC's mill(s) from the following sources: surface water; groundwater; seawater; produced water; and third-party water. Surface water and groundwater refer to naturally-occurring above ground and underground sources of water, respectively. Third-party water refers to water sourced from municipal, public or private water utilities or suppliers. In the context of a palm oil mill, seawater or produced water generally do not apply as sources of water.

Adopted RSPO

			If the UoC is located in an area of known water stress, this should be noted. *(All reference to GRI 303: Water and Effluents 2018 reporting standard, Global Reporting Initiative, https://www.globalreporting.org/)*.
		7.5.3 (C)	Watercourses can include rivers, streams, lakes, ponds, spring, creeks, or coastal water bodies (or any part thereof).
		7.5.4 (C)	If the national laws or regulations of a country do not specify any minimum treatment requirements and/or discharge quality limits for POME, this can be defined through a National Interpretation process. International recommendation/guidelines or regulations of neighbouring/similar countries can be used as reference.
	7.6	**7.6.1 (C)**	The UoC's plan to reduce or minimise GHG emissions should cover: A) Identification and assessment of the key GHG emissions risk areas within the UoC's operations using the RSPO PalmGHG calculator; B) Clear objectives and implementable actions to reduce and mitigate the identified GHG emissions; C) Management and monitoring of GHG emission within the UoC over time for efficacy; and D) Emerging and potential technologies (if any) that could be utilised and implemented for additional reduction or minimisation of GHG emissions. A GHG emission reduction or minimisation target must be clear (i.e., based on a defined scope), specific (e.g., 'Reduce Scope 1 emissions by 20% overall'), measurable (e.g., 'Reduce Scope 1 emissions by 5% annually'), and timebound (i.e., a commitment to achieve the overall target within a specified timeline, for example, 'by 2030' or 'within 5 years'). The latest version of the RSPO PalmGHG Calculator is being developed in alignment with the latest GHG Protocol Standards, based on the GHG Protocol's Scope 1, 2, and 3 framework for measuring and inventorying GHG emissions. For details, please refer to the latest PalmGHG Guidance Document.
		7.6.2 (C)	GHG emissions per product can include Crude Palm Oil (CPO), Crude Palm Kernel Oil (CPKO), and/or Palm Kernel (PK). Estimates generated by the PalmGHG calculator use defined data inputs provided by the UoC, and then verified by auditors during RSPO P&C audits. The UoC's GHG emissions per product must be published in its public summary RSPO P&C audit report as 'publicly reported'.
		7.6.3 (C)	New developments, in general, should only be proposed to be established on mineral soils, in low carbon stock areas, and/or existing cultivated areas already under agricultural land use (e.g., rubber, tree crops) that is suitable for oil palm cultivation.

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		7.6.4 (C)	Examples of significant air pollutants include sulphur dioxide (SO_2), nitrogen oxides (NO_x), non-methane volatile organic compounds (NMVOC), fine particulate matter ($PM_{2.5}$ and PM_{10}), and other airborne pollutants recognised by national or international guidelines as major contributors to severe degradation of air quality. The UoC's plan to reduce or minimise this should consist of: A) Identification and types of air pollutants present in, or generated by, the UoC's operations; B) Level of significance and scale of the identified air pollutants; C) Source(s) of the identified air pollutants; D) Potential measures or actions to reduce or minimise such air pollutants; E) Achievable and measurable reduction targets based on application of those measures or actions; and F) Implementation and monitoring to track progress and adjust the plan, if necessary.
		7.6.5 (C)	In the event that land within the UoC is affected by fire for reasons beyond management control, the land affected or degraded by such fires should be restored, or left to rehabilitate back, to its previous land use function.
		7.6.6	Fire risks include spontaneous wildfires caused by dry conditions and fire spread from open burning by surrounding communities, which can be exacerbated by extreme weather patterns and events. The RSPO Fire Hotspot Monitoring System and other available public fire monitoring tools can serve as early warning signals for potential fire risk.
		7.6.7	Gradual reduction in fossil fuel use within palm oil operations can be achieved by optimising transport, upgrading machinery, and/or adopting energy-saving practices in mills and plantations. The UoC should assess the direct energy use (including fuel and electricity) and energy efficiency of its operations, especially in the planning of infrastructure construction or upgrading. Direct fossil fuel use per metric tonne of CPO (mill) or FFB (plantation) produced should be monitored (Reference: Indicator 7.6.1 as fossil fuel usage is an input in PalmGHG calculations) and should cover fuel use by the on-site workforce, including all transport and machinery operations. The feasibility of collecting and using biogas captured from POME treatment for power generation (Reference: Indicator 7.5.4) or other renewable energy sources (e.g., solar, biomass) should be assessed for potential implementation.

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	7.7	**7.7.1 (C)**	Damaging' primary forests, HCVs, and HCS forests refers to land clearance by the UoC categorised as Non-Compliant Land Clearing (NCLC), defined and assessed through a RSPO Land Use Change Analysis (LUCA). Assessment of compliance falls under three scenarios, based on land status and the timing of land clearing: 1) For existing plantations with no new land clearing after November 2018, evidence of a valid HCV assessment is required, and the version of the assessment manual used must align with RSPO requirements applicable at the time. An ALS-licensed assessor is not required. 2) For UoCs that followed the transitional measures in the P&C 2018, evidence of a valid HCV, standalone HCSA, or Integrated HCV-HCS assessment conducted before land clearing is required. Any land clearing under this scenario must have been registered by 13 September 2019 with the RSPO Secretariat; otherwise, a new HCV-HCSA assessment is required. The version of the assessment manual used must be verified. An ALS-licensed assessor is not required, provided the assessment was completed before the deadline. 3) For new land clearing after 15 November 2018 that was not covered under the transitional measures of scenario 2), evidence that an ALS-integrated HCV-HCSA assessment was conducted is required, using the assessment manual valid at the time (either the November 2017 or the June 2023 version). An ALS-licensed assessor is required. RSPO New Planting Procedure requirements also apply.
		7.7.2 (C)	
		7.7.3 (C)	The management & monitoring plan under Indicator 7.7.3 should be developed utilising findings from the relevant HCV and/or HCV-HCSA assessment as a baseline. Data from complementary sources such as the Land Use Change Analysis (LUCA); peatland management requirements (Reference: Criterion 7.4); Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) processes; and other identified conservation areas (including riparian zones) should also be integrated into the baseline to provide a comprehensive understanding of the conservation and management needs within a Unit of Certification. The plan should be tailored to address any specific findings from the assessments mentioned above, focusing on conserving and enhancing HCVs and HCS forests while managing threats such as human-wildlife conflict and habitat degradation. Clear measures are to be outlined for the protection of Rare, Threatened, and Endangered (RTE) species, the management of other conservation areas, and the promotion of workforce awareness on conservation priorities. The scope of the plan should be realistic and achievable, targeting actions within direct control of the UoC. Additional collaboration(s) with relevant stakeholders active in the immediate area before and during implementation can be beneficial to overall success of the plan. The role of affected communities includes - but is not limited to - participation of those communities in managing HCVs, HCS forests, training or capacity building on HCVs, HCS forest protection and conservation, and monitoring.

Adopted 1.3

		7.7.4 (C)	Adapting the management & monitoring plan is the process of adjusting the UoC's existing management actions to protect and/or conserve HCVs and HCS forests to accommodate actual changes in the status and conditions of those HCVs and HCS forests. Until the RSPO Guidance is developed and endorsed for application, the HCVN Common Guidance for the Management and Monitoring of HCV (version published December 30, 2021, www.hcvnetwork.org) can serve as a reference guidance for this indicator.
		7.7.5	Reference: Principle 4 for applicable requirements on respecting the rights of local communities and reaching a negotiated agreement through the process of Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC). A variety of land management and tenure options should be considered by the UoC to secure HCV areas in ways that also secure local peoples' rights and livelihoods. Some areas are best allocated to community management and secured through customary or legal tenures. In other cases, co-management options may be considered. Where communities are asked to relinquish rights so that HCVs can be protected or enhanced by the UoC or state agencies, great care needs to be taken to ensure that they retain access to adequate land and resources to secure their basic needs, and all such relinquishment of rights is subject to obtain their FPIC.
Procedural Note on Metrics Template: In P&C 2024, the indicator requiring UoCs to submit Metrics Template has been removed (Reference: Indicator 3.2.2 in P&C 2018). Data previously reported in the P&C 2018 Metrics Template will continue to be gathered from UoCs at the pre-audit stage of P&C 2024 audits together with other pre-audit data required by RSPO auditors, as developed in the RSPO Information System. This revision in RSPO's approach to gathering metricated data as part of P&C certification is intended to streamline existing processes and address known issues of undue administrative/operational burden.			

Adopted 13.1

Annex 6 - Supplementary and derivative documents of 2024 RSPO P&C

The following is a list of currently effective, to be updated*, to be developed*, and in development/revision* supplementary and derivative documents of the 2024 RSPO P&C.

**Status of supplementary or derivative document as of 30 June 2025.*

Supplementary or Derivative document	Reference to Criteria / Indicator	Applicability
RSPO Certification System for P&C and ISH Standards **- in revision**	All criteria and indicators	Normative
RSPO Human Rights Due Diligence (HRDD) Guidance **- in development**	1.3 / 1.3.1	Informative
RSPO Policy on the Protection of Human Rights Defenders, Whistleblowers, Complainants and Community Spokespersons **- to be updated**	2.4 / 2.4.1 (C)	Informative
RSPO New Planting Procedure (NPP) **- in revision**	3.3 / 3.3.1 (C); 7.3 / 7.3.3 (C); 7.7 / 7.7.1 (C)	Normative
RSPO Supply Chain Certification (SCC) Standard **- in revision**	3.5 / all indicators	Normative
RSPO Rules on Market Communications & Claims	3.5 / 3.5.4 (C), 3.5.12 (C)	Normative
RSPO Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) Guide	4.3 / all indicators; 4.4 / all indicators	Informative
RSPO Guidance on Calculating Prevailing Wages	6.3 / 6.3.1 (C)	Informative
RSPO Prevailing Wage Calculation Procedure **- in development**	6.3 / 6.3.1 (C)	Normative
RSPO Guidance on Child Rights for Palm Oil Producers	6.5 / 6.5.3 (C)	Informative
RSPO Guidance for the Repayment of Recruitment Fees and Related Costs **- in development**	6.8 / 6.8.3 (C)	Informative
RSPO Manual on Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Steep Terrain Conservation and Management **- in development**	7.3 / 7.3.2 (C)	Informative
RSPO Best Management Practices (BMPs) for Soil **- to be developed**	7.3 / 7.3.4 (C)	Informative
Guidance on Peat Inventory for RSPO reporting	7.4 / 7.4.2	Normative
RSPO Peat Inventory Template	7.4 / 7.4.2	Normative
RSPO Peat Audit Guidance	7.4 / 7.4.2, 7.4.3 (C), 7.4.4 (C), 7.4.5	Informative
RSPO Manual on BMPs for Management and Rehabilitation of Peatlands	7.4 / 7.4.1 (C), 7.4.3 (C), 7.4.4 (C), 7.4.5, 7.4.6 (C),	Informative

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	7.4.7 (C)	
RSPO Manual on BMP's for Existing Oil Palm Cultivation on Peat	7.4 / 7.4.3 (C), 7.4.4 (C), 7.4.5	Informative
RSPO Drainability Assessment Procedure	7.4 / 7.4.6 (C), 7.4.7 (C)	Normative
RSPO Manual on BMPs for the Management and Rehabilitation of Riparian Reserves	7.5 / 7.5.3 (C)	Informative
RSPO PalmGHG Calculator Manual - **in revision**	7.6 / 7.6.1 (C), 7.6.2 (C)	Normative
RSPO GHG Assessment Procedure for New Development	7.6 / 7.6.3 (C)	Normative
RSPO Guidance for Land Use Change Analysis (LUCA)	7.7 / 7.7.1 (C), 7.7.2 (C)	Normative
Interpretation of Indicator 7.7.1 (C) - **in revision, based on Annex 5 of 2018 RSPO P&C (for validity)**	7.7 / 7.7.1 (C)	Normative
RSPO Remediation and Compensation Procedure (RaCP) **- Version 2 in development**	7.7 / 7.7.2 (C)	Normative
RSPO Guidance on Changes in HCV Conditions and Status - **to be developed**	7.7/ 7.7.4 (C)	Informative

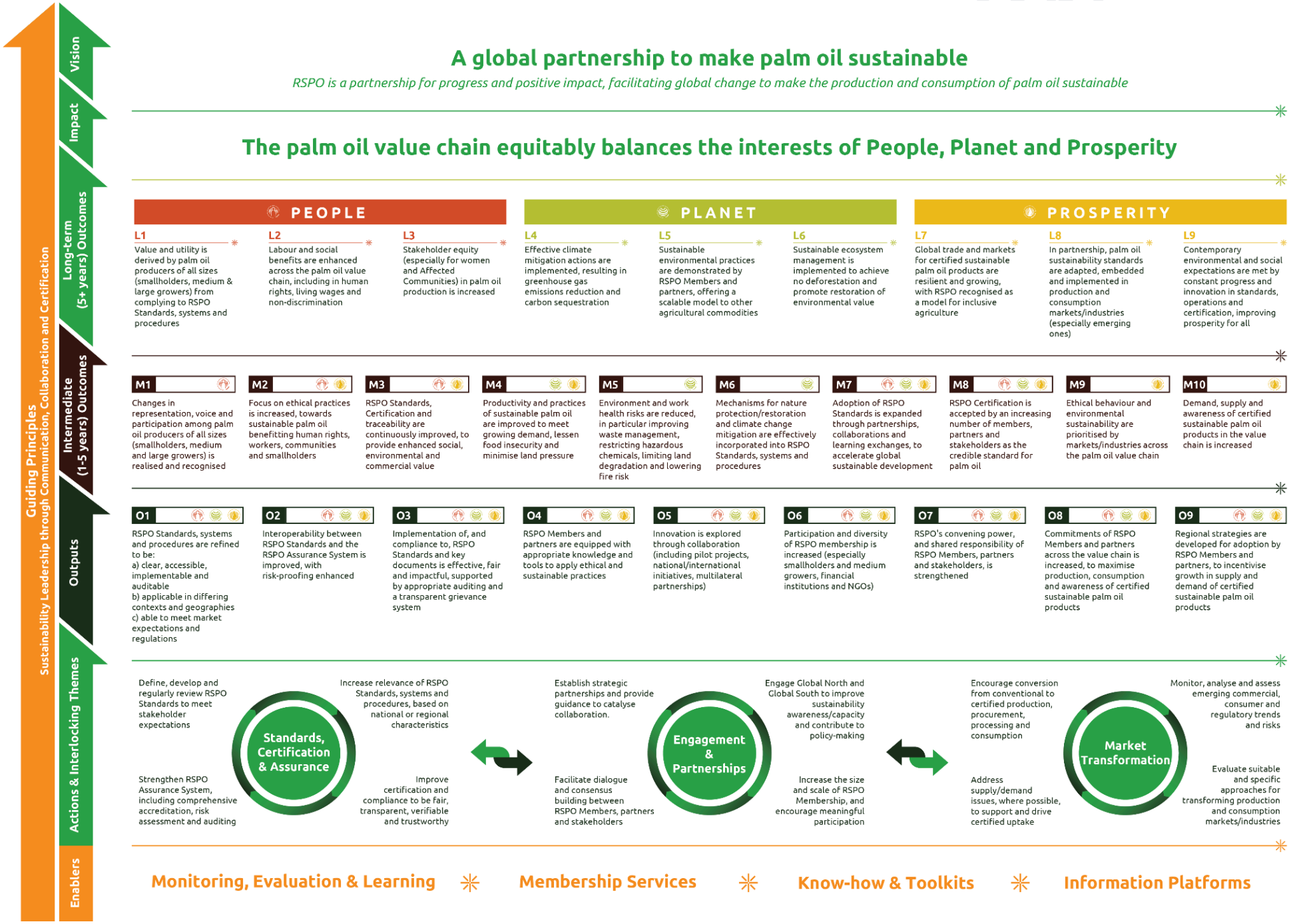
Adopted 13 Nov 2024

VI. Appendices

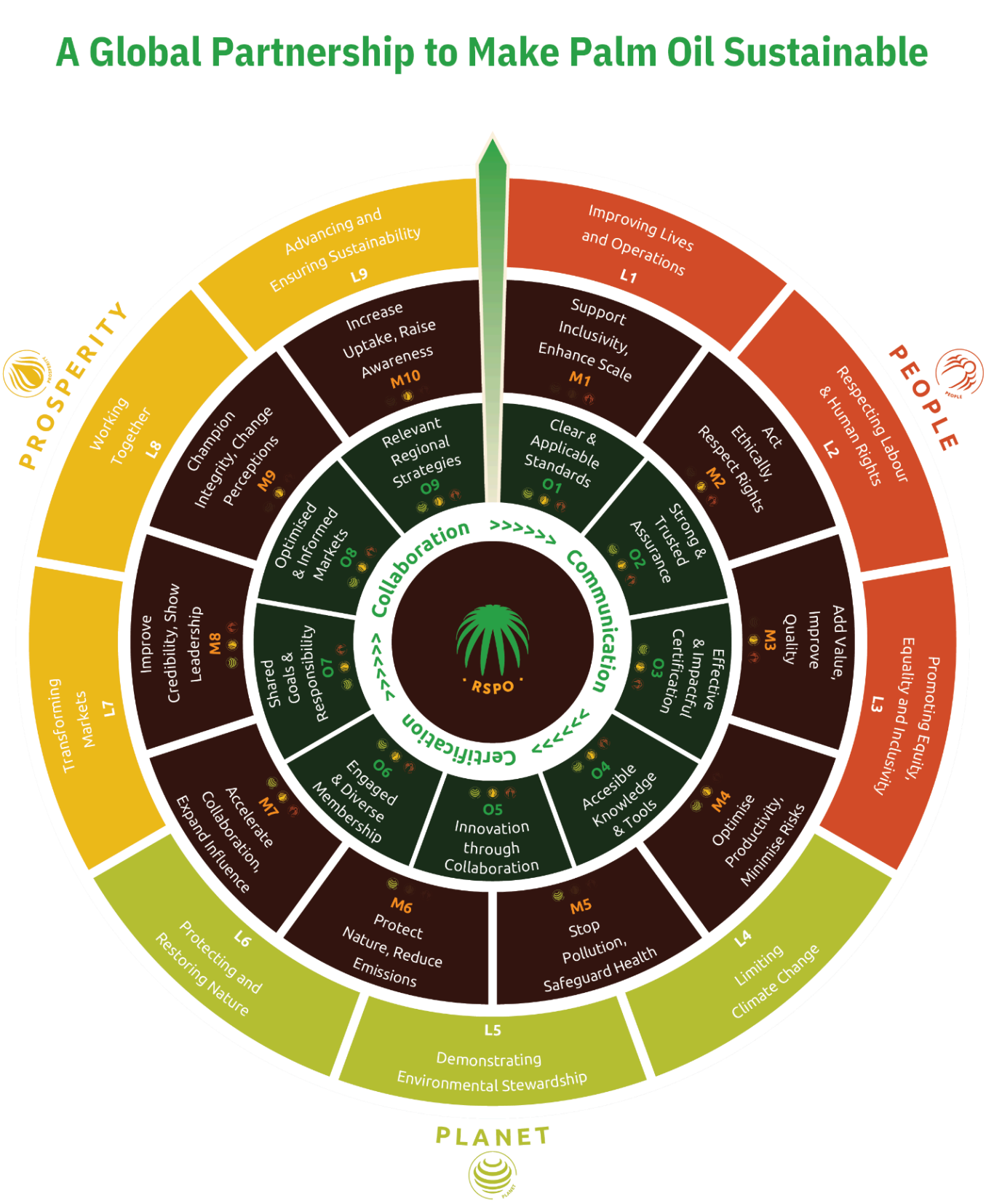
Adopted 13 Nov 2024

Appendix A - RSPO Theory of Change

Theory of Change (Full Diagram)



Theory of Change (Simplified Diagram)



Appendix B - National Interpretations of 2018 RSPO P&C

National Interpretations of 2018 RSPO P&C	Date of Endorsement by RSPO Board of Governors
Cameroon National Interpretation	21 November 2021
Colombia National Interpretation	12 November 2020
Côte d'Ivoire National Interpretation	25 June 2020
Ecuador National Interpretation	20 May 2022
Gabon National Interpretation	3 September 2020
Ghana National Interpretation	7 November 2019
Guatemala National Interpretation	20 June 2021
Honduras National Interpretation	20 June 2021
India National Interpretation	7 November 2019
Indonesia National Interpretation	20 April 2020
Liberia National Interpretation	10 June 2021
Malaysia National Interpretation	7 November 2019
Mexico National Interpretation	25 June 2020
Nicaragua National Interpretation	22 November 2021
Nigeria National Interpretation	21 February 2021
Papua New Guinea and Solomon Islands National Interpretation	7 November 2019
Sierra Leone National Interpretation	22 November 2021
Thailand National Interpretation	25 June 2020

Adopted 13 Nov 2024